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Daniel - Introduction

Daniel

Daniel - Introduction

Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of the book of Daniel

1. Daniel and his friends resolve not to defile themselves (1:1–21)
2. Daniel interprets Nebuchadnezzar's dream about a statue (2:1–49)
3. God delivers Daniel's friends from the fiery furnace (3:1–30)
4. Daniel interprets Nebuchadnezzar's dream about a tree (4:1–37)
5. Daniel interprets the writing on the wall at Belshazzar's feast (5:1–31)
6. God keeps Daniel safe in the den of lions (6:1–28)
7. Daniel's vision of four beasts (7:1–28)
8. Daniel's vision of a ram and a goat (8:1–27)
9. Daniel's prayer for the restoration of Jerusalem and Gabriel's explanation (9:1–27)
10. Daniel's vision of an angel and the kings of the north and south (10:1–12:13)
11. Daniel has a vision and a man appears to him to explain it (10:1–11:1)
12. The wars between the kings of the south and north (11:2–45)
13. What will happen at "the time of the end" (12:1–13)

What is the Book of Daniel about?
The first part of the book of Daniel (chapters 1–6) relates stories about four young men whom the Babylonians took from the kingdom of Judah as prisoners. One of these men was named Daniel. He had three friends, to whom the Babylonians gave the names Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. These stories tell how these young men were faithful to God while living in a pagan land and serving a pagan king. They tell how God protected them and rewarded them because they were faithful. They also tell how God gave Daniel the ability to interpret dreams and explain mysteries.

The second part of the book of Daniel (chapters 7–12) relates several prophetic visions that Daniel had. These chapters also describe, in several cases, the glorious appearance of angelic messengers who explained to Daniel what his visions meant.

What title should translators use for this book?
Translators can use the traditional title "The book of Daniel" or just "Daniel." They might also call this book "Stories and Visions of Daniel" or "What Daniel Did and What God Showed Him."

Who wrote the Book of Daniel?
The first six chapters of the book speak of Daniel and his friends in the third person (as "he" and "they"). This suggests that someone else, perhaps another Judean who was exiled in Babylon with them, may have written these chapters to record how they remained faithful to God and how God protected them.

In the last six chapters of the book, Daniel speaks of himself in the first person (saying "I, Daniel"). (The seventh chapter serves as a transition; it begins by speaking of Daniel in the third person, but this introduces an account by Daniel himself that ends with this first-person attestation.) This indicates that Daniel himself wrote this part of the book.

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

(Some material may go here.)

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

The meaning of Daniel's visions
Even though angelic messengers explain to Daniel what his visions mean, it is not entirely clear to modern readers what historic time periods they predicted or whether they predict things that will happen at the end of the world. It is not necessary to come to conclusions about this in order to translate the book. The language in the visions is straightforward and descriptive, and translation teams should be able to reflect successfully in their languages what it says. What it means is a matter for preachers and teachers of the Scriptures to try to understand and explain.

The original languages of the book of Daniel
Half of the book of Daniel is written in Hebrew, and the other half of the book is written in Aramaic. These halves do not correspond with the two parts that are stories and visions. Instead, chapters 1 and 8–12 are in Hebrew, while chapters 2–7 are in Aramaic. This means that the first chapter of each part of the book is in a different language from the rest of that part. In the first part, the Hebrew chapter introduces a transition from the young men's former life in Jerusalem to their life in the Babylonian and Persian courts, where Aramaic was spoken. In the second part, the Aramaic chapter introduces a transition from the affairs of those foreign courts to matters that affect the Jewish people more directly. Daniel and his three friends were native speakers of Hebrew who had to learn Aramaic

Daniel - Chapter 1 Introduction

(1:4), so they or others who were with them would have been able to put together a book like this that used both languages.

Even in the English ULT text, some of the differences between the original Hebrew and Aramaic texts will be evident. For example, translators may already have encountered the common Hebrew expression "answered and said" in their work on other books. In the Aramaic sections of Daniel, the equivalent expression is "answered and was saying." It is not necessary to try to show such differences in your translation. Consistently say things in the way that is most natural and meaningful in your translation.

"all before that" and "all before this"
In the Aramaic portion of the book (chapters 2–7), these similar phrases describe some relationship between what follows and what precedes. They do not indicate that what precedes happened before what follows. Their meaning is flexible and varies by context. Notes will suggest what they mean and how you might translate them in each instance.

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Daniel 1:1 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שָׁלֹ֔וֹשׁ

"In the year of three"

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **three**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. In this verse, the number identifies the third year of the reign of Jehoiakim. Alternate translation: [In the third year of the reign]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel 1:2 (#1)

וַיִּתֵּן֙ אֲדֹנָ֣י בְּיָד֔וֹ

"And the Lord gave into his hand"

Here, **hand** represents "power" or "control." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the Lord gave into his control]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 1:3 (#1)

לְאַשְׁפְּנַ֖ז

"Ashpenaz"

The word **Ashpenaz** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 1:3 (#2)

מִבְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

"from the sons of Israel"

The author is speaking as if all the people descended from the man Israel were his **sons**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 1:3 (#3)

וּמִזֶּ֥רַע הַמְּלוּכָ֖ה

"both from the seed of the kingdom"

The author is speaking as if the members of the royal family were **seed** that the kingdom had produced. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [both from the royal family]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 1:3 (#4)

וּמִזֶּ֥רַע הַמְּלוּכָ֖ה

"both from the seed of the kingdom"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **kingdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [both from the sons of the royal family]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 1:4 (#1)

וְיֹדְעֵ֤י דַּ֙עַת֙ וּמְבִינֵ֣י מַדָּ֔ע

"and knowers of knowledge and understanders of knowledge"

For poetic purposes, the author is using two different words that have basically the same meaning. The ULT translates each one as **knowledge** because English

does not have two different words that it can use in this context. But if your language does, it would be appropriate to use them here. Alternate translation: [knowers of knowledge and understanders of information]

See: Poetry

Daniel 1:4 (#2)

וְיֹדְעֵי דַּ֫עַתתֹ

“and knowers of knowledge”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this.

See: Poetry

Daniel 1:4 (#3)

וּלְשׁ֥וֹן כַּשְׂדִּֽים

“and tongue of the Chaldeans”

Here, **tongue** represents “language.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and language of the Chaldeans]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 1:4 (#4)

בְּכָל־חָכְמָ֞ה וְיֹדְעֵי֩ דַּ֨עַתתֹ וּמְבִינֵ֜י מַדָּ֗ע

“in all wisdom and knowers of knowledge and understanders of knowledge”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **wisdom** and **knowledge**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [in everything wise and who knew many things and who understood many things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 1:5 (#1)

דְּבַר־י֥וֹם בְּיוֹמ֖וֹ

“the matter of a day in its day”

The author is using **the matter of a day in its day** as a common expression of the culture to mean “a set amount for each day.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a set amount for each day]

See: Idiom

Daniel 1:5 (#2)

מִפַּת־בַּ֣בְג הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ וּמִיַּ֖יִן מִשְׁתָּתֽוֹ

“from the portion of the king and from the wine of his drinking”

Daniel is using this possessive form to mean the food and wine that the king himself eats and drinks. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [from the same food that the king eats and the same wine that he drinks]

See: Possession

Daniel 1:5 (#3)

וּמִקְצָתָ֖ם יַעַמְד֑וּ

“and from the end of them they would stand”

The pronoun **them** refers to the three years of the young men’s training, while the pronoun **they** refers to the young men. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and at the end of those three years the young men would serve]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 1:5 (#4)

לִפְנֵ֥י הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“to the face of the king”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of the king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before the king]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 1:6 (#1)

דָּנִיֵּ֣אל חֲנַנְיָ֔ה מִישָׁאֵ֖ל וַעֲזַרְיָֽה

“Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah”

The author is introducing **Daniel**, **Hananiah**, **Mishael**, and **Azariah** as new participants in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [four young men whose names were Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 1:7 (#1)

בֵּ֚בֶלְטְשַׁאצַּ֔ר וְלַחֲנַנְיָה֙ שַׁדְרַ֣ךְ וּלְמִישָׁאֵ֔ל מֵישַׁ֖ךְ וְלַֽעֲזַרְיָ֑ה עֲבֵ֥ד נְגֽוֹ

“Belteshazzar; and to Hananiah, Shadrach; and to Mishael, Meshach; and to Azariah, Abednego”

The words **Belteshazzar**, **Shadrach**, **Meshach**, and **Abednego** are the Babylonian names of these young men.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 1:7 (#2)

וְלַחֲנַנְיָה֙ שַׁדְרַ֔ךְ וּלְמִישָׁאֵ֖ל מֵישַׁ֑ךְ וְלַעֲזַרְיָ֖ה עַבְֵד נְגֽוֹ

“and to Hananiah, Shadrach; and to Mishael, Meshach; and to Azariah, Abednego”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and to Hananiah, he gave the name Shadrach; and to Mishael, he gave the name Meshach; and to Azariah, he gave the name Abednego]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 1:8 (#1)

וַיָּ֤שֶׂם דָּנִיֵּאל֙ עַל־לִבּ֔וֹ

“But Daniel set upon his heart”

The author is using **set upon his heart** as a common expression of the culture to mean “resolved” or “firmly decided.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But Daniel firmly decided]

See: Idiom

Daniel 1:9 (#1)

וַיִּתֵּ֤ן הָאֱלֹהִים֙ אֶת־דָּנִיֵּ֔אל לְחֶ֖סֶד וּלְרַחֲמִ֑ים

“And God gave Daniel to favor and to compassions”

The author is using **gave Daniel to favor and to compassions** as a common expression of the culture to mean “caused the chief of the eunuchs to regard Daniel with favor and kindness.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And God caused Daniel to be regarded with favor and compassion]

See: Idiom

Daniel 1:9 (#2)

לְחֶ֖סֶד וּלְרַחֲמִ֑ים

“to favor and to compassions”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **favor** and **compassions**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [to be regarded favorably and compassionately]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 1:9 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֖י

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of the chief of the eunuchs. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of] or [in front of]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 1:10 (#1)

יָרֵ֞א אֲנִ֣י

“I, I fear”

The chief of the eunuchs is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **fear** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he himself is afraid of what the king might do to him. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [I myself fear my lord the king] or [for my part, I fear]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 1:10 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֨ר לָמָּה֙ יִרְאֶ֣ה אֶת־פְּנֵיכֶ֔ם זְעֲפִּ֖ים מִן־הַיְלָדִ֑ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר כְּגִילְכֶ֖ם

“For why should he see your faces looking worse than the youths who {are} like your age”

The chief of the eunuchs is using the question form to express his fear of what the king might do to him if the young men looked unhealthy. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [For I am afraid that he will see your faces looking worse than your peers!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Daniel 1:10 (#3)

וְחִיַּבְתֶּם אֶת־רֹאשִׁי לַמֶּלֶךְ

“Then you would endanger my head with the king”

The chief of the eunuchs is using **endanger my head with the king** as a common expression of the culture to mean “cause the king to have me executed.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Then you would cause the king to have me beheaded]

See: Idiom

Daniel 1:10 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר לָמָּה֩ יִרְאֶ֨ה אֶת־פְּנֵיכֶ֜ם זְעֲפִ֗ים מִן־הַיְלָדִים֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר כְּגִילְכֶ֔ם וְחִיַּבְתֶּם אֶת־רֹאשִׁי לַמֶּלֶךְ

“For why should he see your faces looking worse than the youths who {are} like your age? Then you would endanger my head with the king”

The word **you** is plural here because the chief of the eunuchs is addressing Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah together, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Daniel 1:11 (#1)

הַמֶּלְצַר

“the steward”

A **steward** is a kind of official who was put in charge of overseeing and caring for others. If your readers would not be familiar with what a steward is, you could use the name of a similar person that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the caretaker] or [the overseer]

See: Translate Unknowns

Daniel 1:12 (#1)

אֶת־עֲבָדֶיךָ

“your servants”

Daniel is referring to himself and his companions in the third person as **your servants** to show respect and humility before the steward. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this in the first person. Alternate translation: [us]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Daniel 1:12 (#2)

וְיִתְּנוּ־לָ֑נוּ

“and let them give to us”

Daniel is using the pronoun **them** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and let us be given some vegetables to eat]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 1:12 (#3)

וְיִתְּנוּ־לָ֑נוּ מִן־הַזֵּרֹעִ֥ים וְנֹאכְלָ֖ה וּמַ֥יִם וְנִשְׁתֶּֽה

“and let them give to us from vegetables, and let us eat, and water, and let us drink”

Daniel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. He means that he wants the steward to give them vegetables to eat and water to drink. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and let them give to us vegetables to eat and water to drink]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 1:13 (#1)

וְיֵרָאוּ֩ לְפָנֶ֨יךָ מַרְאֵ֜ינוּ וּמַרְאֵ֣ה הַיְלָדִ֗ים

“Then let our appearances be seen to your face, and the appearance of the youths”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **appearances** and **appearance**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [Then call us before you to see how we look and how the youths look after they have been]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 1:15 (#1)

נִרְאָ֣ה מַרְאֵיהֶ֔ם

“their appearances, it was seen”

The expression **it was seen** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [their faces looked]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 1:15 (#2)

וּבְרִיֵאי בָּשָׂר

“and fatter of flesh”

The author is using **fatter of flesh** as a common expression of the culture to mean “healthier” or “better nourished.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and better nourished]

See: Idiom

Daniel 1:17 (#1)

וְהַיְלָדִים הָאֵ֣לֶּה אַרְבַּעְתָּ֗ם נָתַ֤ן לָהֶם֙ הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים

“And these four youths, God gave to them”

The author is stating the topic **these four youths** at the beginning of the sentence and then referring back to them with the pronoun **them**. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the four youths together with the information about what God gave to them. Alternate translation: [And God gave these four youths]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 1:18 (#1)

לִפְנֵי֙ נְבֻכַדְנֶאצַּ֔ר

“to the face of Nebuchadnezzar”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of Nebuchadnezzar. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into the presence of Nebuchadnezzar] or [in front of Nebuchadnezzar]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 1:19 (#1)

וְלֹ֥א נִמְצָ֖א

“and none was found”

The expression **was found** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he found none]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 1:19 (#2)

מִכֻּלָּ֑ם

“from all of them”

The pronoun **them** refers to all the young men whom the king had brought before him. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [from all of the other young men]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 1:20 (#1)

דְּבַר־ חָכְמַ֥ת בִּינָ֖ה

“matter of wisdom {and} understanding”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **wisdom** and **understanding**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [matter requiring them to be wise and to understand well]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 1:20 (#2)

עֶ֣עָשֶׂר יָדֹ֔ות עַ֖ל כָּל

“ten hands above all of”

The author is using **ten hands above** as a common expression of the culture to mean “ten times better than.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [ten times better than all of]

See: Idiom

Daniel 1:20 (#3)

הַחַרְטֻמִּ֣ים׀ הָאַשָּׁפִ֗ים

“the magicians {and} enchanters”

The terms **magicians** and **enchanters** describe people who claimed to have secret knowledge and the ability to perform magic and interpret dreams and omens. If your readers would not be familiar with what these people did, you could use the names of similar people that your readers would recognize, or you could use more general terms. Alternate translation: [the people who practiced magic and claimed secret knowledge]

See: Translate Unknowns

Daniel 1:21 (#1)

עַד־ שְׁנַ֥ת אַחַ֖ת לְכ֣וֹרֶשׁ הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“until the year of one to Cyrus the king”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **one**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [until the first year that Cyrus was king]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Nebuchadnezzar has a troubling dream that he cannot remember (1)
2. His advisors fail to tell him the dream, so he orders their execution (2–13)
3. Daniel appeals for time, and God shows him the dream (14–19)
4. Daniel praises God (20–23)
5. Daniel tells Nebuchadnezzar his dream and its meaning (24–45)
6. Nebuchadnezzar rewards Daniel and his friends (46–49)

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry in Daniel's prayer of thanksgiving in 2:20–23.

Daniel 2:1 (#1)

וּבִשְׁנַ֣ת שְׁתַּ֔יִם

"And in the year of two"

The expression **year of two** uses a cardinal number where your language might use an ordinal number, since it refers to the second year of the reign of Nebuchadnezzar. If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **two**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [In the second year]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel 2:1 (#2)

חָלַ֤ם נְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר֙ חֲלֹמ֔וֹת

"Nebuchadnezzar dreamed dreams"

Daniel is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [Nebuchadnezzar dreamed]

See: Poetry

Daniel 2:1 (#3)

חָלַ֤ם נְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר֙ חֲלֹמ֔וֹת וַתִּתְפָּ֥עֶם רוּחֹ֖ו

"Nebuchadnezzar dreamed dreams. And his spirit was troubled"

The expression **his spirit was troubled** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And this troubled his spirit]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:1 (#4)

וּשְׁנָתֹ֖ו נִהְיְתָ֣ה עָלָֽיו

"and his sleep finished for him"

Daniel is using **his sleep finished for him** as a common expression of the culture to mean that Nebuchadnezzar was unable to sleep. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he could not sleep]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:2 (#1)

לַחַרְטֻמִּ֣ים וְלָאַשָּׁפִ֔ים וְלַמְכַשְּׁפִ֖ים

"the magicians and the enchanters and the sorcerers"

The terms **magicians**, **enchanters**, and **sorcerers** are different kinds of people who were thought to have special knowledge or powers, such as interpreting dreams, using magic, or communicating with spirits. If your readers would not be familiar with what these are, you could use the names of similar people that your readers would recognize, or you could use more general terms. Alternate translation: [the users of magic and the spell-casters and the fortune-tellers]

See: Translate Unknowns

Daniel 2:2 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֣י הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ

"to the face of the king"

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of the king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of the king]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 2:3 (#1)

חֲלֹלְוֹם חֶלֶמְתִּי

“I have dreamed a dream”

Nebuchadnezzar is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [I dreamed]

See: Poetry

Daniel 2:3 (#2)

וַתִּפְפָּעֶם רוּחִי

“and my spirit is troubled”

The expression **is troubled** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and it troubles my spirit]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:4 (#1)

לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי

“live forever”

The Chaldeans are using **live forever** as a common expression of the culture to mean “may you live for a long time.” It was a respectful way to greet a king. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [may you live for a long time]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:4 (#2)

לעבדיך

“to your servants”

The Chaldeans are speaking of themselves in the third person as **your servants** to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person. Alternate translation: [to us, your humble servants]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Daniel 2:4 (#3)

וּפִשְׁרָא נְחַוֵּא

“and we will show the interpretation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and we will interpret it for you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:5 (#1)

וְאָמַר

“and was saying”

The expression **and was saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly, here and in its many other occurrences in this book.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Daniel 2:5 (#2)

מִלְּתָא מִנִּי אַזְדָּא

“The word from me {is} firm”

The king is using **The word from me is firm** as a common expression of the culture to mean “my decision is final.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [My decision is final]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:5 (#3)

וּפִשְׁרֵהּ

“and its interpretation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and interpret it for me]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:5 (#4)

הַדָּמִין תִּתְעַבְדוּן

“you will be made {into} limbs”

The expression **you will be made** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I will have your limbs cut off]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:5 (#5)

וּבָתֵּיכוֹן נְוָלִ֣י יִתְשָׂמֽוּן

“and your houses will be made a rubbish heap”

The expression **your houses will be made a rubbish heap** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and I will turn your houses into a rubbish heap]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:6 (#1)

וּפִשְׁרֵ֖הּ

“and its interpretation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and interpret it for me]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:6 (#2)

וִיקָ֖ר שַׂגִּ֑יא

“and great honor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of honor, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and I will honor you very much]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:7 (#1)

מַלְכָּ֣א חֶלְמָ֗א יֵֽאמַר֙ לְעַבְדָ֔וֹהִי

“Let the king tell the dream to his servants”

Even though the Chaldeans are addressing the king directly, they are speaking of him in the third person as **the king** and of themselves in the third person as **his servants** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form using the second person and the first person. Alternate translation: [O king, please tell us your servants the dream]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Daniel 2:7 (#2)

וּפִשְׁרָ֖ה נְהַחֲוֶֽה

“and we will show the interpretation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and we will interpret it for you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:8 (#1)

כָּל־קֳבֵ֗ל דִּ֤י

“all before that”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to the book of Daniel. In this context, the king is using it to indicate that what follows is the reason for what precedes. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:8 (#2)

עִדָּנָ֣א אִנְתּוּן֙ זָבְנִ֔ין

“you are buying time”

The king is using **you are buying time** as a common expression of the culture to mean “you are trying to gain more time.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are trying extend the time allotted]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:9 (#1)

חֲדָ֣ה־הִ֔יא דָּתְכוֹן֙

“your decree is one”

The king is using **your decree is one** as a common expression of the culture to mean “there is only one verdict for you all.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [there is only one verdict for you all]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:9 (#2)

עִדְּנָא֙ יִשְׁתַּנְּיָ֔א

“the time is changed”

The expression **the time is changed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [circumstances change]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:9 (#3)

פִּשְׁרֵ֖הּ תְּהַחֲוֵנָֽנִי

“you do show me its interpretation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [you interpret it correctly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:10 (#1)

אֱנָ֫שׁ

“a man”

The Chaldeans are not referring to a specific **man**. They mean people in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [anyone]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Daniel 2:10 (#2)

כָּל־קֳבֵ֥ל דִּ֛י

“all before that”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to the book of Daniel. In this context, the wise men are using it to indicate that what follows shows why what precedes is true. Alternate translation: [you may be sure of this because] or [after all,]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:11 (#1)

בִּשְׂרָ֖א

“flesh”

The Chaldeans are using **flesh** to represent human beings, who are mortal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [human beings]

See: Synecdoche

Daniel 2:12 (#1)

כָּל־קֳבֵ֣ל דְּנָ֔ה

“All before this”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to the book of Daniel. In this context, the author is using it to indicate that follows is the result of what he has just described. Alternate translation: [Because of this] or [As a result]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:12 (#2)

בְּנַ֤ס וּקְצָ֨ף

“became angry and became & furious”

The terms **became angry** and **became very furious** mean similar things. Daniel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [became extremely angry]

See: Doublet

Daniel 2:13 (#1)

וְחַכִּימַיָּ֖א מִתְקַטְּלִ֑ין

“that the wise men were to be killed”

The expression **the wise men were to be killed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that people should kill the wise men]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:13 (#2)

וּבְעָ֥וֹ דָנִיֵּ֛אל וְחַבְרָוֹהִ֖י לְהִתְקְטָלָֽה

“And they sought Daniel and his friends, to be killed”

The expression **to be killed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And they sought Daniel and his friends in order to kill them]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:14 (#1)

עֲטָא וּטְעֵם

“with prudence and discretion”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **prudence** and **discretion**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [prudently and discreetly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:14 (#2)

לְאַרְיֹוךְ

“to Arioch”

The word **Arioch** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 2:16 (#1)

וּפִשְׁרָא לְהַחֲוָיֵה לְמַלְכָּא

“that he might show the interpretation to the king”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [that he might explain to the king what the dream meant]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:18 (#1)

וְרַחֲמִין לְמִבְעֵאוּ

“that they might seek mercies”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **mercies**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [that they might seek to be treated mercifully]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:18 (#2)

רָזָה דְנָה

“this mystery”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **mystery**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was hidden] or [what they did not know]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:19 (#1)

לְדָנִיֵּאל & רָזָה גְלֵי

“the mystery was revealed to Daniel”

The expression **the mystery was revealed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God revealed the mystery to Daniel]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:20 (#1)

לֶהֱוֵא שְׁמֵהּ דִּי־אֱלָהָא מְבָרַךׁ

“May his name, of God, be blessed”

David is saying what he wants to happen. See the discussion in the introduction to this book about this form of speech, and follow the decision you have made as a team about how speakers will express in such contexts what they want to happen. Alternate translation: [I desire for God’s name to be blessed]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Daniel 2:20 (#2)

לֶהֱוֵא שְׁמֵהּ דִּי־אֱלָהָא מְבָרַךׁ

“May his name, of God, be blessed”

The expression **be blessed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [May people bless the name of God]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:20 (#3)

לֶהֱוֵא שְׁמֵהּ דִּי־אֱלָהָא מְבָרַךׁ

“May his name, of God, be blessed”

Daniel is using the term **name** to represent who God is or to refer to God’s reputation. Alternate translation: [May God be blessed]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 2:20 (#4)

שְׁמֵהּ דִּי־אֱלָהָא

“his name, of God”

“His name, of God” is a doubling of reference. The phrase names God twice, once by pronoun, “name,” and once explicitly as “God.” It might seem that the

expression **his name, of God** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [May God be blessed]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Daniel 2:20 (#5)

שְׁמֵ֣ה דִֽי־אֱלָהָ֔א

“his name, of God”

Here, **his name** represents God himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [God himself]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 2:20 (#6)

חָכְמְתָ֥א וּגְבוּרְתָ֖א

“wisdom and power”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **wisdom** and **power**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [being wise and being mighty]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:20 (#7)

מִן־עָלְמָ֥א וְעַד־עָלְמָֽא

“from eternity and to eternity”

Daniel is referring to all of time by naming two extremes, **from eternity** and **to eternity**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for all time]

See: Merism

Daniel 2:21 (#1)

הֱהֵ֣ב חָכְמְתָ֔א לְחַכִּימִ֖ין וּמַנְדְּעָ֑א לְיָדְעֵ֖י בִּינָֽה

“the one giving wisdom to the wise and knowledge to the knowers of understanding”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [the one giving wisdom and understanding to those who are wise]

See: Parallelism

Daniel 2:21 (#2)

לְחַכִּימִֽין

“to the wise”

Daniel is using the adjective **wise** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [to wise people] or [to those who are wise]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 2:21 (#3)

וּמַנְדְּעָ֖א לְיָדְעֵ֥י בִינָֽה

“and knowledge to the knowers of understanding”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **knowledge** and **understanding**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [and enabling those who can discern to know things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:21 (#4)

הֱהֵ֣ב חָכְמְתָ֔א לְחַכִּימִ֖ין וּמַנְדְּעָ֑א לְיָדְעֵ֖י בִּינָֽה

“the one giving wisdom to the wise and knowledge to the knowers of understanding”

This is poetic language. If your language has a way to indicate poetry, you could use it here.

See: Poetry

Daniel 2:22 (#1)

עַמִּיקָתָ֥א וּמְסַתְּרָתָ֖א

“the deep and the hidden”

Daniel is using the plural adjectives **the deep** and **the hidden** as nouns to mean certain kinds of things. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [deep things and hidden things]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 2:22 (#2)

עַמִּיקָתָ֥א וּמְסַתְּרָתָ֖א

“the deep and the hidden”

The terms **the deep** and **the hidden** mean similar things. Daniel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [things that are very difficult to know] or [things that are very obscure]

See: Doublet

Daniel 2:22 (#3)

יְדַעׂ מָמָה בַחֶשׁוֹכָא ונהירא עִמֵּהּ שְׁרֵא

“he knows what {is} in the darkness, and the light is lodged with him”

Daniel is speaking of hidden things as if they were **darkness** and of what God knows as if it were **light**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he knows what is secret, and understanding resides with him]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 2:23 (#1)

אֱלָהָהּ אֲבָהָתַי

“God of my fathers”

Daniel is speaking of his ancestors as if they were his **fathers**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God of my ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 2:23 (#2)

דִּי־בְעֵעֲינָא מִנָּךְ

“what we sought from you”

By **we**, Daniel means himself and his friends but not the one to whom he is speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Daniel 2:24 (#1)

כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה

“All before this”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to the book of Daniel. In this context, the author is using it to indicate that follows is the result of what he has just described. Alternate translation: [Consequently]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:25 (#1)

אֲמַר־לֳהּ דִּי

“he said to him, that”

The word **that** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Daniel 2:25 (#2)

בְּנֵי גָלוּתָאא דִּדַי יְהוּד דִּדַי

“the sons of the captivity of Judah who”

Arioch is using **the sons of the captivity of Judah** as a common expression of the culture to mean the people who had been taken away from Judah into exile. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the exiles from Judah who]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:25 (#3)

גָלוּתָאא דִּדַי יְהוּד דִּדַי

“the captivity of Judah who”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **captivity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [those captured from Judah who]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:25 (#4)

פִּשְׁרָא

“the interpretation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what the dream means]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:26 (#1)

בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר

“was Belteshazzar”

The word **Belteshazzar** is the Babylonian name given to Daniel.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 2:28 (#1)

בְּאַחֲרִית יוֹמַיָּיא

“at the end of days”

Daniel is using **at the end of days** as a common expression of the culture to mean a future time. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in days to come]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:28 (#2)

חֶלְמָךְ וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשָׁךְ

“Your dream and the visions of your head”

If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a connecting word or phrase to show that **Your dream and the visions of your head** explains what Daniel means when he says that God has made the king know what will happen in the future. Alternate translation: [Your dream, that is, the visions of your head]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Daniel 2:28 (#3)

וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשָׁךְ

“and the visions of your head”

Daniel is using **the visions of your head** as a common expression of the culture to mean the things that Nebuchadnezzar saw in his mind while he was dreaming. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the images you saw in your mind]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:29 (#1)

רַעְיוֹנָךְ

“your thoughts”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **thoughts**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what you were thinking]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:29 (#2)

רָזַיָּיא

“mysteries”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **mysteries**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [hidden things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:30 (#1)

רָזָא דְנָה גְּלֵלִי לְלֵי

“this mystery has been revealed to me”

The expression **this mystery has been revealed to me** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God has revealed this mystery to me]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:30 (#2)

מִן־כָּל־חַיַּיָּא

“more than all of the living”

Daniel is using the adjective **living** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [more than anyone else who is alive] or [more than any other human being]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 2:30 (#3)

לְמַלְכָּא יְהוֹדְעוּן

“they may make the king know”

The pronoun **they** does not refer to any specific people here. Daniel uses it in an indefinite way to mean that the interpretation would be made known to the king. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the king may come to know]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 2:30 (#4)

וְרַעְיוֹנֵי לִבְבָךְ

“the thoughts of your heart”

Daniel is speaking of the mind as if it were the **heart**, because the people of this culture associated thinking with the heart. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the thoughts of your mind]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 2:31 (#1)

וְרֵוָהּ דְּחִיל

“and its appearance was terrifying”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **appearance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and it looked terrifying]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:31 (#2)

וַאֲלוּ

“and behold”

Daniel is using the term **behold** to focus King Nebuchadnezzar’s attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [and look]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 2:31 (#3)

צַלְמָא דְּכֵן רַב וְזִיוֵהּ יַתִּיר

“This statue {was} great, and its splendor {was} exceeding”

The expression **was great and its splendor was exceeding** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [This statue was very large, and it gleamed with extraordinary splendor]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:31 (#4)

וְרֵוָהּ דְּחִיל

“and its appearance was terrifying”

The expression **its appearance was terrifying** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and it terrified those who saw it]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:32 (#1)

חֲדָהּוֹהִי וּדְרָעַוֹהִי דִּדֵּי כְסַף מְעַוֹהִי וְיַרְכָתַתֵּהּ דִּדֵּי נְחָשׁ

“its chest and arms, of silver; its belly and its thighs, of bronze”

Daniel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [its chest and arms were of silver; its belly and its thighs were of bronze]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 2:33 (#1)

שָׁקַקָוֹהִי דִּדֵּי פַּרְזֶלָּ רַגְלַּוֹהִי מִנְּהוֹן דִּדֵּי פַּרְזֶלָּ וּמִנְּהוֹן דִּדֵּי חֶסֶף

“its legs, of iron; its feet, some of them of iron and some of them of clay”

Daniel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. He means that its legs {were} of iron. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [its legs were of iron; some of its feet were of iron and some of them were of clay]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 2:34 (#1)

הִתְגְּזֶרֶת אֶבֶן

“a stone was cut out”

The expression **a stone was cut out** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone cut out a stone]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:34 (#2)

דִּי־לָ֫א בִידַ֥יִן

“but not by hands”

Here, **hands** represents the effort or action of human beings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [but not by human effort]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 2:35 (#1)

כְּעֹעַ֣ר מִן־אִדְּרֵי־קַ֔יִט

“like the chaff of the threshing floors of summer”

The point of this comparison is that just as **chaff** is light and easily blown away by the wind, so the crushed pieces of the statue were completely scattered and disappeared. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [as light and scattered as the chaff of the threshing floors of summer]

See: Simile

Daniel 2:35 (#2)

וְכָל־אֲתַ֖ר לָא־הִשְׁתְּכַ֣ח לְהֹ֑ון

“and any place was not found for them”

The expression **any place was not found for them** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and no one could find any trace of them]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:35 (#3)

הֲנָ֣ת לְטַ֔וּר רַ֖ב וּמְלָ֥ת כָּל־אַרְעָֽא

“became a great mountain, and it filled all of the earth”

Daniel is speaking of the kingdom that God will establish as if it were **a great mountain** that **filled all of the earth**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [grew into a kingdom that spread throughout the whole earth]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 2:36 (#1)

וּפִשְׁרֵ֖הּ נֵאמַ֥ר קֳדָם־מַלְכָּֽא

“And we will tell its interpretation before the king”

By **we**, Daniel means himself but not the king to whom he is speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Daniel 2:36 (#2)

וּפִשְׁרֵ֖הּ נֵאמַ֥ר קֳדָם־מַלְכָּֽא

“And we will tell its interpretation before the king”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And we will tell the king what it means]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:37 (#1)

מָרֵ֣א מַלְכַיָּ֔א

“are} the king of kings”

Daniel is using **the king of kings** as a common expression of the culture to mean a supreme king who rules over other kings. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are the greatest king, ruling over all other kings]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:37 (#2)

חִסְנָ֣א וְתָקְפָ֔א וְיִקְרָ֖א

“the power, the strength, and the glory”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **the power**, **the strength**, and **the glory**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [the ability to rule powerfully, to rule strongly, and to be honored greatly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:38 (#1)

בְּנֵי־אֲנָשָׁ֗א

“the sons of man”

Daniel is using **the sons of man** as a common expression of the culture to mean human beings in general. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [human beings]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:38 (#2)

חֵיוָ֣ת בָּרָ֔א וְעֹ֥וף־שְׁמַיָּ֖א

“the beast of the field, and the bird of the heavens”

Daniel is not referring to a specific **beast** or **bird**. He means beasts and birds in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the wild animals, and the birds of the sky]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Daniel 2:38 (#3)

בִּידָךְ

“into your hand”

Here, **your hand** represents your power and control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into your power]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 2:38 (#4)

אַנְתָּה־הוּא רֵאשָׁהּ דִּי דַהֲבָא

“You are the head of gold”

Daniel is speaking of Nebuchadnezzar as if he were the head of gold on the statue. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You are like the head of gold]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 2:39 (#1)

ארעא מִנָּךְ

“earthward from you”

Here, **earthward from you** represents being inferior. since the earth is generally below people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [inferior to you]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 2:40 (#1)

תַּקִּיפָה כְּפַרְזְלָא

“strong as iron”

The point of this comparison is that just as **iron** is strong and crushes other things, so **a fourth kingdom** will be strong and will crush the kingdoms before it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [strong just as iron is strong]

See: Simile

Daniel 2:40 (#2)

כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּדֵי & כָּל

“all before that & all of”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to the book of Daniel. In this context, Daniel is using it to indicate that the first part of this sentence is equivalent to the second part. Alternate translation: [just as]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:41 (#1)

נִצְבְּתָא דִּדֵי פַּרְזְלָא

“the firmness of iron”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **firmness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how firm iron is]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 2:41 (#2)

וּמִן־נִצְבְּתָא דִּדֵי פַּרְזְלָא לֶהֱוֵא־בַּהּ

“For some of the firmness of iron will be in it”

The expression **For some of the firmness of iron will be in it** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [This kingdom will have some of the strength of iron in it]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:41 (#3)

כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּדֵי

“all before that”

See how you translated this expression in the similar context in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [just as]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:42 (#1)

וְאָצְבְּעָת֣ רַגְלַיָּ֗א מנהון פַּרְזֶ֤ל ומנהון חֲסַף֙ מִן־קְצָ֣ת מַלְכוּתָ֔א תֶּהֱוֶ֖ה תַּקִּיפָ֑ה וּמִנַּ֣הּ תֶּהֱוֶ֔ה תְּבִירָ֖ה

“And {as} the toes of the feet, some of them {were} iron and some of them {were} clay, some of the kingdom will be strong and some of it will be brittle”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the toes of the feet** were **some iron and some clay**, so is the kingdom composed of both strong and brittle elements. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [Just as the toes of the feet were partly iron and partly clay, so will some of the kingdom be strong and some of it will be brittle]

See: Simile

Daniel 2:42 (#2)

מנהון פְּרְזֶ֫ל ומנהון חֲסַ֥ף

“some of them {were} iron and some of them {were} clay”

In each part of the verse, you could put the **clay** before the **iron** in order to put the new information before the old information. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Information Structure

Daniel 2:43 (#1)

מִתְעָרְבִ֣ין לֶהֱוֹן֮

“they will be mixing themselves”

The pronoun **they** refers to the people of the divided kingdom, that is, its rulers. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the rulers of the divided kingdom will be mixing themselves]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 2:43 (#2)

בִּזְרַ֣ע אֲנָשָׁ֑א

“by the seed of man”

Daniel is speaking of human descendants as if they were **seed** that a man plants. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [through their offspring]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 2:43 (#3)

הֵא־כְדִ֣י פַרְזְלָ֗א לָ֤א מִתְעָרַב֙ עִם־חַסְפָּ֔א

“even as iron does not mix itself with clay”

The point of this comparison is that just as **iron** does not mix itself with **clay**, so the rulers of this kingdom will not remain united with one another. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [just as iron does not stay mixed with clay, so those rulers will not remain united]

See: Simile

Daniel 2:44 (#1)

מַלְכוּ֙ דִּ֣י לְעָלְמִ֔ין לָ֥א תִתְחַבַּ֖ל

“a kingdom that will not be destroyed to eternities”

The expression **a kingdom that will not be destroyed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a kingdom that no one will ever destroy]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:44 (#2)

ומַלְכוּתָ֗ה לְעַ֤ם אָחֳרָן֙ לָ֣א תִשְׁתְּבֻ֔ק

“and the kingdom will not be left to another people”

The expression **the kingdom will not be left to another people** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and no other people will take over the kingdom]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:44 (#3)

וְהִ֥יא תְקַ֖ום לְעָלְמִֽין׃

“but it, it will stand to eternities”

Daniel is stating the pronoun **it** separately, even though the verb translated as **it will stand** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that this kingdom, unlike the kingdoms that came before it, will endure forever. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [but God’s kingdom will stand forever]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 2:45 (#1)

מִטּוּרָא אִתְגְּזָרַת אֶבֶן דִּי־לָ֫א בִידַ֥יִן

“a stone was cut from a mountain, but not by hands”

Daniel is speaking of the kingdom that God will establish as if it were a stone that was cut from a mountain, but not by hands. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God set up a kingdom, pictured as a stone cut from a mountain but not by human hands]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 2:45 (#2)

מִטּוּרָא אִתְגְּזָרַת אֶבֶן

“a stone was cut from a mountain”

The expression **a stone was cut from a mountain** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone cut a stone from a mountain]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:45 (#3)

וּמְהֵימַ֥ן פִּשְׁרֵֽהּ

“and its interpretation {is} confirmed”

The expression **confirmed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and God has confirmed what it means]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 2:46 (#1)

נְפַ֣ל עַל־אַנְפּ֔וֹהִי

“fell on his face”

Falling on his face was a symbolic action by which Nebuchadnezzar showed great honor and reverence toward Daniel. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [bowed down to the ground to show honor]

See: Symbolic Action

Daniel 2:47 (#1)

אֱלָ֣הּ אֱלָהֲי֗ן וּמָרֵ֤א מַלְכִ֙ין

“the God of gods and the Lord of kings”

The king is using **the God of gods and the Lord of kings** as a common expression of the culture to mean that Daniel’s God is supreme over all other gods and over all kings. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [supreme over all other gods and over all kings]

See: Idiom

Daniel 2:48 (#1)

וְרַב־סַגְּנַ֣יָּ֔ן

“and chief of the governors”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he made him chief of the governors]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 2:49 (#1)

וְדָנִיֵּ֖אל בְּתַרְעָ֣ע מַלְכָּֽא

“But Daniel {was} at the gate of the king”

Here, **the gate of the king** represents the king’s court, where officials carried out the business of the government. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [But Daniel remained at the royal court]

See: Metonymy

Daniel - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Nebuchadnezzar orders his officials to worship his golden statue (1–7)
2. Officials report Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego for not worshiping (8–12)
3. Nebuchadnezzar threatens them, but they refuse (13–18)
4. Nebuchadnezzar has them thrown into a very hot furnace (19–23)

5. God sends an angel to rescue them (24–27)
6. Nebuchadnezzar honors God and promotes them (28–30)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Nebuchadnezzar make a statue covered completely with gold?

When Daniel interprets Nebuchadnezzar's dream in chapter 2, he explains that the parts of the statue in his dream that were made of different metals represented different empires. Nebuchadnezzar's Babylonian empire was the head of gold. The dream, which Daniel said God gave Nebuchadnezzar to show him what would happen in the future, indicated that this empire would end and others would succeed it. By building a great statue like the one in his dream but covering it all in gold, Nebuchadnezzar was asserting instead that his empire would never end. Bowing down to the statue was an act of agreeing with him and disagreeing with what God had said in the dream. In many places, the law of Moses already forbade Israelites to bow down to any idols (for example, in the Ten Commandments in Exodus 20:4–5). But this was a further reason why these Judean young men had to refuse to worship the statue even if they were executed as a result.

Why does this chapter not describe Daniel refusing to worship the statue?

This chapter only describes Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego refusing to worship Nebuchadnezzar's golden statue. However, readers should not infer from this that Daniel did worship it. The last verse of the previous chapter, which provides a transition into this chapter, says that Nebuchadnezzar "appointed Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego over the work of the province of Babylon. But Daniel was at the gate of the king." In other words, Daniel remained at the royal court, while his three friends had responsibilities out in the province of Babylon, and that is where Nebuchadnezzar set up his statue (3:1). So Daniel was not among the provincial officials who were summoned to the dedication of the statue. His actions in the rest of the book (for example, in chapter 6, where he continues to pray to God even though he would be executed for doing this) show that if he had been summoned, he too would have refused to worship the statue.

Daniel 3:1 (#1)

אַמִּ֤ין שִׁתִּין֙ פְּתָיֵ֔הּ אַמִּ֖ין שְׁשָׁ֥ת

"was} sixty cubits. Its width {was} six cubits"

These **cubits** were a unit of measurement corresponding to the distance between an average person's elbow and middle fingertip, or about 46 centimeters or 18 inches. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express these measurements in modern units, either in the text or a footnote. Alternate translation: [about 27 meters. Its width {was} about 2.7 meters]

See: Biblical Distance

Daniel 3:1 (#2)

בְּבִקְעַ֥ת דּוּרָ֖א

"on the Plain of Dura"

The word **Dura** is the name of a plain.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 3:2 (#1)

לְאַחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּ֑א

"the satraps"

These **satraps** were provincial governors of the highest rank in the Babylonian Empire. If your readers would not be familiar with what satraps were, you could use the name of a similar kind of official that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the highest provincial officials]

See: Translate Unknowns

Daniel 3:2 (#2)

לַחֲנֻכַּ֥ת צַלְמָ֖א

"to the dedication of the statue"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **dedication**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to dedicate the statue]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 3:4 (#1)

קָרֵ֖א בְּחָ֑יִל

"called out in strength"

Daniel is using **called out in strength** as a common expression of the culture to mean "loudly." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [called out with a loud voice]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:4 (#2)

לְכוֹן אֱמְרִין

“One is commanding you”

The pronoun **One** refers to King Nebuchadnezzar. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [King Nebuchadnezzar is commanding you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 3:4 (#3)

עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָׁנַיָּא

“peoples, nations, and languages”

Here, **languages** represents the people who speak those languages. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [peoples, nations, and speakers of every language]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 3:5 (#1)

סַבְּכָא פְּסַנְתֵּרִין סוּמְפֹּנְיָה

“trigon, harp, bagpipe”

A **trigon**, a **harp**, and a **bagpipe** were kinds of musical instruments. If your readers would not be familiar with what these instruments were, you could use the names of similar instruments that your readers would recognize, or you could use more general terms. Alternate translation: [two kinds of stringed instruments and a wind instrument]

See: Translate Unknowns

Daniel 3:5 (#2)

תִּפְלְלוּן וְתִסְגְּדוּן

“you shall fall down and worship”

By **fall down and worship**, the herald means to lie facedown on the ground as an act of worship. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you shall bow down to the ground and worship]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 3:6 (#1)

וּמַן־דִּי־לָא יִפֹּל וְיִסְגֻּד

“But who that does not fall down and worship”

The herald is not referring to a specific person with the phrase **who that does not fall down and worship**. He means anyone at all who does not do this. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But anyone at all who does not fall down and worship]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Daniel 3:6 (#2)

יִתְרְמֵא לְגוֹא־אַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא

“he will be thrown into the midst of a furnace of blazing fire”

The expression **he will be thrown** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the king’s officials will throw him into the midst of a furnace of blazing fire]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 3:7 (#1)

כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה

“All before this”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to the book of Daniel. In this context, the author is using it to indicate that follows is the result of what he has just described. Alternate translation: [As a result]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:7 (#2)

קַרְנָא מַשְׁרוֹקִיתָא קִיתְרֹס שַׂבְּכָא פְּסַנְטֵרִין

“the horn, pipe, lyre, trigon, harp”

Some ancient manuscripts do not include the term “bagpipe” at the end of the list of instruments here. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts include the term, as in verses 5, 10, and 15. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Daniel 3:8 (#1)

כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה

“All before this”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to the book of Daniel. In this context, the author is using it to indicate that follows is the result of what he has just described. Alternate translation: [Consequently]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:8 (#2)

גֶּבְרִין כַּשְׂדָּאֵין

“men, Chaldeans”

Daniel is using the phrase **men, Chaldeans** to introduce a group of Chaldeans as new participants in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [certain Chaldeans]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 3:8 (#3)

וַאֲכַלוּ קַרְצֵיהֹון דִּבְנֵי יְהוּדָיֵא

“and ate the pieces of the Jews”

The author is using **ate the pieces of the Jews** as a common expression of the culture to mean “brought malicious accusations against the Jews.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and brought malicious accusations against the Jews] or [and maliciously accused the Jews]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:9 (#1)

עֲנוֹ וְאָמְרִין

“They answered and were saying”

The Chaldeans had not been asked a question, but Daniel uses the expression **They answered and were saying** to introduce their speech. Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Daniel 3:9 (#2)

לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי

“live to eternities”

The Chaldeans are using **live to eternities** as a common expression of the culture to mean “may you live for a very long time.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [may you live many years]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:12 (#1)

גֻּבְרִין יְהוּדָאיִן

“men, Jews”

The Chaldeans are identifying Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego as Jews. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [certain Jews]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 3:12 (#2)

גֻּבְרַיָּיא אִלֵּךְ לָא־שָׂשְׂמוּ עֲלַיִךְ & טְעֵם

“These men do not set regard on you”

The Chaldeans are using **do not set regard on you** as a common expression of the culture to mean “do not respect you” or “do not obey you.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [These men do not respect you] or [These men do not obey you]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:13 (#1)

בִּרְגַז וַחֲמָה

“in rage and heat”

The terms **rage** and **heat** mean similar things. Daniel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [in furious anger]

See: Doublet

Daniel 3:15 (#1)

תִּפְלְחוּן וְתִסְגְּדוּן לְצַלְמָא דִּי־עֲבַדְתּ֑ וְהֵן לָ֣א תִסְגְּדוּן

“you fall down and worship the statue that I have made; but if you do not worship”

Nebuchadnezzar is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [you fall down and worship the

statue that I have made, then I will not punish you for not doing this before; but if you do not worship]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 3:15 (#2)

וּמַן־הוּא אֱלָהׇה דִּ֣י יְשֵׁיזְבִנְכוֹן מִן־יְדִֽי

“And who is the god who will deliver you from my hand”

Nebuchadnezzar is using the question form to assert that no god will be able to rescue Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego from his power. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [And there is no god who will deliver you from my hand!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Daniel 3:15 (#3)

יְדִֽי

“my hand”

Here, **my hand** represents Nebuchadnezzar’s power to punish them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [my control]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 3:17 (#1)

הֵ֣ן אִיתַ֔י

“If it is”

Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego are using **If it is** as a common expression of the culture to mean “if that happens,” referring to their being thrown into the furnace. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [If we are thrown into the furnace] or [If that is what happens]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:17 (#2)

יְדָ֣ךְ

“your hand”

Here, **your hand** represents the king’s power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [your control]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 3:18 (#1)

וְהֵ֣ן לָ֗א

“But if not”

Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [But if he does not deliver us]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 3:18 (#2)

יְדִ֣יעַ לָ֭הֱוֵא־לָ֣ךְ

“may it be known to you”

The expression **may it be known to you** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you should know]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 3:19 (#1)

הִתְמְלִ֤י חֱמָא֙

“was filled {with} heat”

Daniel is using **was filled {with} heat** as a common expression of the culture to mean “became furious.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [became furious]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:19 (#2)

חַ֠ד־שִׁבְעָ֨ה עַ֜ל דִּ֣י חֲזָ֗ה לְמִזְיֵ֔הּ

“one seven more than had been seen to heat it”

Daniel is using **one seven more** as a common expression of the culture to mean “seven times hotter” than it was usually heated. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [seven times hotter]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:19 (#3)

דִּ֣י חֱזֵ֔ה לְמֵזְיֵ֖הּ

“than had been seen to heat it”

Daniel is using the phrase **than had been seen to heat it** as a common expression of the culture to mean “more than it had ever been heated before.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [than it had ever been heated before]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:19 (#4)

דִּ֣י חֱזֵ֔ה לְמֵזְיֵ֖הּ

“than had been seen to heat it”

The expression **had been seen** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [than anyone had seen anyone heat it]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 3:19 (#5)

חַ֠ד־שִׁבְעָ֞ה עַ֣ל דִּ֤י חֱזֵה֙ לְמֵזְיֵ֔הּ

“one seven more than had been seen to heat it”

Here, **seven** might not be an exact number. It may represent completion. Alternate translation: [as many times hotter as possible, hotter than it had ever been heated before]

See: Numbers

Daniel 3:20 (#1)

וּלְגֶ֣בָרִ֔ין גִּבָּרֵי־חַ֖יִל֑ & אֲמַ֖ר

“And he told men, men of valor”

The author is using the expression **men, men of valor** to introduce these new participants in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [certain men of valor] or [certain strong soldiers]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 3:21 (#1)

פטישיהון

“their tunics”

The term that the ULT translates as **tunics** refers to some kind of inner garment that people of this culture wore under their **cloaks**. Some interpreters understand it to mean “trousers.” However, since the exact meaning is uncertain, you may wish to use a general phrase in your translation. Alternate translation: [their inner garments]

See: Translate Unknowns

Daniel 3:22 (#1)

כָּל־קֳבֵ֣ל דְּנָ֔ה

“All before this”

The author is using **All before this** as a common expression of the culture to mean “because of this” or “on account of this.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Because of this] or [For this reason]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:25 (#1)

הָ֣א

“Behold”

Nebuchadnezzar is using the term **Behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Look]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 3:25 (#2)

וְרֵוֵ֖הּ דִּדְּי רביעיא

“And the appearance of the fourth”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **appearance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And the fourth one]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 3:25 (#3)

לְבַר־אֱלָהִ֖ין

“a son of the gods”

Nebuchadnezzar is using **a son of the gods** as a common expression of the culture to mean “a god.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your

readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a god]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:26 (#1)

עַבְדָּוֹהִי דִּי־אֱלָהָא עִלָּיָא

“his servants of the Most High God”

It might seem that saying **his** in addition to the possessive phrase with **of** would be to express extra information in a way that would not be natural in your language. If so, you can shorten this expression. Alternate translation: [servants of the Most High God]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Daniel 3:27 (#1)

לָא־שְׁלֵטַת נוּרָא בִּגְשְׁמְהוֹן

“the fire had not ruled over their bodies”

Daniel is speaking of **the fire** as if it were a living thing that could rule over the men’s bodies. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the fire had not damaged their bodies]

See: Personification

Daniel 3:28 (#1)

בְּרִיךְ אֱלָהֲהוֹן דִּי־שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגֹוֹ

“Blessed {be} the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego”

Nebuchadnezzar is praising God when he says **Blessed {be} the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego**. In your translation, use a form that people would recognize as an expression of praise or blessing in your language. You might express this as a declaration of praise, if that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [May the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego be praised]

See: Blessings

Daniel 3:28 (#2)

וְיַהֲבוּ גשמיהון

“and gave up their bodies”

Nebuchadnezzar is using **gave up their bodies** as a common expression of the culture to mean “were willing to die.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and were willing to die]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:29 (#1)

וּמִנִּי שְׁתִ֫ישַׁת טְעֵם

“And from me a decree is set”

The expression **And from me a decree is set** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And I am setting forth this decree]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 3:29 (#2)

שלה

“anything”

The phrase **anything** is a translation of the standard written Hebrew text as we have it today. There is, however, a correction, “anything wrong,” in the margin of the text that Hebrew scribes have recommended. You may want to follow this correction in your translation, or you may want to follow the major translation in your area.

See: Alternative Readings

Daniel 3:29 (#3)

הַדָּמְמִין יִתְעֲבֵד וּבֵיתֵהּ נְוָלִי יִשְׁתַּוֵּה

“will be made {into} limbs and its house be made a rubbish heap”

The expressions **will be made {into} limbs** and **its house be made a rubbish heap** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I will have my soldiers cut them into limbs and make their house a rubbish heap]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 3:29 (#4)

הַדָּמְמִין יִתְעֲבֵד

“will be made {into} limbs”

Nebuchadnezzar is using **will be made {into} limbs** as a common expression of the culture to mean “be cut into pieces.” If this phrase does not have that

meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be cut into pieces]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:29 (#5)

כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּדִי

“all before that”

Nebuchadnezzar is using **all before that** as a common expression of the culture to mean “because.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [seeing that] or [because]

See: Idiom

Daniel 3:29 (#6)

וּבַיְתֵהּ נְוָלִי יִשְׁתַּוֵּה

“and its house be made a rubbish heap”

Nebuchadnezzar is speaking as if the offender’s house were **a rubbish heap**. He means that it will be completely destroyed and reduced to ruins. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and its house be completely destroyed]

See: Metaphor

Daniel - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter consists of a letter that King Nebuchadnezzar wrote to all the subjects in his empire. In this letter, he relates an experience he had that taught him that God, whom he calls “the Most High” and “the king of the heavens,” determines what people will reign over earthly kingdoms and for how long.

1. The greeting at the start of the letter (1–3)
2. Nebuchadnezzar has a dream and asks Daniel to interpret it (4–18)
3. Daniel explains the meaning of the dream (19–27)
4. What the dream depicted happens to Nebuchadnezzar (28–36)
5. The closing of the letter (37)

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry in 4:3 and 4:34–35.

The tree as the king

The great tree of the dream represents Nebuchadnezzar himself (verse 22); keep the imagery while letting the interpretation identify him.

Daniel 4:1 (#1)

עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָׁנַיָּא

“the peoples, nations, and languages”

The terms **peoples**, **nations**, and **languages** mean similar things. Nebuchadnezzar is using the three terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the many different people groups]

See: Doublet

Daniel 4:1 (#2)

וְלִשָׁנַיָּא

“and languages”

Here, **languages** represents the people who speak them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and language groups]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 4:1 (#3)

שְׁלָמְכוֹן יִשְׂגֵּא

“May your peace abound”

This is a conventional greeting at the start of a letter that expresses the hope that all is well with the recipients. (The term **peace** has the sense of “welfare” here.) Use the equivalent greeting from your culture. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Politeness

Daniel 4:3 (#1)

אָתְּתֹוהִי כְּמָה רַבְרְבִין וְתִמְהֲהֹוהִי כְּמָה תַקִּיפִין

“How great {are} his signs, and how mighty {are} his wonders”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine

them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [How very great and mighty are his miraculous signs!]

See: Parallelism

Daniel 4:3 (#2)

מַלְכוּתֵהּ מַלְכוּת עָלַם

“His kingdom {is} a kingdom of eternity”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **kingdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [He rules as king forever]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 4:3 (#3)

מַלְכוּתֵהּ מַלְכוּת עָלַם וְשָׁלְטָנֵהּ עִם־דְּדָר וְדָר

“His kingdom {is} a kingdom of eternity, and his dominion {is} with generation and generation”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Another approach would be to connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. See how you as a team have decided to translate the parallel phrases in poetry, and follow that approach here and throughout this chapter. Alternate translation: [His kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, indeed, he rules over people from generation to generation]

See: Parallelism

Daniel 4:3 (#4)

עִם־דְּדָר וְדָר

“is} with generation and generation”

Nebuchadnezzar is using the phrase **with generation and generation** as a common expression of the culture to mean “for all generations” or “forever.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [continuing throughout all generations]

See: Idiom

Daniel 4:4 (#1)

אֲנָנָה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר שְׁלֵוָה הֲוֵיתִ֫י בְּבֵיתִ֫י וְרַעֲנַן בְּהֵיכְלִי

“I, Nebuchadnezzar, was being secure in my house and prosperous in my palace”

Here Nebuchadnezzar is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Daniel 4:4 (#2)

בְּבֵיתִ֫י

“in my house”

In this context, **house** may represent “royal house” or “kingdom.” The UST follows that interpretation.

See: Metaphor

Daniel 4:5 (#1)

חֵלֶם חֲזֵית וִידַחֲלִנֵּנִי וְהַרְהֹרִין עַל־מִשְׁכְּבִי וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי יְבַהֲלֻנָּנִי

“I saw a dream and it frightened me. And the thoughts upon my bed and the visions of my head alarmed me”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Another approach would be to connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. See how you as a team have decided to translate the parallel phrases in poetry, and follow that approach here and throughout this chapter. Alternate translation: [I saw a dream that terrified and alarmed me as I lay on my bed]

See: Parallelism

Daniel 4:5 (#2)

וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי

“and the visions of my head”

Nebuchadnezzar is using the phrase **the visions of my head** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the things that he saw while he was dreaming.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you

could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the things I saw in my dream]

See: Idiom

Daniel 4:6 (#1)

וּמִנִּי שִׁשָּׂים טְעֵם

“And a decree was set from me”

The expression **was set** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And I set a decree]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 4:6 (#2)

פְּשַׁשַׁר חֶלְמָא

“the interpretation of the dream”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what the dream signified]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 4:8 (#1)

אֲתֵרַיִּן עַל־קָדָמַי דָּנִיֵּאל

“another came in before me, Daniel”

Here Nebuchadnezzar is introducing **Daniel** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [a man named Daniel came in before me]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 4:8 (#2)

דִּי־שְׁמֵהּ בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר כְּשֻׁם אֱלָהִי

“whose name {is} Belteshazzar, according to the name of my god”

The word **Belteshazzar** is the Babylonian name that Nebuchadnezzar gave to Daniel, based on the name of one of his own gods.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 4:8 (#3)

רוּחַ־אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין

“is} the spirit of the holy gods”

Nebuchadnezzar is using the possessive form to describe a **spirit** that is characterized by **the holy gods**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a divine spirit from the holy gods]

See: Possession

Daniel 4:9 (#1)

בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר רַב חַרְטֻמַּיָּא

“Belteshazzar, chief of the magicians”

Nebuchadnezzar begins to report the words that he spoke to Daniel without using a verb such as “said” to introduce them. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Daniel 4:9 (#2)

חֶזְוֵי חֶלְמִי

“the visions of my dream”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **visions**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [tell me what I saw in my dream]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 4:9 (#3)

וּפִשְׁרֵהּ

“and its interpretation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and tell me what it means]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 4:10 (#1)

וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי

“And the visions of my head”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **visions**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what I saw in my mind]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 4:10 (#2)

חָזֵה הֲוֵית וַאֲלוּ אִילָנ בְּגוֹא אַרְעָא

“I was looking, and behold, a tree in the midst of the earth”

Nebuchadnezzar is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. He means that he saw a tree in his vision. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I was looking, and listen, I saw a tree in the midst of the earth]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 4:10 (#3)

וְאֵלּוּ

“and behold”

Nebuchadnezzar is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [I saw]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 4:11 (#1)

רְבָבָה & וּתְקִקָף

“became great, and it became strong”

The terms **became great** and **it became strong** mean similar things. Nebuchadnezzar is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [became very great]

See: Doublet

Daniel 4:11 (#2)

וְרוֹמֵהּ יְמָטֵא לִשְׁמַיָּא וַחֲזוֹתֵהּ לְסוֹף כָּל־אַרְעָא

“and its height reached to the heavens, and its sight, to the end of all of the earth”

Nebuchadnezzar says **its height reached to the heavens, and its sight, to the end of all of the earth** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and it grew extremely tall, and it could be seen from very far away]

See: Hyperbole

Daniel 4:12 (#1)

וּמִנֵּהּ יִתְזַן כָּל־בִּשְׂרָא

“and all flesh was fed from it”

The expression **was fed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and all flesh got food from it]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 4:12 (#2)

כָּל־בִּשְׂרָא

“all flesh”

Nebuchadnezzar is using **all flesh** to represent all living creatures. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [every living creature]

See: Synecdoche

Daniel 4:13 (#1)

חָזֵה הֲוַיִת בְּחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי עַל־מִשְׁכְּבְיִ

“I was looking in the visions of my head upon my bed”

Nebuchadnezzar is using **I was looking in the visions of my head upon my bed** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I was dreaming.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I was dreaming] or [Images passed through my mind as I lay sleeping]

See: Idiom

Daniel 4:13 (#2)

וַאֲלוּ

“and behold”

Nebuchadnezzar is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [I saw]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 4:13 (#3)

עִיר וְקַדִּישׁ

“a watcher and a holy {one”

This expression describes a holy being who watches (waits) for instructions from God, that is, a holy angel, as in the UST.

See: Hendiadys

Daniel 4:14 (#1)

וְכֵן אָמַר גְּזַרוּ אִילָנָא

“and thus he was saying, ‘Cut down the tree”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and thus he was ordering them to cut down the tree]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Daniel 4:14 (#2)

תְּנֵנֵד חֵיוְתָאא מִן־תַּחְתּוֹהִי וְצִפְּרַיָּא מִן־עַנְפוֹהִי

“Let the beast flee from beneath it, and the birds, from its branches”

The watcher is saying what he wants the beast and the birds to do. See the discussion in the introduction to this book about “let” and “may” and follow the decision of your team of how a speaker will express in this context what he wants someone to do. Alternate translation: [The beast must flee from beneath it, and the birds, from its branches]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Daniel 4:14 (#3)

וְצִפְּרַיָּא מִן־עַנְפוֹהִי

“and the birds, from its branches”

The watcher is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and let the birds flee from its branches]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 4:14 (#4)

גְּזַרוּ אִילָנָא וְקַצְּצוּ עַנְפּוֹהִי אַתַּתְּרוּ עָפְיֵיהּ וּבַדְּדָרוּ אִנְבֵּבֵהּ תְּנֵנֵד חֵיוְתָאא מִן־תַּחְתּוֹהִי וְצִפְּרַיָּא מִן־עַנְפוֹהִי

“Cut down the tree and cut off its branches, shake off its foliage, and scatter its fruit. Let the beast flee from beneath it, and the birds, from its branches”

The implied word “you” in these commands is plural because the watcher is addressing the other heavenly beings who carry out his commands, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Daniel 4:15 (#1)

שְׁבֻקוּ

“leave”

The word “you” is implied in the command **leave** and is plural here because the watcher is speaking to the other heavenly beings, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Daniel 4:15 (#2)

וּבֶאֱסוּרַ דִּי־פַרְזֶלָ וּנְחָשׁ

“and with a band of iron and bronze”

The purpose of this **band** was to prevent the heat of the sun from splitting the tree and killing it completely. If the stump remained intact, it might send out new shoots. If your readers would not be familiar with the practice of banding a tree stump, you could explain it in the text of your translation or in a footnote.

See: Translate Unknowns

Daniel 4:15 (#3)

בְּדִתְאָא & בַּעֲשַׂשְׂבָ

“in the grass & in the grass of”

The second instance of “grass” refers to grass in general. The first instance of “grass” refers to new grass or tender grass, that is, grass that has just started growing. If your language has its own term for this, it would be appropriate to use it here in your translation, here and in verse 23.

See: Translate Unknowns

Daniel 4:15 (#4)

וּבְטַלָּ שְׁמַיָּא יִצְטַבַּע

“And let it be wet with the dew of the heavens”

The expression **be wet** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And let the dew of the heavens make it wet]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 4:16 (#1)

לִבְבֵהּ֙ מִן־אנושא יְשַׁנּ֔וֹן וּלְבַבַ֖ חֵיוָ֣ה יִתְיְהִ֑בָ וְשִׁבְעָ֥ה עִדְנִ֖ין יַחְלְפ֥וּן עֲלֽוֹהִי

“Let his heart be changed from a man, and let the heart of a beast be given to him, and let seven times pass over him”

The watcher is saying what he wants to happen to the man represented by the tree. See the discussion in the introduction to this book about “let” and “may” and follow the decision of your team of how a speaker will express in this context what he wants someone to do. Alternate translation: [I desire that his heart be changed from a man and that the heart of a beast be given to him and that seven times pass over him] or [His heart should be changed from a man’s, and the heart of a beast should be given to him, and seven years should pass over him]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Daniel 4:16 (#2)

לִבְבֵהּ֙ מִן־אנושא יְשַׁנּ֔וֹן וּלְבַבַ֖ חֵיוָ֣ה יִתְיְהִ֑בָ

“Let his heart be changed from a man, and let the heart of a beast be given to him”

The expressions **be changed** and **be given** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Let them change his heart from a man, and let them give the heart of a beast to him]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 4:16 (#3)

לִבְבֵהּ֙ מִן־אנושא יְשַׁנּ֔וֹן

“Let his heart be changed from a man”

The pronoun **his** refers to the man whom the tree represents. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Let the heart of the man whom the tree represents be changed from a man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 4:16 (#4)

לִבְבֵהּ֙ מִן־אנושא יְשַׁנּ֔וֹן

“Let his heart be changed from a man”

Here the watcher is speaking as if the man’s mind were his **heart**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Let his mind be changed from a man]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 4:16 (#5)

וְשִׁבְעָ֥ה עִדְנִ֖ין יַחְלְפ֥וּן עֲלֽוֹהִי

“and let seven times pass over him”

The implication is that **seven times** refers to a fixed period of time, either seven years or seven seasons. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and let seven fixed periods of time pass over him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 4:17 (#1)

בִּגְזֵרַ֣ת עִירִ֔ין פִּתְגָמָ֖א וּמֵאמַ֣ר קַדִּישִׁ֑ין שְׁאֵלְתָּֽא

“The matter {is} by a decree of the watchers, and the decision {is} from a command of the holy ones”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [The watchers and holy ones have decided this together]

See: Parallelism

Daniel 4:17 (#2)

חַיָּיֵ֣א

“the living”

The speaker for **the watchers** is using the adjective **the living** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [people who are alive]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 4:17 (#3)

וּשְׁפַ֥ל אֲנָשִׁ֖ים יְקִ֥ים עלֽיה

“and he sets up over it the lowest of men”

The watcher is using the adjective **the lowest** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and he sets up over it a man who is of the lowest status]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 4:18 (#1)

דִּ֠י רוּחַ־אֱלָהִ֨ין קַדִּישִׁ֜ין בָּךְ

“because the spirit of the holy gods {is} in you”

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [since the spirit of the holy gods is in you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Daniel 4:18 (#2)

כָּל־קֳבֵ֣ל דְּנָ֗ה ׀ כָּל־חַכִּימֵ֣י מַלְכוּתִ֔י

“all before that all of the wise men of my kingdom”

Nebuchadnezzar is using **all before that ** as a common expression of the culture to mean “since.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [since all of the wise men of my kingdom]

See: Idiom

Daniel 4:19 (#1)

חֶלְמָ֣א לשנאיך ופשׁרֵ֔ה לעריך

“may} the dream {be} for the ones hating you and its interpretation, for your enemies”

Daniel is using the expression **for the ones hating you and its interpretation, for your enemies** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I wish that what the dream predicts would happen to your enemies rather than to you.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I wish that what the dream and its interpretation predict would happen to those who hate you, your enemies, rather than to you]

See: Idiom

Daniel 4:19 (#2)

מראי חֶלְמָ֣א לשנאיך ופשׁרֵ֔ה לעריך

“My lord, {may} the dream {be} for the ones hating you and its interpretation, for your enemies”

Belteshazzar is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [My lord, may the dream be for the ones hating you and may its interpretation be for your enemies]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 4:22 (#1)

אנתה־הוּא מַלְכָּ֣א

“it {is} you, O king”

Here Daniel is speaking as if the king were the tree that Nebuchadnezzar saw in his dream. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that tree is a symbol of you, O king]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 4:22 (#2)

וּרְבוּתָ֖ךְ רְבָ֣תת

“And your greatness has become great”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **greatness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And how great you are has increased]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 4:22 (#3)

וְשָׁלְטָנָ֖ךְ לְסֹ֥וף אַרְעָֽא

“and your dominion, to the end of the earth”

Daniel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and your dominion has reached to the end of the earth]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 4:25 (#1)

וְלָ֨ךְ טָרְדִ֜ין מִן־אֱנָשָׁ֗א & וְעִ֨שְׂבָּבָ֤א כְתוֹרִין֙ ׀ לָ֣ךְ יְטַעֲמ֔וּן וּמִטַּ֥ל שְׁמַיָּ֖א לָ֣ךְ מְצַבְּעִ֑ין

“that they will be driving you from man & And they will feed you grass like oxen, and they will be wetting you with the dew of the heavens”

In each of these instances, the pronoun **they** does not refer to specific people. Daniel is using it to describe

what will happen to the king. In some languages, it may be natural to use passive verbal forms to express this meaning. Alternate translation: [you will be driven from men ... And you will be fed grass like oxen, and you will be wetted with the dew of the heavens]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 4:25 (#2)

וְעִשְׂבָּבָא כְתוֹרִין ׀ לֶיכְלָךְ יְטַעֲמוּן

“And they will feed you grass like oxen”

The point of this comparison is that just as **oxen** eat **grass**, so the king will be made to eat grass. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [And they will make you eat grass, just as oxen eat grass]

See: Simile

Daniel 4:25 (#3)

וְשִׁבְעָה עִדָּנִין יַחְלְפוּן עֲלָיִךְ

“And seven times will pass over you”

Daniel is using **And seven times will pass over you** as a common expression of the culture to mean “seven years will pass for you.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Seven years will go by for you] or [This will continue for seven years]

See: Idiom

Daniel 4:26 (#1)

וְדִי אֲמַרוּ לְמִשְׁבַּק עִקַּר שָׁרְשׁוֹהִי דִּי אִילָנָא מַלְכוּתָךְ לֶיכְלָךְ קַיָּמָה

“And that they said to leave the stump of the roots of the tree, your kingdom {will be} enduring for you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the king’s kingdom enduring before the information about leaving the stump of the roots of the tree. Alternate translation: [And your kingdom will be an enduring kingdom for you; that is what they meant when they said to leave the stump of the roots of the tree]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 4:26 (#2)

שַׁלִּטְטַן שְׁמַיָּא

“the heavens {are} ruler”

Here, **the heavens** represents “God.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [God is ruler]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 4:27 (#1)

וחטיך בְּצִדְקָה פְרַק וַעֲוָיָתָךְ

“and may you break off your sin in righteousness and your iniquities”

Here Daniel is speaking as if the king could **break off** his sin the way a person breaks off a branch from a tree. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and may you cease from your sin by doing what is right and from your iniquities]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 4:27 (#2)

הֵיכְן

“if”

Here, the term **if** marks a prolonging of your prosperity as the possible result of Nebuchadnezzar breaking off his sin to practice righteousness and his iniquity by showing mercy to the poor. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that Daniel is suggesting that this could be a result. Alternate translation: [so that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Daniel 4:27 (#3)

בְּצִדְקָה

“in righteousness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [by doing what is right]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 4:27 (#4)

עֲנָיָיִן

“the poor”

Daniel is using the adjective **the poor** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use

adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those who are poor]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 4:28 (#1)

כֹּלָּא מְטָא עַל־נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא

"The whole came upon King Nebuchadnezzar"

Nebuchadnezzar is the one telling this account, but he speaks of himself in the third person as **King Nebuchadnezzar**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [Everything from the dream came upon me, King Nebuchadnezzar]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Daniel 4:29 (#1)

לְקֵצָת יַרְחִין תְּרֵי־עָשַׂר

"At the end of 12 months"

Nebuchadnezzar is using the phrase translated as **At the end of 12 months** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Daniel 4:30 (#1)

הֲלָלָא דָא־הִיא בָּבֶל רַבְּתָא דִּי־אֲנָה בְנֵיתַהּ לְבֵית מַלְכוּ בְּתֻקֶף חִסְנִי וְלִיקָר הַדְרִי

"Is} this not the great Babylon, which I, I have built it for the house of the kingdom by the might of my power and for the glory of my majesty"

Nebuchadnezzar is using the question form to boast about what he has accomplished. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [This is indeed the great Babylon, which I myself have built for the house of the kingdom by the might of my power and for the glory of my majesty!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Daniel 4:30 (#2)

דִּי־אֲנָה בְנֵיתַהּ

"which I, I have built it"

It might seem that the expression **which I, I have built it** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [which I have built]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Daniel 4:30 (#3)

אֲנָה בְנֵיתַהּ

"I, I have built it"

Nebuchadnezzar is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **have built** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he himself is the one who built this great city, showing his pride in his own achievement. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [which I myself have built it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 4:31 (#1)

עִדּוֹ מִלְּתָא בְּפֻם מַלְכָּא

"The word {was} still in the mouth of the king"

Nebuchadnezzar is using the expression **still in the mouth of the king** as a common expression of the culture to mean "the king was still speaking." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The king was still speaking these words]

See: Idiom

Daniel 4:33 (#1)

וּמִן־אֱנָשָׁא טָרְדִ֫ין וְעִשְׂבָּא כְתוֹרִין יֵאכֻל וּמִטַּל שְׁמַיָּא גִּשְׁמֵהּ יִצְטַבַּע

"And he was driven from man, and he ate grass like oxen, and his body was wet with the dew of the heavens"

The expressions **was driven** and **was wet** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And people drove him away from man, and he ate grass like oxen, and the dew of the heavens made his body wet]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 4:33 (#2)

שַׂעְרֵהּ כִּנְשָׁרִין רְבָבָה וְטִפְרָרוֹהִי כְצִפְּרִין

“his hair had become great like eagles and his nails, like birds”

The point of this comparison is that just as **eagles** have long feathers and **birds** have long claws, so the king’s hair and nails grew very long. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [his hair had grown very long, as long as the feathers of eagles, and his nails had grown very long, as long as the claws of birds]

See: Simile

Daniel 4:35 (#1)

וְכָל־דָּארֵי אַרְעָא כְּלָא חֲשִׁיבִין

“And all of the dwellers of the earth are being regarded {as} nothing”

The expression **are being regarded** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And God regards all of the dwellers of the earth as nothing]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 4:35 (#2)

בְּחֵיל שְׁמַיָּא

“among the army of the heavens”

Here Nebuchadnezzar is speaking as if the beings in the heavens were an **army**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [among the beings who live in the heavens]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 4:35 (#3)

וְלָא אִיתַי דִּי־יְמַחֵא בִּידָהּ

“And there is none who strikes his hand”

Nebuchadnezzar is using the expression **strikes his hand** as a common expression of the culture to mean “restrains him or stops him from acting.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And there is none who holds him back]

See: Idiom

Daniel 4:35 (#4)

מָמָה עֲבַדְתְּ

“What are you doing”

Anyone who would say this to God would be using the question form to challenge or rebuke him. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You have no right to do this!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Daniel 4:36 (#1)

וְעַל־מַלְכוּתְתִי הֲתְקְנַת וּרְבְבוּ יַתִּירָה הֲוָסְפַת לִי

“and my kingdom was established to me, and exceeding greatness was added to me”

The expressions **was established** and **was added** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and God established my kingdom for me and gave exceeding greatness to me]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 4:37 (#1)

מְשַׁבַּח וּמְרוֹמֵם וּמְהַדַּר

“am praising and exalting and glorifying”

The terms **praising** and **exalting** and **glorifying** mean similar things. Nebuchadnezzar is using the three terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [am greatly praising the King of the heavens]

See: Doublet

Daniel 4:37 (#2)

כָּל־מַעֲבָדֵהּ קְשׁוֹט

“all of his deeds are truth”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **truth**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [all of his deeds are true]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 4:37 (#3)

וְאֹרְחָתֵהּ דִּדֵּין

“and his ways are justice”

Here Nebuchadnezzar is speaking as if the way God acts were the **ways** or paths on which God travels. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and everything he does is just]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 4:37 (#4)

וְדִיִ֨ מַהְלְכִ֤ין בְּגַוְוָה

“and {those} who are walking about in pride”

Here Nebuchadnezzar is speaking as if the ways people behave were **walking about**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and those who conduct themselves with pride]

See: Metaphor

Daniel - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. At a feast that Belshazzar gives, a hand writes something on the palace wall (1–6)
2. No one else can read the writing, but the queen mother recommends Daniel (7–12)
3. Daniel reads and interprets the writing (13–28)
4. Belshazzar rewards Daniel, but he is killed that night by the invading Persians (29–30)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Belshazzar want to drink from vessels from the Jerusalem temple?
Belshazzar and his guests used vessels from the Jerusalem temple to drink toasts in honor of the gods their idols represented. This was most likely a deliberate act repudiating the God of that temple in favor of traditional Babylonian gods. Daniel reminds Belshazzar that he knew all about how his grandfather Nebuchadnezzar had come to honor and worship that God as the true God. But many interpreters suggest that, with the Babylonians now under dire threat from the Persians, Belshazzar believed that if he returned to his traditional gods, they would rescue him and his kingdom. In this culture, when one kingdom conquered another, it would take the idols of the conquered kingdom and put them in the temple of one of its own gods as trophies of victory. There were no idols representing Yahweh, so the Babylonians took the vessels from his temple instead. It appears that Nebuchadnezzar had kept these in a temple and not used them for common purposes. Belshazzar, by using them at a banquet to drink toasts to false gods, was defiling them. That is why he came under such serious and immediate judgment.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Mene, Mene, Tekel, and Parsin
No one could read what the writing on the wall said, so it is probable that it was written in some language and script other than the Aramaic that was spoken in Babylon. God enabled Daniel to understand what the writing was saying, and he translated it into Aramaic words. The meaning of these words is evident from what Daniel says about them: “mene” means to “number,” “tekel” means to “weigh,” and “peres” means to “divide.” (The term “mene” is probably repeated for emphasis, to show the certainty of God’s judgment against Belshazzar. “Parsin” in verse 25 is the plural of “peres” in verse 28.) The ULT and UST texts write these Aramaic words with English letters, spelling them the way they sound in English. Translators are encouraged to write these words with the letters of their own alphabets and to spell them the way they sound in their own languages.

Daniel 5:1 (#1)

בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר

“Belshazzar”

The word **Belshazzar** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 5:1 (#2)

אֶלַּף

“a thousand”

Daniel is using the adjective **thousand** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [a thousand of them]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 5:1 (#3)

בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר מַלְכָּא עֲבַד לְחֶם רַב לְרַבְרְבָנוֹהִי אֶלַּף

“King Belshazzar made a great feast for his nobles, a thousand”

Belshazzar is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. He means that he made a feast for a thousand of his nobles. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [King Belshazzar made a great feast for a thousand of his nobles]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 5:2 (#1)

בְּטָעֲעֵם חַמְרָ֣א

“in the taste of the wine”

Daniel is using the phrase **in the taste of the wine** as a common expression of the culture to mean that Belshazzar was under the influence of the wine that he had been drinking. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Belshazzar became drunk and said] or [while under the influence of the wine]

See: Idiom

Daniel 5:2 (#2)

בֵּלְשַׁאצַּ֞ר אֲמַ֤ר ׀ בְּטָעֲעֵם֙ חַמְרָ֣א

“Belshazzar said in the taste of the wine”

Elsewhere in Daniel and Ezra, in the Aramaic portions of Scripture, the term that the ULT translates here as **taste** means “command” or “decree.” While many interpreters favor “taste” here, the sense of “command” would also suit the context and have the same basic meaning. Alternate translation: [Belshazzar said by command of the wine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 5:2 (#3)

נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּ֣ר אֲבוּהִ֔י

“Nebuchadnezzar his father”

Belshazzar is using the term **father** to mean “grandfather,” or more generally, “ancestor.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Nebuchadnezzar his grandfather]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 5:2 (#4)

וְיִשְׁתּוֹן֙ בֵּהּ֣וֹן מַלְכָּ֔א וְרַבְרְבָנ֖וֹהִי שֵׁגְלָתֵ֣הּ וּלְחֵנָתֵ֑הּ

“so that the king and his nobles, his wives and his concubines might drink from them”

Drinking from these **vessels** was a symbolic action by which the king mocked the God whose temple was in Jerusalem. Verse 4 makes clear that the Belshazzar wanted to honor his own idols rather than God, whom his grandfather Nebuchadnezzar had learned to fear and honor. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote.

See: Symbolic Action

Daniel 5:3 (#1)

בֵּאדַ֣יִן הַיְתִ֔יו

“Then they brought”

The pronoun **they** refers to the servants of the king. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Then the king’s servants brought]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 5:3 (#2)

הֵיכְלָ֣א דִֽי־בֵ֔ית אֱלָהָ֖א

“the temple of the house of God”

Daniel is using the possessive form to describe a **temple** that is characterized by being a **house** for **God**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the temple that was the house of God]

See: Possession

Daniel 5:6 (#1)

זִיוָ֥הִי שְׁנַ֖נוֹהִי

“his splendors changed {for} him”

Daniel is using the phrase **his splendors changed** as a common expression of the culture to mean that the king’s face turned pale. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the color drained from his face]

See: Idiom

Daniel 5:6 (#2)

וְקִטְרֵי חַרְצֵהּ מִשְׁתָּרְרִין

“And the joints of his loins were loosened”

Daniel is using the phrase **the joints of his loins were loosened** as a common expression of the culture to mean that the king suddenly became weak with fear. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And his body became weak with terror]

See: Idiom

Daniel 5:6 (#3)

מִשְׁתָּרְרִין

“were loosened”

The expression **were loosened** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [grew weak] or [came loose]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:6 (#4)

וְאַרְכְּבָתֵּהּ דְּגָדָא לְדָדָא נָקְשָׁן

“and his knees knocked, this to this”

Daniel is using the phrase **his knees knocked, this to this** as a common expression of the culture to mean that the king’s knees struck against each other because he was so afraid. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and his knees banged together in fear]

See: Idiom

Daniel 5:7 (#1)

קָרֵא מַלְכָּא בְּחַיִל

“The king called out in strength”

Daniel is using the phrase **The king called out in strength** as a common expression of the culture to mean that the king raised his voice. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The king called out with a loud voice]

See: Idiom

Daniel 5:7 (#2)

כָּל־אֱנָשׁ דִּי־יִקְרֵא כְּתָבָה דְנָה

“Any man who reads this writing”

The king is not referring to a specific **man**. He means people in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Whoever reads this writing]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Daniel 5:7 (#3)

וּפִשְׁרֵהּ יְחַוְנַנַּנִי

“and shows me its interpretation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and shows me what it means]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 5:7 (#4)

אַרְגְּוָנָא יִלְבַּשׁ והמונכא דִּי־דַהֲבָאא עַל־צַוְּארֵהּ

“shall wear purple, and a chain of gold {shall be} around his neck”

These were symbols of high rank and authority. Alternate translation: [shall be granted high rank]

See: Symbolic Action

Daniel 5:7 (#5)

וְתַלְתִּתַּי בְּמַלְכוּתָא יִשְׁלַט

“and he shall rule {as} the third in the kingdom”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **third**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [and only two others shall rule above him in the kingdom]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel 5:8 (#1)

ופשרא לְהוֹדָעָה לְמַלְכָּא

“or to make the king know the interpretation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [or to tell the king what it meant]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 5:9 (#1)

מַלְכָּא בֵלְשַׁאצַּר שַׂגִּיא מִתְבָּהַל וְזִיוֹהִי שָׁנַיִן עֲלָוֹהִי וְרַבְרְבָנוֹהִי מֻשְׁתַּבְּשִׁין

“King Belshazzar was being alarmed greatly, and his splendors were changing upon him, and his nobles were being perplexed”

The expressions **was being alarmed** and **were being perplexed** are passive verbal forms. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express these ideas in active form or in another way that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [King Belshazzar felt great alarm, and his splendors were changing upon him, and his nobles felt perplexity]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:10 (#1)

מַלְכְּתָּא

“The queen”

The implication is that this woman was the queen mother, that is, the mother of the king, since the king’s wives were already present at the feast. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The mother of the king came in]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 5:10 (#2)

מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי

“O king, live to eternities”

The queen is using the expression **live to eternities** as a common expression of the culture to express a respectful wish that the king would have a long and prosperous life. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [O king, may you enjoy long life and prosperity]

See: Idiom

Daniel 5:10 (#3)

וְזִיוָיךְ אַל־יְשַׁתַּנּוֹ

“and may your splendors not be changed”

The expression **may your splendors not be changed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and do not let your face lose its color]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:11 (#1)

רַוּחַ אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין

“is} the spirit of the holy gods”

The queen is using the possessive form to describe a **spirit** that is characterized by coming from **the holy gods**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [is a spirit that comes from the holy gods]

See: Possession

Daniel 5:11 (#2)

נַהִירוּ וְשָׂכְלְתָנוּ וְחָכְמָה

“light and understanding and wisdom”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **light**, **understanding**, and **wisdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [abilities to enlighten and to understand and to be wise]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 5:11 (#3)

נַהִירוּ

“light”

The queen is speaking as if the ability to understand things were **light**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [insight]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 5:11 (#4)

וְחָכְמָה כְּחָכְמַת־אֱלָהִין

“and wisdom like the wisdom of the gods”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the gods** were thought to have perfect wisdom, so this man had extraordinary **wisdom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and wisdom as extraordinary as the wisdom that the gods were thought to have]

See: Simile

Daniel 5:11 (#5)

הִשְׁתְּכַחַת בֵּהּ

“were found in him”

The expression **were found in him** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [showed themselves in him]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:11 (#6)

וּמַלְכָּא נְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר אֲבוּךְ & אֲבוּךְ מַלְכָּא

“And King Nebuchadnezzar, your father, your father the king”

The queen is repeating the information that Nebuchadnezzar was an illustrious predecessor of Belshazzar in order to emphasize the qualifications of Daniel. If your language can repeat information for emphasis, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [And your grandfather, King Nebuchadnezzar, that great emperor]

See: Reduplication

Daniel 5:12 (#1)

כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי

“all before that”

Here, the phrase **all before that** introduces the reason why the queen says the king should summon Daniel, namely that Daniel has these exceptional abilities. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a reason.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Daniel 5:12 (#2)

וּמְשַׁרְיָא קִטְרִין

“and loosening of knots”

Here the queen is speaking as if solving difficult problems were **loosening of knots**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [untangling difficult problems] or [solving difficult problems]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 5:12 (#3)

בֶּלְטְשַׁאצַּר

“Belteshazzar”

The word **Belteshazzar** is the Babylonian name of Daniel.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 5:12 (#4)

כְּעַן

“Now”

The queen is using the term **Now** to focus her listeners’ attention on what she is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 5:12 (#5)

דָּנִיֵּאל יִתְקְרֵי

“let Daniel be called”

The expression **let Daniel be called** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [have someone call Daniel]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:13 (#1)

בֱּאדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל הֵעַל

“Then Daniel was brought in”

The expression **Then Daniel was brought in** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Then they brought Daniel in]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:13 (#2)

בְּנֵי גָלוּתָא דִּי יְהוּד דִּי

“the sons of the captivity of Judah that”

The king is using the phrase **the sons of the captivity of Judah** as a common expression of the culture to refer to the people who had been taken away from Judah as captives. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Judean captives whom]

See: Idiom

Daniel 5:13 (#3)

אנתה־הוּא דָּנִיֵּאל דִּי־מִן־בְּנֵי גָלוּתָאא דִּדִי יְהוֹדִ דִּדִי הַיְתִתֵּי מַלְכָּא אַבִי מִן־יְהוּד

“Are you Daniel, who {is} from the sons of the captivity of Judah that my father the king brought from Judah”

The king is using the question form to express his certainty about Daniel’s identity, not to request information. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So you are Daniel, who is from the sons of the captivity of Judah that my father the king brought from Judah!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Daniel 5:14 (#1)

וְשִׁמְעֵת עלַיִךְ

“Now I have heard about you”

Here the author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Daniel 5:14 (#2)

הִשְׁתְּכַחַת בָּךְ

“are found in you”

The expression **are found in you** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [belong to you]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:15 (#1)

וּכְעַן

“And now”

Belshazzar is using the term **And now** to focus Daniel’s attention on what he is about to say. The king introduces a major point and then his main point. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 5:15 (#2)

הֵעֵעלוּ קֳדָמַי

“have been brought in before me”

The expression **have been brought in before me** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [my servants have brought in before me]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:15 (#3)

פְּשַׁר

“the interpretation of”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how to interpret]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 5:16 (#1)

כְּעַן

“And now”

Again, Belshazzar is using the term **And now** to focus Daniel’s attention on what he is about to say. This time he will deliver his main point. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [And so]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 5:16 (#2)

וַאֲנָהּ שְׁמֵעֵת

“But I, I have heard”

Belshazzar is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I have heard** already

includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that, unlike his wise men who were not able to interpret the writing, he himself has heard that Daniel is able to interpret it. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [But I myself have heard]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 5:16 (#3)

פְּשָׁרִ֥ין לְמִפְשַׁ֖ר

“to interpret interpretations”

The king is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root: **interpret interpretations**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [give interpretations of difficult things]

See: Poetry

Daniel 5:16 (#4)

וְקִטְרִ֥ין לְמִשְׁרֵֽא

“and to loosen knots”

Belshazzar is speaking as if difficult problems were **knots** that needed to be loosened. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [untangle complicated problems] or [solve extremely difficult problems]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 5:16 (#5)

וּפִשְׁרֵ֖הּ

“and & its interpretation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and interpret it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 5:16 (#6)

אַרְגְּוָנָ֣א תִלְבַּ֗שׁ והמונכא דִּֽי־דַהֲבָא֙ עַל־צַוְּארָ֔ךְ

“you shall wear purple and a chain of gold {shall be} around your neck”

Wearing purple clothing and a gold chain around one’s neck was a symbolic action by which the king showed that Daniel would receive great honor and authority. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [I will honor you by having you wear purple and by putting a chain of gold around your neck]

See: Symbolic Action

Daniel 5:17 (#1)

מַתְּנָתָ֖ךְ לָֽךְ֑ וּנְבָזְבִיתָ֥ךְ לְאָחֳרָ֖ן הַהֵ֥ב

“Let your gifts be for yourself, and give your rewards to another”

Daniel is saying what he wants the king to do. See the discussion in the introduction to this book about “let” and follow the decision of your team of how a speaker will express in this context what he wants someone to do. Alternate translation: [You may keep your gifts for yourself, and I want you to give your rewards to another]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Daniel 5:17 (#2)

וּפִשְׁרָ֖א

“and & the interpretation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [make him know what it means]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 5:18 (#1)

מַלְכוּתָ֣א וּרְבוּתָ֗א וִיקָרָ֛א וְהַדְרָ֖ה

“the kingdom and greatness and honor and majesty”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **greatness**, **honor**, and **majesty**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the kingdom and everything that made him great and honored and majestic]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 5:19 (#1)

עַמְמַיָּ֣א אֻמַּיָ֔א וְלִשָּׁנַיָּ֖א

“peoples, nations, and languages”

Here, **languages** represents the people who speak those languages. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [peoples, nations, and speakers of every language]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 5:19 (#2)

זאעין וְדָחֲלִין

“trembling and fearing”

The terms **trembling** and **fearing** mean similar things. Daniel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [extremely afraid]

See: Doublet

Daniel 5:19 (#3)

דִּי־הָוָה צָבֵא הֶנֵא קָטֵל וְדִי־הָוָה צָבֵא֙ הֶנֵה מַחֵא וְדִי־הֶנֵה צָבֵא֙ הֶנֵה מָרְרִים וְדִי־הָוָה צָבֵא הֶנֵה מַשְׁפִּיל

“Whom he was wishing, he was killing, and whom he was wishing, he was letting live. And whom he was wishing, he was lifting up, and whom he was wishing, he was humbling”

Daniel is referring to Nebuchadnezzar’s complete power over everyone by naming opposite actions: whom **he was killing** and whom **he was letting live**, and whom **he was lifting up** and whom **he was humbling**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [He had complete power over everyone, deciding whether they lived or died and whether they became important or unimportant]

See: Merism

Daniel 5:20 (#1)

רְרַם לִבְבֵהּ וְרוּחֵהּ תְּקִפַת לַהְזָדָה

“his heart lifted {itself} up and his spirit became strong to be proud”

Daniel is speaking of Nebuchadnezzar becoming proud and arrogant as if **his heart lifted** itself **up and his spirit became strong to be proud**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he became very proud and stubbornly arrogant]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 5:20 (#2)

הָנְחַתוּ

“he was brought down”

The expression **he was brought down** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God brought him down]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:20 (#3)

כָּרְסֵא מַלְכוּתֵהּ

“the throne of his kingdom”

Here, **the throne of his kingdom** represents his royal power and authority as king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [his royal authority as king]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 5:20 (#4)

וִיקָרָהּ הֶעְדִּיוּ

“and they removed his glory”

Here, Daniel uses the pronoun **they** in an impersonal sense to indicate that God removed Nebuchadnezzar’s glory. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and God removed his glory]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 5:21 (#1)

טָרְדִיד

“he was driven”

The expression **he was driven** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God drove him]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:21 (#2)

וּמִן־בְּנֵי֙ אֱנָשָׁא֙ טָרְדִיד וְלִבְבֵהּ ׀ עִם־חֵיוָתָא֙ שוי וְעִם־עֲרָדַיָּא֙ מְדוֹרֵהּ עִשְׂבָבָא כְתוֹרִין יְטַעֲמוּנִּהּ וּמִטַּל שְׁמַיָּא גִּשְׁמֵהּ יִצְטַבָּע עַ֠ד דִּי־יְדַ֨ע דִּי־שַׁלִּ֜יט אֱלָהָא֙ עליא בְּמַלְכוּת אֱנָשָׁא֙ וּלְמַן־דְּדִי יְקִימ֖וּן עליה

“And he was driven from the sons of man, and his heart resembled with an animal, and his dwelling {was} with the wild donkeys. They fed him grass like oxen, and his body was wet with the dew of the heavens, until that he knew that the Most High God {is} ruler over the kingdom of man and whom that he wishes, he sets up over it”

The pronoun **he** refers to Nebuchadnezzar, while the pronoun **he** in **whom that he wishes, he sets up over it** refers to God. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Nebuchadnezzar was driven from the sons of man and his heart resembled with an animal and his dwelling was with the wild donkeys. They fed him grass like oxen and his body was wet with the dew of the heavens until Nebuchadnezzar knew that the Most High God is ruler over the kingdom of man and whomever God wishes, God sets up over it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 5:21 (#3)

בְּנֵי֙ אֲנָשָׁ֔א

“the sons of man”

Daniel is using the phrase **the sons of man** as a common expression of the culture to mean human beings in general. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [humanity]

See: Idiom

Daniel 5:21 (#4)

וְלִבְבֵ֖ה ׀ עִם־חֵיוָתָ֣א שוי

“and his heart resembled with an animal”

The point of this comparison is that just as an **animal** thinks and acts without human reason, so Nebuchadnezzar’s **heart**, or mind, became like that. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and his mind lost human reason and became like that of an animal]

See: Simile

Daniel 5:21 (#5)

עִשְׂבָ֣ב כְּתוֹרִ֣ין יְטַעֲמ֑וּנֵּ֗ה

“They fed him grass like oxen”

The point of this comparison is that just as **oxen** eat grass, so Nebuchadnezzar was fed **grass** to eat. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [They fed him grass to eat, just as oxen eat grass]

See: Simile

Daniel 5:22 (#1)

ואנתה

“But you”

Daniel uses the word **But** here to indicate a contrast between what Belshazzar knew about Nebuchadnezzar and his own failure to humble himself. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Nonetheless, you]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Daniel 5:22 (#2)

לָ֣א הַשְׁפֵּ֔לְתְּ לִבְבָ֖ךְ

“have not humbled your heart”

Daniel is speaking of Belshazzar’s refusal to become humble as if he could physically lower his own **heart**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [have not become humble]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 5:22 (#3)

כָּל־קֳבֵ֣ל דְּדִ֔י

“all before that”

Daniel is using **all before that** as a common expression of the culture to mean “although.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [even though] or [despite the fact that]

See: Idiom

Daniel 5:23 (#1)

וְעַ֤ל מָרֵא־שְׁמַיָּא֙ ׀ הִתְרוֹמַ֣מְתְּ

“But you have lifted yourself up against the Lord of the heavens”

Daniel is speaking of Belshazzar’s arrogance toward God as if he had physically **lifted** himself **up against**

the Lord of the heavens. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But you have acted arrogantly toward the Lord of the heavens]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 5:23 (#2)

הַיְתִתָיו

“have been brought”

The expression **have been brought** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they have brought]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:23 (#3)

נִשְׁמְתָךְ בִּידֵהּ

“your breath {is} in his hand”

Here, **your breath** represents your life, and being **in his hand** represents being under his control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [your life is under his control]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 5:23 (#4)

וְכָל־אָרְחָתָךְ לֵהּ

“and all of your ways {are} to him”

Daniel is speaking of everything Belshazzar does as if his actions were **ways**, or paths, that belong to God. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and everything that you do he determines]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 5:24 (#1)

שְׁלַלַיַּה

“was sent”

The expression **was sent** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [came]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:24 (#2)

רְשִׁים

“was inscribed”

The expression **was inscribed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [appeared]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:25 (#1)

מְנֵא מְנֵא תְּקֵל וּפַרְסִין

“Mene,’ ‘Mene,’ ‘Tekel,’ and ‘Parsin”

The words **Mene**, **Mene**, **Tekel**, and **Parsin** are words in the original language. You will need to decide if you will use these words in their original form or if you will instead translate their meaning into your language. Either approach has broad support. If you use the original words, you could spell them the way they sound in your language and then put the translation in a footnote. Alternate translation: [‘Numbered,’ ‘Numbered,’ ‘Weighed,’ ‘Divided.’]

See: Copy or Borrow Words

Daniel 5:27 (#1)

תְּקִקֵלְתָּה בְמֹאזְנַיָּא וְהִשְׁתְּכַחְתְּ חַסִּיר

“you have been weighed on the scales and found deficient”

Daniel is speaking of God judging Belshazzar as if God had **weighed** him **on the scales and found** him **deficient**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God has examined you and determined that you do not meet his standard]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 5:27 (#2)

תְּקִקֵלְתָּה

“you have been weighed”

The expression **you have been weighed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God weighed you]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:27 (#3)

וְהִשְׁתְּכַחַתְּ חַסְּיר

“and found deficient”

The expression **found deficient** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he has found you deficient]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:28 (#1)

פְּרִיסַתְ מַלְכוּתָךְ וִיהִיבַת לְמָדַי וּפָרְס

“your kingdom has been divided and given to the Mede and the Persian”

The implication is that God is the one who has divided the kingdom and that the Medes and the Persians will take control of it, which happened soon afterward. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [God has divided your kingdom and has given it to the Medes and the Persians, who will soon rule over it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 5:28 (#2)

פְּרִיסַתְ

“has been divided”

The expression **has been divided** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [has broken apart] or [God has divided]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:28 (#3)

וִיהִיבַת

“and given”

The expression **given** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and God has given it]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:28 (#4)

לְמָדַי וּפָרְס

“to the Mede and the Persian”

In this verse, the word **Mede** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the Medes as a group, and the word **Persian** refers to all of the Persians as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “Mede” and “Persian.” Alternate translation: [to the Medes and the Persians]

See: Collective Nouns

Daniel 5:29 (#1)

וְהַלְבְּישׁוּ לְדָנִיֵּאלְ

“and they clothed Daniel”

Here, the pronoun **they** refers to the servants of Belshazzar. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and his servants clothed Daniel]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 5:29 (#2)

וְהַכְרְזוּ

“and they made a proclamation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **proclamation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and they had it announced]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 5:30 (#1)

קְטִיל

“was killed”

The expression **was killed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [met his death]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 5:31 (#1)

כְּבַר שְׁנִין שִׁתִּין וְתַרְתֵּין

“as a son of 62 years”

Daniel is using the phrase **a son of 62 years** as a common expression of the culture to mean that Darius was 62 years old. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he was 62 years old]

See: Idiom

Daniel - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. King Darius appoints high officials and wants Daniel to be the highest (1–3)
2. The other officials get Darius to make a law forbidding prayer (4–9)
3. Daniel continues to pray to God, and the officials insist that Darius punish him (10–16)
4. Daniel is thrown into a den of lions, but God protects him (16–23)
5. The other officials are thrown into the den and killed, and Darius honors God (24–28)

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry in 6:26–27.

Daniel 6:1 (#1)

שְׁפַר׀ קֳדָם דָּרְיָוֶשׁ

“It seemed good before Darius”

The author is using **It seemed good before Darius** as a common expression of the culture to mean “Darius decided this.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Darius thought it best]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:1 (#2)

לַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא

“satraps”

Satraps were provincial governors in the ancient Persian empire, each of whom ruled one region on behalf of the king. If your readers would not be familiar with what satraps were, you could use the name of a similar kind of official that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [provincial governors]

See: Translate Unknowns

Daniel 6:2 (#1)

סָרְכִין תְּלָתָא

“three sareks”

Sareks were high officials who supervised the satraps in the ancient Persian empire. If your readers would not be familiar with what sareks were, you could use the name of a similar kind of official that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [three chief administrators]

See: Translate Unknowns

Daniel 6:3 (#1)

כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּדֵי

“all before that”

The expression **all before that** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Daniel 6:3 (#2)

רְוּחַ יַתִּירָאא בֵּהּ

“an excellent spirit {was} in him”

Here, **an excellent spirit** represents “exceptional character and ability.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [he had outstanding character and ability]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 6:4 (#1)

עִלָּה לְהַשְׁכָּחָה לְדָנִיֵּאל

“to find an occasion against Daniel”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **occasion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to find some way to accuse Daniel]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 6:4 (#2)

כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי

“all before that”

Daniel is using **all before that** as a common expression of the culture to mean “because.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:4 (#3)

לָֽא הִשְׁתְּכַחַת עִלְּוֹהִי

“was not found in him”

The expression **was not found in him** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they did not find in him]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 6:5 (#1)

אֱמְרִ֔ין דִּדָ֖י

“were saying that”

Here, the word **that** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Daniel 6:5 (#2)

לָֽא נְהַשְׁכַּ֣ח לְדָנִיֵּ֔אל דְּנָ֕ה כָּל־עִלָּ֖א לָֽהֳהֵ֑ן הַשְׁכַּ֥חֲנָה עֲלֹ֖והִי

“We will not find any occasion against this Daniel unless we find {something} against him”

If it would appear in your language that these men were making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [The only occasion we will find against this Daniel will be something]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

Daniel 6:6 (#1)

לְעָלְמִ֖ין חֱֽיִי

“live to eternities”

The officials are using **live to eternities** as a common expression of the culture to mean “may you live a very long time.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [may you live long]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:7 (#1)

יְבַעֲע֥וּ בָעְיָ֛ה

“petitions a petition”

The officials are using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root, **petitions a petition**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this.

See: Poetry

Daniel 6:7 (#2)

יִתְרְמֵּ֖א לְגֻ֣ב אַרְיָוָֽתָא

“shall be thrown into a den of lions”

The expression **shall be thrown into a den of lions** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is someone whom your servants shall throw into a den of lions]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 6:8 (#1)

דִּי־לָ֖א תֶּעְדֵּֽא

“which does not pass away”

The officials are using **which does not pass away** as a common expression of the culture to mean “which cannot be revoked.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [which is without end]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:9 (#1)

כָּל־קֳבֵ֣ל דְּנָ֔ה

“All before this”

Daniel is using **All before this** as a common expression of the culture to mean “so” or “therefore.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [So then] or [Therefore]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:10 (#1)

רְשִׁ֖ים כְּתָבָֽא

“the writing had been signed”

The expression **the writing had been signed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the king had signed the writing]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 6:10 (#2)

וְכַוִּין פְּתִיחָן לֵהּ בְּעִלִּיתֵּהּ נֶגֶד יְרוּשְׁלֶם

“now the windows to him in his upper chamber were opened toward Jerusalem”

Here the author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Daniel 6:10 (#3)

כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי

“all before that”

Daniel is using **all before that** as a common expression of the culture to mean “just as.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [just as] or [in the same way as]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:12 (#1)

הֲלָא אֱסָר רְשַׁשְׁתְּ דִּדֵּי כָל־אֱנָשׁ דִּי־יִבְעֵהּ מִן־כָּל־אֱלָהּ וֶאֱנָשׁ עַד תְּלָתִין & מִנָּךְ מַלְכָּא יִתְרְמֵא לְגֻבָּ אַרְיָוָתָא &

“Did you not sign a decree that any man who petitions from any god or man for thirty & from you, O king, shall be thrown into a den of lions”

The men are using the question form to remind the king of a decree he already made, implying that he must enforce it. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You signed a decree that any man who petitions from any god or man for thirty days, except from you, O king, shall be thrown into a den of lions!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Daniel 6:12 (#2)

יִתְרְמֵא לְגֻבָּ אַרְיָוָתָא

“shall be thrown into a den of lions”

The expression **shall be thrown into a den of lions** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language.

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 6:13 (#1)

בְּנֵי גָלוּתָא דִּדֵי יְהוּד

“the sons of the captivity of Judah”

The officials are using **the sons of the captivity of Judah** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the people who were taken away from Judah as captives.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people who were taken away from Judah as captives]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:13 (#2)

לָא־שָׂשָׂם עלִיךְ מַלְכָּא טְעֵם

“does not set regard on you, O king”

The officials are using **does not set regard on you** as a common expression of the culture to mean “pays no attention to you.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [does not respect you] or [does not obey you]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:14 (#1)

וְעַל דָּנִיֵּאל שָׂשֵׂם בֶּבֶל לְשֵׁיזְבוּתֵהּ

“and he set his heart on Daniel to deliver him”

The author is using **he set his heart on Daniel to deliver him** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the king was determined to rescue Daniel.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he resolved to rescue Daniel]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:16 (#1)

בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא אֲמַר וְהַיְתִיו֙ לְדָנִיֵּ֔אל וּרְמ֖וֹ לְגֻבָּ֣א דִּֽי־אַרְיָוָתָ֑א עָנֵ֤ה מַלְכָּא֙ וְאָמַ֣ר לְדָנִיֵּ֔אל אֱלָהָךְ֙ דִּֽי אנתה פָלַ֣ח־לֵ֔הּ בְּתִדִירָ֖א הֽוּא־יְשֵׁיזְבִנָּֽךְ

“Then the king was speaking, and they brought Daniel and threw {him} into a den of lions. The king answered and was saying to Daniel, “Your God, whom you are serving him in continuance, he, may he deliver you”

You could put the information about the king speaking to Daniel before the information that they threw Daniel into the den of lions. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Information Structure

Daniel 6:16 (#2)

דִּֽי אנתה פָלַ֣ח־לֵ֔הּ

“whom you are serving him”

It might seem that the expression **whom you are serving him** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [whom you are serving]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Daniel 6:17 (#1)

וְהֵיתָיְתִ֣ת אֶ֔בֶן חְדָ֖ה וְשַׂמַ֣ת עַל־פֻּ֣ם גֻּבָּ֑א

“And a stone was brought and set over the mouth of the den”

The expression **a stone was brought and set over the mouth of the den** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And servants brought a stone and set it over the mouth of the den]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 6:18 (#1)

וְשִׁנְתֵ֥הּ נְדַ֖ת עֲלֽוֹהִי

“and his sleep departed from him”

The author is speaking of **his sleep** as if it were a living thing that could depart from the king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he was unable to sleep]

See: Personification

Daniel 6:21 (#1)

לְעָלְמִ֖ין חֱֽיִי

“live to eternities”

Daniel is using **live to eternities** as a common expression of the culture to mean “may you live a very long time.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [may you live long]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:22 (#1)

קֳדָמ֣וֹהִי זָכוּ֮ הִשְׁתְּכַחַת֒ לִ֑י

“innocence was found to me before him”

The expression **innocence was found to me before him** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he found me to be innocent]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 6:22 (#2)

כָּל־קֳבֵ֣ל דִּ֔י

“all before that”

Daniel is using **all before that** as a common expression of the culture to mean “because.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:23 (#1)

וְהַסְּפַ֥ק דָּנִיֵּ֖אל מִן־גֻּבָּ֑א

“And Daniel was brought up from the den”

The expression **Daniel was brought up from the den** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the king’s servants brought Daniel up from the den]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 6:23 (#2)

וְכָל־חַבָלָל֙ לָא־הִשְׁתְּכַ֣ח בֵּ֔הּ

“and any harm was not found in him”

The expression **any harm was not found in him** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and they found no harm in him]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 6:24 (#1)

דִּי־אֲכַ֫לוּ קַרְצ֥וֹהִי דִּֽנִיֵּ֖אל

“who had eaten the pieces of Daniel”

The author is using **who had eaten the pieces of Daniel** as a common expression of the culture to mean “who had maliciously accused Daniel.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who had maliciously accused Daniel]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:25 (#1)

כְּתָ֣ב לְכָל־עַמְמַיָּ֗א אֻמַיָּא֙ וְלִשָׁנַיָּ֔א דִּי־דארין בְּכָל־אַרְעָ֖א שְׁלָמְכ֥וֹן יִשְׂגֵּֽא

“wrote to all of the peoples, nations, and languages that were dwelling in all of the earth, “May your peace abound”

The quotation of the letter from King Darius may begin with **to all of the peoples** rather than with **May your peace abound**. (Compare the start of the letter from King Nebuchadnezzar in 4:1.) Alternate translation: [wrote, “To all of the peoples, nations, and languages that are dwelling in all of the earth, may your peace abound”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Daniel 6:25 (#2)

וְלִשָׁנַיָּ֗א

“and languages”

Here, **languages** represents “the people who speak those languages.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and speakers of different languages]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 6:25 (#3)

בְּכָל־אַרְעָ֖א

“in all of the earth”

The author says **in all of the earth** as an extreme statement for emphasis. The people addressed lived throughout the king’s empire. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [throughout the entire empire]

See: Hyperbole

Daniel 6:25 (#4)

שְׁלָמְכ֥וֹן יִשְׂגֵּֽא

“May your peace abound”

The king is using **May your peace abound** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I wish you great well-being.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [May you prosper greatly]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:26 (#1)

מִן־קֳדָמַ֣י שִׂ֔ים טְעֵ֖ם

“From before me a decree is set”

The expression **From before me a decree is set** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I am making this decree]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 6:26 (#2)

זאעין וְדָֽחֲלִ֑ין

“trembling and fearing”

The terms **trembling** and **fearing** mean similar things. The king is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [deeply afraid]

See: Doublet

Daniel 6:26 (#3)

וְקַיָּמֵהּ לְעָלְמִין

“and enduring to eternities”

The king is using **enduring to eternities** as a common expression of the culture to mean “existing forever.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he exists forever]

See: Idiom

Daniel 6:26 (#4)

וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ דִּי־לָ֫א תִתְחַבַּל וְשָׁלְטָנֵהּ עַד־סוֹפָא

“and his kingdom {is one} that will not be destroyed, and his dominion {will be} to the end”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [and his kingdom and his rule will never come to an end]

See: Parallelism

Daniel 6:26 (#5)

לָ֫א תִתְחַבַּל

“will not be destroyed”

The expression **will not be destroyed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no power can destroy]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 6:27 (#1)

מְשֵׁיזָ֫ב וּמַצִּיל

“delivering and rescuing”

The terms **delivering** and **rescuing** mean similar things. The king is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [powerfully saving people]

See: Doublet

Daniel 6:27 (#2)

אָתִין וְתִמְהִין

“signs and wonders”

The terms **signs** and **wonders** mean similar things. The king is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [amazing miracles]

See: Doublet

Daniel 6:27 (#3)

בִּשְׁמַיָּ֫א וּבְאַרְעָא

“in the heavens and on the earth”

The king is referring to all of creation by naming two major components, **the heavens** and **the earth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [everywhere in creation]

See: Merism

Daniel 6:27 (#4)

מִן־יַד אַרְיָוָתָא

“from the hand of the lions”

Here, **hand** represents “power” or “control.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the power of the lions]

See: Metonymy

Daniel - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Narrative introduction: Daniel has a dream about four beasts (1)
2. Daniel describes his dream (2–15)
3. Daniel tells how a character in the dream explained its meaning to him (16–27)
4. Daniel concludes this account personally (28)

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry in 7:9–10 and 7:13–14.

Translation issues in this chapter

Should translations try to identify what the beasts in this dream represent?
The character in the dream who explains its meaning to Daniel tells him, "These great beasts, which are four, are four kings arising from the earth" (7:17). Interpreters have certain understandings of what kingdoms these beasts represent, for example, that the lion represents the Babylonian Empire under Nebuchadnezzar, that the bear represents the empire of the Medes and Persians, and so forth. However, we recommend that you do not put anything in the text of your translation or even in a footnote tentatively identifying these kingdoms. Their identity is not certain, and moreover it is not the task of translators to interpret the text, only to represent what it says accurately in their own languages. We recommend similarly that you not offer interpretations of the symbols in chapters 8–12. See the discussion in the introduction to the book of Daniel, "The meaning of Daniel's visions."

Daniel 7:1 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת חֲדָ֔ה לְבֵלְאשַׁצַּר֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ בָּבֶ֔ל

"In the year of one to Belshazzar, the king of Babylon"

Daniel is using the time reference **In the year of one to Belshazzar, the king of Babylon** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Daniel 7:1 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת חֲדָ֔ה לְבֵלְאשַׁצַּר֙

"In the year of one to Belshazzar"

In the original language, the number here is a cardinal number, **one**, that has the sense of an ordinal number, "first." If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **one**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [In the first year of the reign of Belshazzar]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel 7:1 (#3)

לְבֵלְאשַׁצַּר֙

"to Belshazzar"

The word **Belshazzar** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 7:1 (#4)

דָּנִיֵּאל֙ חֱזָ֣ה חֶזְוָ֔ן רֵאשֵׁ֖שׁ עַל־מִשְׁכְּבֵ֑הּ בֵּאדַ֤יִן חֶלְמָא֙ כְּתַ֣ב רֵאשׁ֔ מִלִּ֖ין אֲמַ֥ר

"Daniel saw a dream and visions of his head upon his bed. Then he wrote the dream; he told the head of the matters"

Even though Daniel is the one who is reporting this vision, he is speaking of himself in the third person as **Daniel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I saw a dream and visions of my head upon my bed. Then I wrote the dream; I told the head of the matters]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Daniel 7:1 (#5)

וְחֶזְוֵ֖י רֵאשֵׁ֑שׁ

"and visions of his head"

Daniel is using **visions of his head** as a common expression of the culture to mean "the things that he saw while he was sleeping." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and things that he saw while sleeping]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:1 (#6)

רֵאשׁ֔ מִלִּ֖ין אֲמַ֥ר

"he told the head of the matters"

Daniel is using **the head of the matters** as a common expression of the culture to mean "the most important parts of what he had seen." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he recounted the essential points of what he had seen]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:2 (#1)

עָנֵ֥ה דָנִיֵּאל֙ וְאָמַ֔ר

"Daniel answered and was saying"

Daniel is using the words **answered and was saying** to introduce a direct quotation of his own report, which continues to the end of this chapter. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Daniel 7:2 (#2)

אַרְבַּעַת רוּחֵי שְׁמַיָּא

“the four winds of the heavens”

Daniel is referring to all of the directions by naming **the four winds of the heavens**, that is, the winds that blow from the four points of the compass. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [winds blowing from all directions across the sky]

See: Merism

Daniel 7:3 (#1)

וְאַרְבַּע חֵיוָן רַבְרְבָן סָלְקָן מִן־יַמָּא

“And four great beasts were coming up from the sea”

Here, **four great beasts** represent four kings and the kingdoms that they rule, as the interpretation later in this chapter explains. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And four great beasts, which represented four kings, were coming up from the sea]

See: Symbolic Language

Daniel 7:3 (#2)

שְׁנָיִן דָּדָא מִן־דָּא

“this being different from this”

Daniel is using **this being different from this** as a common expression of the culture to mean “each one was different from the others.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [each one being unlike the rest]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:4 (#1)

קַדְמָיְתָא כְאַרְיֵה וְגַפִּין דִּי־נְשַׁשַׁר לַהּ חָזֵה הֲוֵית עַד דִּי־מְרִטוּ גַפַּיהּ וּנְטִילַת מִן־אַרְעָא וְעַל־רַגְלַיִן כֶּאֱנָשׁ הֳקִימַת וּלְבַב אֱנָשׁ יְהִיבַ לַהּ

“The first {was} like a lion, but the wings of an eagle {were} to it. I was looking until that its wings were pulled off, and it was raised from the ground, and on two feet it was stood like a man, and the heart of a man was given to it”

These events did not all happen at the same time; they happened one after another. Your language may have a connecting phrase that you can use to show this. Alternate translation: [The first was like a lion, but it had the wings of an eagle. I kept watching until its wings were torn off. Next, it was lifted up from the ground. After that, it was made to stand on two feet like a man. Finally, it was given the mind of a man]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Daniel 7:4 (#2)

קַדְמָיְתָא כְאַרְיֵה

“The first {was} like a lion”

The point of this comparison is that just as a **lion** is strong and majestic, so was **The first** beast that Daniel saw. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [The first was as strong and majestic as a lion]

See: Simile

Daniel 7:4 (#3)

מְרִטוּ גַפַּיהּ

“its wings were pulled off”

The expression **were pulled off** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone pulled off its wings]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:4 (#4)

וּנְטִילַת מִן־אַרְעָא וְעַל־רַגְלַיִן כֶּאֱנָשׁ הֳקִימַת

“and it was raised from the ground, and on two feet it was stood like a man”

The expressions **was raised** and **was stood** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language.

Alternate translation: [and someone raised it from the ground and made it stand on two feet like a man]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:4 (#5)

וּנְטָטַ֣ילַת מִן־אַרְעָ֗א וְעַל־רַגְלַ֤יִן כְּאֱנָשׁ֙ הֻקִימַ֔ת

“and it was raised from the ground, and on two feet it was stood like a man”

The point of this comparison is that just as **a man** stands upright on two feet, so did this beast once its wings were gone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and it was raised from the ground, and it was made to stand upright on two feet, in the way that a man stands]

See: Simile

Daniel 7:4 (#6)

וְעַל־רַגְלַ֤יִן

“and on two feet”

The expression **two feet** is the dual of “feet.” If your language has a dual form, it would be appropriate to use it here.

See: Numbers

Daniel 7:4 (#7)

כְּאֱנָשׁ

“like a man”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [like a human being]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Daniel 7:4 (#8)

וּלְבַבַ֣ אֱנָ֔שׁ יְהִיַ֖ב לַֽהּ

“and the heart of a man was given to it”

The expression **was given** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and someone gave it the heart of a man]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:4 (#9)

וּלְבַבַ֣ אֱנָ֔שׁ יְהִיַ֖ב לַֽהּ

“and the heart of a man was given to it”

Here Daniel is speaking as if the ability to think as a human being does were **the heart of a man**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it was given the ability to think as a man does]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 7:5 (#1)

דְּמְיֵ֣ה לְדֻבָּ֔

“resembling a bear”

The point of this comparison is that just as a **bear** is heavy and powerful, so was this second beast. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [resembling a bear, which is heavy and powerful]

See: Simile

Daniel 7:5 (#2)

וְלִשְׁטַ֣ר־חַ֔דַ הֻקְמַ֖ת

“And on one side, it was raised up”

The expression **it was raised up** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And it raised up one of its sides]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:5 (#3)

וְלִשְׁטַ֣ר־חַ֔דַ הֻקְמַ֖ת

“And on one side, it was raised up”

The implication is either that the beast reared up on one side as if it were ready to attack or that one of its sides was higher than the other. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And it was rearing up on one side, ready to attack]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 7:5 (#4)

וְכֵ֣ן אָמְרִ֔ין לַֽהּ֙ קוּמִ֣י אֲכֶ֔לִי בְּשַׂשַׂ֖ר שַׂגִּֽיא

“and thus they were saying to it, ‘Arise, devour much flesh”

There is a direct quotation inside a direct quotation here. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and thus they were telling it to arise and devour much flesh]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Daniel 7:5 (#5)

וְכֵן֙ אָמְרִ֣ין לַהּ

“and thus they were saying to it”

The pronoun **they** refers to speakers whom Daniel does not identify. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and thus voices were saying to it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 7:5 (#6)

קוּמִ֔י

“Arise”

These speakers are using **Arise** as a common expression of the culture to mean “Go ahead.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Go ahead]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:6 (#1)

כִּנְמַ֔ר

“like a leopard”

The point of this comparison is that just as a **leopard** is swift, so was this beast. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [as swift as a leopard]

See: Simile

Daniel 7:6 (#2)

וְשָׁלְטָ֣ן יְהִיבַ֔ לַהּ

“and dominion was given to it”

The expression **was given** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and God gave dominion to it]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:6 (#3)

וְשָׁלְטָ֣ן

“and dominion”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **dominion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and the right to rule over others]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 7:7 (#1)

דְּחִילָ֥הּ וְאֵימְתָנִ֖י

“making afraid and terrible”

The expressions **making afraid** and **terrible** mean similar things. Daniel is using the two expressions together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [extremely terrifying]

See: Doublet

Daniel 7:7 (#2)

וּשְׁאָרָ֣א ברגליה רָפְסָ֑ה

“and it was trampling the rest with its feet”

The implication is that **the rest** refers either to whatever this beast did not devour or to the other beasts. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and it was trampling with its feet whatever was left over]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 7:7 (#3)

וְקַרְנַ֖יִן עֲשַׂ֥ר

“and ten horns”

Here, **ten horns** represent ten kings, as the interpretation in verse 24 explains. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and ten horns representing ten kings]

See: Symbolic Language

Daniel 7:8 (#1)

קְרַ֣ן אָחֳרִ֣י זְעֵירָ֔ה סִלְּקַ֖ת ביניהון

“another horn, little, was coming up among them”

Here, **another horn, little** represents another king who comes to power after those ten kings. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this infor-

mation in a footnote. Alternate translation: [another horn, little, was coming up among them, which represented another king]

See: Symbolic Language

Daniel 7:8 (#2)

וּתְלָ֖ת מִן־קַרְנָ֣יָא קַדְמָיָתָ֑א אִתעקרו מִן־קדמיה

“and three of the first horns were uprooted from before it”

The expression **were uprooted** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and it pulled out three of the first horns]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:8 (#3)

וּתְלָ֖ת מִן־קַרְנָ֣יָא קַדְמָיָתָ֑א אִתעקרו מִן־קדמיה

“and three of the first horns were uprooted from before it”

Here Daniel is speaking as if three kings losing their power were three horns being **uprooted** like plants pulled out of the ground. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and three of the first horns were removed from before it]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 7:8 (#4)

עַיְנִ֨ין כְּעֵינֵ֤י אֱנָשָׁא֙

“eyes like the eyes of a man”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the eyes of a man** show intelligence and awareness, so did the **eyes** of this horn. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [eyes that showed intelligence and awareness]

See: Simile

Daniel 7:8 (#5)

וּפֻ֥ם מְמַלִּ֖ל רַבְרְבָֽן

“and a mouth speaking great {things”

Here, **a mouth** represents the ability to speak. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and it was able to speak arrogant words]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 7:8 (#6)

רַבְרְבָֽן

“great {things”

The implication is that the **great** things that this horn speaks are boastful claims that it makes about itself. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [arrogant boasts about itself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 7:9 (#1)

כָּרְסָוָן֙ רְמִ֔יו

“thrones were set”

The expression **were set** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone set up thrones]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:9 (#2)

וְעַתִּ֥יק יוֹמִ֖ין

“and the Ancient of Days”

Daniel is using **the Ancient of Days** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the one who has always existed,” that is, God. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the eternal God]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:9 (#3)

לְבוּשֵׁ֣הּ ׀ כְּתַלַּ֣ג חִוָּ֑ר

“His clothing {was} white as snow”

The point of this comparison is that just as **snow** is bright white, so was **His clothing**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [His clothing was gleaming, bright white]

See: Simile

Daniel 7:9 (#4)

וּשְׂעַ֥ר רֵאשֵׁ֖הּ כַּעֲמַ֣ר נְקֵ֑א

“and the hair of his head {was} like pure wool”

The point of this comparison is that just as **pure wool** is white, so was **the hair of his head**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the hair of his head was white, like pure wool]

See: Simile

Daniel 7:9 (#5)

כָּרְסְיֵהּ֙ שְׁבִיבִ֣ין דִּי־נ֔וּר

“His throne {was} flames of fire”

Here Daniel is speaking as if this throne were **flames of fire**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [His throne appeared to be on fire]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 7:9 (#6)

נ֔וּר גַּלְגֹּלֹ֖והִי נִ֥ור דָּלֵֽק

“fire; its wheels {were} burning fire”

The implication is that the mention of **its wheels** pictures this throne as a chariot. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [fire; it was like a chariot, and its wheels were burning fire]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 7:10 (#1)

נְהַר֙ דִּי־נ֣וּר נָגֵ֔ד וְנָפֵ֖קִ מִן־קֳדָמֹ֑והִי

“A river of fire was flowing and coming out from before him”

Here Daniel is speaking as if the fire coming out from God’s presence were a stream of water that **was flowing** like a **river**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Fire was continuously coming out from before him in great quantity]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 7:10 (#2)

אַלְפִ֤ים יְשַׁמְּשׁוּנֵּ֙הּ֙ וְרִבְבָ֣ן רִבּ֔וֹן קֳדָמֹ֖והִי יְקוּמ֑וּן

“a thousand of thousands served him, and a myriad of myriads stood before him”

The expressions **a thousand of thousands** and **a myriad of myriads** indicate very large numbers of beings. Translate these numbers according to the conventions of your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [a million served him, and a hundred million stood before him]

See: Numbers

Daniel 7:10 (#3)

אַלְפִ֤ים יְשַׁמְּשׁוּנֵּ֙הּ֙ וְרִבְבָ֣ן רִבּ֔וֹן קֳדָמֹ֖והִי יְקוּמ֑וּן

“a thousand of thousands served him, and a myriad of myriads stood before him”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Another approach would be to connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. See how you as a team have decided to translate the parallel phrases in poetry, and follow that approach here and throughout this chapter. Alternate translation: [an extremely large number of people served him and stood before him]

See: Parallelism

Daniel 7:10 (#4)

קֳדָמֹ֖והִי יְקוּמ֑וּן

“stood before him”

Here Daniel is speaking as if being ready to serve someone were to have **stood before him**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [waited in his presence, ready to serve him]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 7:10 (#5)

דִּינָ֖א יְתִתָּֽב

“The court sat”

Here Daniel is speaking as if beginning a session of judgment were simply to have **sat** down. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The court convened to render judgment]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 7:10 (#6)

וְסִפְרִ֖ין פְּתִ֥יחוּ

“and books were opened”

The expression **were opened** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the attendants opened the books]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:10 (#7)

וְסִפְרִ֖ין פְּתִ֥יחוּ

“and books were opened”

The implication is that these **books** contain the records of what people have done, which the court uses in judging them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and they opened the records of everything people had done, in order to judge them by those records]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 7:11 (#1)

מִן

“from”

The word translated as **from** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Because of]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Daniel 7:11 (#2)

קְטִילַ֤ת חֵיוְתָא֙ וְהוּבַ֣ד גִּשְׁמַ֔הּ וְיִהְיִבַ֖ת לִיקֵ֥דַת אֶשָּֽׁא

“the beast was killed and its body was destroyed and it was given to the burning fire”

The expressions **was killed**, **was destroyed**, and **was given** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God killed the beast and destroyed its body and put it into the burning fire]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:12 (#1)

וּשְׁאָ֣ר חֵיוָתָ֔א הֶעְדִּ֖יו שָׁלְטָנְהֶ֑ון

“And the rest of the beasts, they took away their dominion”

Daniel mentions **the rest of the beasts** first and then says what was done to them. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about what was done to these beasts together with the mention of the beasts themselves. Alternate translation: [And they took away the dominion of the rest of the beasts]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 7:12 (#2)

הֶעְדִּ֖יו שָׁלְטָנְהֶ֑ון

“they took away their dominion”

The pronoun **they** refers to beings whom Daniel does not identify, not to the beasts. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [they lost their dominion to certain beings whom Daniel does not name]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 7:12 (#3)

וְאַרְכָ֣ה בְחַיֵּ֔ין יְהִיבַ֥ת לְהוֹן֙ עַד־זְמַ֣ן וְעִדָּֽן

“but a prolonging in life was given to them for a season and a time”

The expression **was given** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but God prolonged their lives for a season and a time]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:12 (#4)

וְאַרְכָ֣ה בְחַיֵּ֔ין

“but a prolonging in life”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **a prolonging**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [but a longer time to live]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 7:12 (#5)

עַד־זְמַ֣ן וְעִדָּֽן

“for a season and a time”

Daniel is using **for a season and a time** as a common expression of the culture to mean “for a limited period

of time that he does not specify." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for a certain period of time]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:13 (#1)

עִם־עֲנָנֵי שְׁמַיָּא

"with the clouds of the heavens"

Here, **the clouds of the heavens** represent coming from heaven, where God dwells. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from God's dwelling place in heaven]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 7:13 (#2)

כְּבַר אֱנָשׁ אָתֵה הֲוָה

"one like a son of man was coming"

The point of this comparison is that just as **a son of man** has a human form, so did this **one** whom Daniel saw. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [one who had a human form was coming]

See: Simile

Daniel 7:13 (#3)

וּקְדָמוֹהִי הַקְרְבוּהִי

"and they brought him near before him"

The pronoun **they** refers to attendants whom Daniel does not identify, the first **him** refers to the one like a son of man, and the second **him** refers to the Ancient of Days. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and attendants brought him near before the Ancient of Days]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 7:14 (#1)

וְלֵהּ יְהַיב שָׁלְטָן וְיקָר וּמַלְכוּ וְכָל עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָׁנַיָּא לֶהֱוֹן יִפְלְחוּן שָׁלְטָנֵהּ שָׁלְטָן עָלַם דִּי־לָא יֶעְדֵּה וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ דִּי־לָא תִתְחַבַּל

"And to him was given dominion and glory and a kingdom, that all peoples, nations, and languages should serve him. His dominion {is} a dominion of eternity that will not pass away, and his kingdom {is one} that will not be destroyed"

Here, **that** marks **all peoples, nations, and languages should serve him** as the goal or purpose of giving him **dominion and glory and a kingdom**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Daniel 7:14 (#2)

וְלֵהּ יְהַיב שָׁלְטָן וְיקָר וּמַלְכוּ

"And to him was given dominion and glory and a kingdom"

The expression **was given** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the Ancient of Days gave him dominion and glory and a kingdom]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:14 (#3)

שָׁלְטָן וְיקָר וּמַלְכוּ

"dominion and glory and a kingdom"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **dominion**, **glory**, and **a kingdom**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [the ability to rule and to be honored and to reign as king]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 7:14 (#4)

וְכָל עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָׁנַיָּא

"that all peoples, nations, and languages"

The terms **peoples**, **nations**, and **languages** mean similar things. Daniel is using the three terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [that everyone in the whole world]

See: Doublet

Daniel 7:14 (#5)

שָׁלְטָנֵהּ שָׁלְטָן עָלַם דִּי־לָא יֶעְדֵּה וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ דִּי־לָא תִתְחַבַּל

"His dominion {is} a dominion of eternity that will not pass away, and his kingdom {is one} that will not be destroyed"

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [His royal rule will certainly endure forever]

See: Parallelism

Daniel 7:14 (#6)

שָׁלְטָנֵן עָלַם

“is} a dominion of eternity”

Daniel is using the possessive form to describe a **dominion** that is characterized by **eternity**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [is a dominion that lasts forever]

See: Possession

Daniel 7:14 (#7)

דִּי־לָ֫א תִתְחַבַּל

“is one} that will not be destroyed”

The expression **will not be destroyed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is one that nothing will ever destroy]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:15 (#1)

אֶתְכְּרִיַת רוּחִי אֲנָה דָנִיֵּאל בְּגִוּא נִדְנֶה

“My spirit was distressed, I, Daniel, in the midst of the body”

Daniel interrupts his statement about his spirit in order to identify himself. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **I, Daniel** before the information about his spirit being distressed. Alternate translation: [As for me, Daniel, my spirit within my body was distressed]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 7:15 (#2)

אֶתְכְּרִיַת רוּחִי אֲנָה דָנִיֵּאל בְּגִוּא נִדְנֶה

“My spirit was distressed, I, Daniel, in the midst of the body”

Daniel is using **My spirit was distressed** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I was deeply troubled within myself.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I, Daniel, was deeply troubled]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:16 (#1)

חַדָּ֫ מִן־קָ֭קָאֲמַיָּ֣א

“one of the ones standing”

Here Daniel is introducing **one of the ones standing** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [a certain man who was standing there]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 7:16 (#2)

חַדָּ֫ מִן־קָ֭קָאֲמַיָּ֣א

“one of the ones standing”

The implication is that this is one of the many beings who were standing before God, as verse 10 describes. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [one of the ones standing before God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 7:16 (#3)

וּפְשַׁשַׁר מִלַּיָּ֣א יְהוֹדְעִנָּנִי

“and he made me know the interpretation of the matters”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **the interpretation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and he made me know what the matters meant]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 7:17 (#1)

אִלֵּין֙ חֵיוָתָ֣א רַבְרְבָתָ֔א

“These great beasts”

This is the beginning of what the **one of the ones standing** told Daniel. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could introduce this as a direct quotation of him. Alternate translation: [He told me, ‘These great beasts]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Daniel 7:17 (#2)

אִלֵּין חֵיוָתָתָא רַבְרְבָתָא דִּ֫י אִנּ֫ין אַרְבַּ֫ע אַרְבַּ֫ע מַלְכִ֫ין יְקוּמ֫וּן מִן־אַרְעָא

“These great beasts, which are four, {are} four kings arising from the earth”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [He told me that those great beasts, which were four, were four kings arising from the earth]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Daniel 7:17 (#3)

אַרְבַּ֫ע מַלְכִ֫ין יְקוּמ֫וּן מִן־אַרְעָא

“are} four kings arising from the earth”

Here, **four kings** represent the four kingdoms that these kings rule. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [are four kingdoms that will arise on the earth]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 7:17 (#4)

יְקוּמ֫וּן מִן־אַרְעָא

“arising from the earth”

The attendant is using **arising from the earth** as a common expression of the culture to mean “coming to power in the world.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who will come to power in the world]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:18 (#1)

וְיִקַּבְּלוּן֙

“But & will receive”

The attendant uses the word **But** here to indicate a contrast between the four kings who arise from the earth and the holy people of God who receive the kingdom. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [However,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Daniel 7:18 (#2)

וְיִקַּבְּלוּן֙ מַלְכוּתָ֫א קַדִּישֵׁ֫י עֶלְיוֹנִ֫ין

“But the saints of the Most High will receive the kingdom”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **the kingdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [But the saints of the Most High will start to reign]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 7:18 (#3)

קַדִּישֵׁ֫י עֶלְיוֹנִ֫ין

“the saints of the Most High”

The attendant is using the possessive form to describe **the saints** who belong to **the Most High**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the holy people who belong to the Most High]

See: Possession

Daniel 7:18 (#4)

קַדִּישֵׁ֫י עֶלְיוֹנִ֫ין

“the saints of the Most High”

The implication is that **the saints** are the people whom God has set apart as holy for himself. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the people whom God has set apart as holy for himself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 7:18 (#5)

עַד־עָ֫לְמָ֫א וְעַ֫ד עָלַ֫ם עָלְמַ֫יָּא

“to eternity and to eternity of eternities”

The expressions **to eternity** and **to eternity of eternities** mean similar things. The attendant is using the two expressions together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [forever without end]

See: Doublet

Daniel 7:19 (#1)

דִּ֫י־הֲוַ֫ת שְׁנִיָּ֫ה מִן־כֻּלְּהֹון דְּחִילָ֫ה יַתִּ֫תִּ֫ירָה שְׂנִיָּה דִּי־פַרְזֶ֫לֶל וְטִפְרַ֫יהּ דִּי־נְחָ֫שׁ אָכְלָ֫ה מַדֶּקָ֫ה וּשְׁאָרָ֫א בְּרַגְלַ֫יהּ רָפָּ֫סָה

“which was being different from all of them, making afraid exceedingly, its teeth of iron and its claws of bronze, devouring, crushing, and trampling the rest with its feet”

Daniel gives a long series of descriptions of **the fourth beast** within one sentence. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about what this beast looked like and what it did into separate sentences. Alternate translation: [which was different from all of them. It was exceedingly frightening. Its teeth were iron and its claws were bronze. It devoured and crushed, and it trampled the rest with its feet]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 7:20 (#1)

וְפֻם֙ מְמַלִּ֣ל רַבְרְבָ֔ן

“and a mouth speaking great {things”

Daniel is using **speaking great things** as a common expression of the culture to mean “boasting arrogantly.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a mouth that boasted proudly] or [a mouth that spoke arrogant words]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:20 (#2)

וְחָזְוַ֖ה רַ֣ב מִן־חַבְרָתַֽהּ

“and its appearance {was} greater than its fellows”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **its appearance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and it looked more imposing than its fellows]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 7:22 (#1)

וְדִינָ֗א יְהַ֙ב לְקַדִּישֵׁ֣י עֶלְיוֹנִ֔ין

“and judgment was given for the saints of the Most High”

The expression **was given** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he gave judgment for the saints of the Most High]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:22 (#2)

וְדִינָ֗א יְהַ֙ב לְקַדִּישֵׁ֣י עֶלְיוֹנִ֔ין

“and judgment was given for the saints of the Most High”

The implication is either that the court ruled in favor of God’s holy people or that the authority to judge was given to God’s holy people. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the court ruled in favor of the saints of the Most High]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 7:23 (#1)

כֵּן֮ אֲמַר֒ חֵיוְתָ֣א רְבִיעָ֣יְתָא מַלְכ֗וּ רְבִיעִיא֙ תֶּהֱוֵ֣א בְאַרְעָ֔א

“Thus he was saying, ‘The fourth beast will be a fourth kingdom on the earth”

There is a direct quotation inside a direct quotation here. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Thus he was saying that the fourth beast will be a fourth kingdom on the earth]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Daniel 7:23 (#2)

כֵּן֮ אֲמַר֒

“Thus he was saying”

The pronoun **he** refers to the one standing whom Daniel approached, as verse 16 describes. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Thus the one standing there was saying]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 7:23 (#3)

וְתֵאכֻ֤ל כָּל־אַרְעָא֙ וּתְדוּשִׁנַּ֔הּ וְתַדְקִנַּ֖הּ

“And it will devour all of the earth, and it will trample it and crush it”

Here the attendant is speaking as if this kingdom were a beast that would **devour** the nations it conquered and **trample** and **crush** them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And it will conquer all of the earth, and it will defeat and destroy every nation]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 7:23 (#4)

כָּל־אַרְעָא

“all of the earth”

The attendant says **all of the earth** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [a vast expanse of land]

See: Hyperbole

Daniel 7:24 (#1)

וְקַרְנַיָּא עֲשַׂר מִנַּהּ מַלְכוּתָה עַשְׂרָה מַלְכִין יְקוּמוּן

“And the ten horns, from this kingdom, ten kings will arise”

The attendant mentions **the ten horns** first and then explains in a new clause what they represent. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the ten kings together with the mention of the ten horns. Alternate translation: [And from this kingdom, ten kings, who are the ten horns, will arise]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 7:24 (#2)

וְהוּא יִשְׁנֵאא מִן־קַדְמָיֵא

“And he will be different from the first {ones”

The attendant is using the adjective **first** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [And he will be different from the kings who ruled before him]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 7:25 (#1)

וּמִלִּין לְצַצַד עִלָּיָא יְמַלִּל

“And he will speak words against the Most High”

The implication is that these **words against the Most High** are defiant and insulting. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And he will speak arrogant insults against the Most High]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 7:25 (#2)

עִלָּיָא

“the Most High”

The first instance of **the Most High** is singular, while the second instance is plural. This is an Aramaic plural of excellence. It does not mean that there is more than one God, but that the one true God is supremely glorious and powerful. If your language can use its plural form for intensification, not just for number, it would be appropriate to use it here. Other languages may have other ways to show this intensification. Alternate translation: [the Most High ... the Almighty God]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

Daniel 7:25 (#3)

וּלְקַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין יְבַלֶּא

“and he will wear out the saints of the Most High”

Here the attendant is speaking as if oppressing God’s holy people relentlessly were to **wear out** a garment until it fell apart. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will continually afflict the holy people of the Most High until they are exhausted]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 7:25 (#4)

לְהַשְׁנָיָה זִמְנִין וְדָת

“to change the times and the law”

The implication is that **the times** are the festivals that God appointed for his people and that **the law** is the law that God gave them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to change the appointed festivals and the law that God gave his people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 7:25 (#5)

וְיִתְיַהֲבוּן בִּידֵהּ

“And they will be given into his hand”

The expression **will be given** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And God will put the times and the law into his hand]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:25 (#6)

וְיִתְיַהֲבוּן בִּידֵהּ

“And they will be given into his hand”

The pronoun **they** refers to the **saints of the Most High**, not to **the times and the law**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the saints will be given]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 7:25 (#7)

וְיִתְיַהֲבוּן בִּידֵהּ

“And they will be given into his hand”

Here, **his hand** represents the power and control of this king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And they will be given over to his power]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 7:25 (#8)

עַד־עִדָּן וְעִדָּנִין וּפְלַג עִדָּן

“for a time and times and half of a time”

The attendant is using **a time and times and half of a time** as a common expression of the culture to mean “a limited period that God has determined.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for a limited period that God has determined]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:26 (#1)

לְהַשְׁמָדָה וּלְהוֹבָדָה עַד־סוֹפָא

“to consume and destroy {it} to the end”

Here, **to** marks **consume and destroy** as the goal or purpose of taking away his dominion. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [totally consuming and destroying it]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Daniel 7:26 (#2)

לְהַשְׁמָדָה וּלְהוֹבָדָה

“to consume and destroy {it”

The terms **consume** and **destroy** mean similar things. The attendant is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [to utterly destroy it]

See: Doublet

Daniel 7:26 (#3)

עַד־סוֹפָא

“to the end”

The attendant is using **to the end** as a common expression of the culture to mean “completely and finally.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [completely and finally]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:27 (#1)

וּמַלְכוּתָה וְשָׁלְטָנָא וּרְבוּתָא דְּדִי מַלְכְוָתָא

“and the kingdom and the dominion and the greatness of the kingdoms”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **the kingdom**, **the dominion**, and **the greatness**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [and the right to reign and to rule gloriously over the kingdoms]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 7:27 (#2)

תְּחוֹת כָּל־שְׁמַיָּא

“under all of the heavens”

The attendant says **under all of the heavens** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [throughout the entire earth]

See: Hyperbole

Daniel 7:27 (#3)

יְהִיבַת לְעַמָּא קַדִּישֵׁי עִלָּיוֹנִין

“will be given to the people of the saints of the Most High”

The expression **will be given** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will give to his people, the saints of the Most High]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 7:27 (#4)

וְכֹלְּ֣ שָׁלְטָנַיָּ֗א לֶֽהֱ יִפְלְחֹ֥ון וְיִשְׁתַּמְּעֽוּן

“and all dominions will serve and make themselves hear him”

Here, **all dominions** represent the rulers who hold that authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and all rulers will serve and make themselves hear him]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 7:27 (#5)

לֶֽהֱ יִפְלְחֹ֥ון וְיִשְׁתַּמְּעֽוּן

“will serve and make themselves hear him”

In this context, the term **hear** has the sense of “obey.” While the form is reflexive in the original, in many languages an active form will convey the meaning accurately. Alternate translation: [will serve and obey him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 7:27 (#6)

לֶֽהֱ יִפְלְחֹ֥ון וְיִשְׁתַּמְּעֽוּן

“will serve and make themselves hear him”

The terms **serve** and **make themselves hear him** mean similar things. Daniel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [will diligently obey him] or [will obey him completely]

See: Doublet

Daniel 7:28 (#1)

עַד־כְּ֥עָה סֹופָ֖א דִּי־מִלְּתָ֑א

“To here {is} the end of the matter”

The words **To here** signal the end of Daniel’s report of what he saw in his vision. Use the natural form in your language for expressing the conclusion of an account. Alternate translation: [That is the end of my report]

See: End of Story

Daniel 7:28 (#2)

וְזִיוַ֣י יִשְׁתַּנְּ֔ון עֲלַ֖י

“and my splendors changed upon me”

Daniel is using **my splendors changed upon me** as a common expression of the culture to mean “my face turned pale.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and my face turned pale]

See: Idiom

Daniel 7:28 (#3)

וּמִלְּתָ֣א בְּלִבְבִ֔י נְטָרַ֖ת

“But I kept the matter in my heart”

Here Daniel is speaking as if his **heart** were a container in which he could keep something. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But I did not tell anyone what I had seen]

See: Metaphor

Daniel - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Daniel sees a vision of a ram, a goat, and a horn that became great (1–14)
2. The angel Gabriel explains the vision to Daniel (15–27)

Translation issues in this chapter

The meaning of the animals in this vision
In the case of this vision, the interpretation that a figure gives to Daniel does specify what the animals represent. Gabriel tells Daniel, “The ram that you saw ... is the kings of Media and Persia” (8:20) and “The male goat is the king of Javan” (that is, Greece, 8:21). There is no reason not to include this specific information in your translation. However, the identity of the king in verses 23–25 is not certain, and we recommend that you not suggest in your translation who this might be.

Daniel 8:1 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שָׁלֹ֔וש לְמַלְכ֖וּת

“In the year of three to the reign of”

The expression **In the year of three** uses a number in a form that means the third year of Belshazzar’s reign. If your language would not represent a number in a form such as this, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [In the third year of the reign of]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel 8:1 (#2)

בֵּלְאשַׁצַּר הַמֶּלֶךְ

“King Belshazzar”

The word **Belshazzar** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 8:1 (#3)

חָזׇון נִרְאָה אֵלַי֙ אֲנִ֣י דָנִיֵּ֔אל

“a vision appeared to me, me, Daniel”

Daniel is stating the pronoun **me** separately, even though the expression **to me** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that the vision he is describing is one that he saw personally. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [to me, Daniel, personally]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 8:1 (#4)

אֵלַי֙ אֲנִ֣י דָנִיֵּ֔אל

“to me, me, Daniel”

Daniel is repeating forms of the word **me** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [to me indeed, Daniel]

See: Reduplication

Daniel 8:1 (#5)

אַחֲרֵ֖י הַנִּרְאָ֥ה אֵלַ֖י בַּתְּחִלָּֽה

“after the one having appeared to me at the first”

The implication is that **the one having appeared to me at the first** refers to the vision that Daniel describes in the previous chapter. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [after the earlier vision that had appeared to me, the one I have just described]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 8:2 (#1)

בְּשׁוּשַׁ֣ן הַבִּירָ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֖ר בְּעֵילָ֣ם הַמְּדִינָ֑ה

“was} in Susa the citadel, which {is} in Elam the province”

The word **Susa** is the name of a city, and the word **Elam** is the name of a province. Later in this verse, **Ulai** is the name of a canal.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 8:3 (#1)

וָאֶשָּׂ֤א עֵינַי֙

“And I lifted up my eyes”

Daniel is using **I lifted up my eyes** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I looked up.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I looked up]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:3 (#2)

וְהִנֵּ֔ה

“and behold”

Daniel is using the word **behold** as if he wanted his readers to look at something, when he actually wants them to pay attention to what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and hear this]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 8:3 (#3)

עֹמֵ֖ד לִפְנֵ֣י הָאֻבָ֑ל

“standing to the face of the canal”

Here, **the face** of the canal represents “the area in front of the canal.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [standing in front of the canal]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 8:3 (#4)

קְרָנַ֔יִם וְהַקְּרָנַ֖יִם

“were} two horns, and the two horns”

In each instance, the expression **two horns** is the dual of "horn." If your language has a dual form, it would be appropriate to use it here.

See: Numbers

Daniel 8:3 (#5)

וְהָאַחַתּ֖ גְּבֹהָ֣ה מִן־הַשֵּׁנִ֑ית וְהַגְּבֹהָ֖ה עֹלָ֥ה בָּאַחֲרֹנָֽה

"but the one was higher than the second, and the higher came up afterward"

Daniel is using the adjectives **the one**, **the second**, and **the higher** as nouns to mean certain horns. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [but one horn was higher than the other horn, and the higher horn came up afterward]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 8:4 (#1)

וְכָל־חַיּ֥וֹתּ לֹא־יַעַמְד֖וּ לְפָנָ֑יו

"and all of the beasts did not stand to its face"

Daniel is using **did not stand to its face** as a common expression of the culture to mean "could not withstand it." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and no beast could withstand it]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:4 (#2)

וְאֵ֣ין מַצִּ֔יל מִיָּדֽוֹ

"and there was none delivering from its hand"

Here, **its hand** represents "its power." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and there was none delivering from its power]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 8:4 (#3)

כִּרְצֹנ֖וֹ

"according to its will"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **will**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [as it wanted]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 8:5 (#1)

וַאֲנִ֖י ׀ הָיִ֣יתִי מֵבִ֑ין

"And I, I was observing"

Daniel is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I was observing** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he was carefully watching this vision as it unfolded. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [I was watching closely]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 8:5 (#2)

עַל־פְּנֵ֥י כָל־הָאָ֖רֶץ

"over the face of all of the earth"

Daniel is using **the face of all of the earth** as a common expression of the culture to mean "the whole surface of the earth." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [over the entire surface of the earth]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:5 (#3)

וְאֵ֥ין נוֹגֵ֖עַ בָּאָֽרֶץ

"but without touching the earth"

The implication is that the goat was moving so swiftly that it seemed not to touch the ground as it ran. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [but moving so swiftly that it seemed not to touch the earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 8:5 (#4)

קֶ֖רֶן חָזוּת֑

"a horn of vision"

Daniel is using **a horn of vision** as a common expression of the culture to mean "a conspicuous horn." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you

could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a prominent horn]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:6 (#1)

בַּבַּעַל הַקְּרָנַיִם

“the master of two horns”

Daniel is using **the master of two horns** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the one that had two horns.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one that had the two horns]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:6 (#2)

הַקְּרָנַיִם

“two horns”

As in verse 3, the expression **two horns** is the dual of “horn.” See how you translated that expression there.

Daniel 8:6 (#3)

לִפְנֵי הָאֻבָל

“to the face of the canal”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of the canal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [beside] or [in front of]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 8:6 (#4)

בַּחֲמַת כֹּחוֹ

“in the heat of its power”

Daniel is using **in the heat of its power** as a common expression of the culture to mean “with furious strength.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with furious strength]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:7 (#1)

וַיִּתְמַרְמַר אֵלָיו

“and it was embittered at it”

Daniel is speaking as if the goat **was embittered** in order to describe how enraged it was at the ram. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the goat was enraged at the ram]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 8:7 (#2)

אֶת־שְׁתֵּי קְרָנָיו

“the two of its horns”

In this instance, the term **horns** is plural, not dual as in verses 3 and 6. Translate this in the way your language would naturally express numbers.

See: Numbers

Daniel 8:7 (#3)

מִיָּדוֹ

“from its hand”

Here, **hand** represents the power/control of the goat. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the goat’s power]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 8:7 (#4)

וְלֹא־הָיָה כֹחַ בָּאַיִל לַעֲמֹד לְפָנָיו

“And the ram was not strong to stand to its face”

Daniel is using **stand to its face** as a common expression of the culture to mean “resist it.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [was not strong enough to resist the goat] or [could not withstand the goat]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:7 (#5)

וַיַּשְׁלִיכֵהוּ אַרְצָה וַיִּרְמְסֵהוּ

“And it cast it to the earth and trampled it”

The first pronoun **it** in this sentence refers to the goat, and the pronouns that follow refer to the ram. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the goat cast the ram to the earth and trampled it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 8:8 (#1)

נִשְׁבְּרָה֙ הַקֶּ֣רֶן הַגְּדוֹלָ֔ה

“the great horn was broken”

The expression **was broken** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [something broke off the great horn]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 8:8 (#2)

לְאַרְבַּ֖ע רוּחֹ֣ות הַשָּׁמָ֑יִם

“toward the four winds of the heavens”

Daniel is speaking as if the four directions were **the four winds of the heavens**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [toward the four directions of the earth]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 8:9 (#1)

וְאֶל־הַצֶּ֖בִי

“and toward the Beauty”

Here, **the Beauty** represents “the land of Israel.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and toward the glorious land of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 8:10 (#1)

צְבָ֣א הַשָּׁמָ֔יִם

“the army of the heavens”

Daniel is speaking of the beings who live in heaven as if they were **the army of the heavens**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the heavenly beings]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 8:11 (#1)

שַׂר־הַצָּבָ֖א

“the commander of the army”

The implication is that **the commander of the army** is God, who rules over the beings who live in heaven. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [God, who commands the army of heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 8:11 (#2)

וּמִמֶּ֣נּוּ֮ הרים הַתָּמִ֣יד וְהֻשְׁלַ֣ךְ מְכ֣וֹן מִקְדָּשֹׁ֑ו

“And the perpetual sacrifice was removed from him, and the place of his sanctuary was cast down”

The expressions **was removed** and **was cast down** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And it took away the perpetual sacrifice from him, and it threw down the place of his sanctuary]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 8:11 (#3)

הַתָּמִ֣יד

“the perpetual sacrifice”

The implication is that **the perpetual sacrifice** is the offering that the priests presented to God every morning and every evening. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the sacrifice that the priests offered to God every morning and evening]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 8:12 (#1)

תִּנָּתֵ֥ן

“will be given over”

The expression **will be given over** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will hand an army over]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 8:12 (#2)

וְתַשְׁלֵ֥ךְ אֱמֶ֖תָּה אַ֣רְצָה

“and it will cast truth to the ground”

Daniel is speaking as if truth were an object that could be thrown down when he says that the horn **will cast truth to the ground**. Your language may have

a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will utterly reject the truth]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 8:12 (#3)

וְעָשְׂתָה וְהִצְלִיחָה

“And it will do and succeed”

The phrase **do and succeed** expresses a single idea. The word **succeed** tells more about **do**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [And it will do whatever it wishes with success]

See: Hendiadys

Daniel 8:13 (#1)

וָאֶשְׁמְעָה אֶחָד־קָדוֹשׁ מְדַבֵּר

“And I heard a holy one speaking”

The implication is that **a holy one** is an angel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And I heard a holy angel speaking]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 8:13 (#2)

תֵּתֶת וְקֹדֶשׁ וְצָבָא מִרְמָס

“the giving {of} both the sanctuary and the army for trampling”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **the giving**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [that God will give over for trampling both the sanctuary and the army]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 8:13 (#3)

מִרְמָס

“for trampling”

The holy one is speaking of the defeat and desecration of the sanctuary and the army as if enemies would crush them underfoot, since they have been given **for trampling**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to be crushed by enemies]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 8:14 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָי

“And he said to me”

The pronoun **he** refers to the holy one who was speaking, whom Daniel mentioned first in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And that first holy one said to me]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 8:14 (#2)

אֵלָי

“to me”

Some ancient manuscripts read “to me.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “to him.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Daniel 8:14 (#3)

עַד עֶרֶב בֹּקֶר אַלְפַּיִם וּשְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת

“Until evening, morning, 2,300”

The number **2,300** counts pairs of an evening and a morning, that is, the times when the priests presented the perpetual sacrifice. Translate this number according to the conventions of your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [Until 2,300 evenings and mornings have passed]

See: Numbers

Daniel 8:14 (#4)

עַד עֶרֶב בֹּקֶר

“Until evening, morning”

The holy one is referring to all of each day by naming two major components, **evening** and **morning**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Until there have passed full days numbering]

See: Merism

Daniel 8:14 (#5)

וְנִצְדַּק קֹדֶשׁ

“Then the sanctuary will be made right”

The expression **will be made right** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Then God will make the sanctuary right]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 8:15 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“And behold”

Daniel is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [And listen]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 8:15 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה עֹמֵד לְנֶגְדִּי

“And behold, one standing to my face”

Daniel is introducing **one standing to my face** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [And suddenly there was someone standing in front of me]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 8:15 (#3)

וְהִנֵּה עֹמֵד לְנֶגְדִּי

“And behold, one standing to my face”

Daniel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. It may be helpful to supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [behold, I saw one standing in front of me]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 8:15 (#4)

כְּמַרְאֵה־גָבֶר

“according to the appearance of a man”

Daniel says that this being was **according to the appearance of a man**. The point of this comparison is that the one standing before him looked like a human being, although he was not actually a man. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [who looked like a human being, although he was not one]

See: Simile

Daniel 8:16 (#1)

בֵּין אוּלָי

“between the Ulai”

Daniel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [coming from between the banks of the Ulai]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 8:16 (#2)

הָבֵן לְהַלָּז אֶת־הַמַּרְאֶה

“make this one understand the appearance”

The pronoun **this one** refers to Daniel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [make Daniel understand the appearance]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 8:17 (#1)

וַיָּבֹא אֵצֶל עָמְדִי

“And he came beside my standing”

Daniel is using **beside my standing** as a common expression of the culture to mean “to the place where I was standing.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he came to the place where I was standing]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:17 (#2)

וָאֶפָּלָה עַל־פָּנָי

“and fell on my face”

Falling face down on the ground was a symbolic action by which Daniel showed fear and reverence in the presence of this heavenly messenger. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and fell down with my face to the ground to show reverence]

See: Symbolic Action

Daniel 8:17 (#3)

בֶּן־אָדָם

“son of man”

Gabriel is using **son of man** as a common expression of the culture to mean “mortal human being.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [human being]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:19 (#1)

הִנֵּנִי מוֹדִיעֲךָ

“Behold me, making you know”

Gabriel is using **Behold me, making you know** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I am about to make you know.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am about to tell you]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:19 (#2)

בְּאַחֲרִית הַזַּעַם

“at the end of the indignation”

The implication is that **the indignation** is God’s anger against sinful people. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at the end of God’s anger against sinners]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 8:20 (#1)

הָאַיִל אֲשֶׁר־רָאִיתָ בַּבַּעַל הַקְּרָנָיִם מַלְכֵי מָדַי וּפָרָס

“The ram that you saw, a master of two horns, {is} the kings of Media and Persia”

Gabriel is speaking as if **The ram** that Daniel saw were the same thing as the kings of Media and Persia, when he means that the ram represents them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The ram that you saw, a master of two horns, represents the kings of Media and Persia]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 8:21 (#1)

יָוָן

“Javan”

The word **Javan** is the name of a people group. The home of those people is known in many languages today as “Greece.” You could use that name in your translation if this would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Greece]

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 8:21 (#2)

וְהַקֶּרֶן הַגְּדוֹלָה אֲשֶׁר בֵּין־עֵינָיו הִוא הַמֶּלֶךְ הָרִאשׁוֹן

“and the great horn that {was} between its eyes, it {is} the first king”

Gabriel names **the great horn** first and then refers back to it with the pronoun **it**. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the horn and the information about the king together in a single statement. Alternate translation: [and the great horn that was between its eyes represents the first king]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 8:22 (#1)

וְלֹא בְכֹחוֹ

“but not with its power”

Gabriel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but they will not stand with the power it has]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 8:23 (#1)

וּבְאַחֲרִית מַלְכוּתָם

“And at the end of their rule”

The pronoun **their** refers to the four kingdoms that Gabriel described in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And at the end of these kingdoms’ rule]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 8:23 (#2)

כְּהָתֵם הַפֹּשְׁעִים

“when transgressors are complete”

Gabriel is using **when transgressors are complete** as a common expression of the culture to mean "when sinful people have done all the evil that they will do." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when sinful people have finished doing all their evil]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:23 (#3)

הַפֹּשְׁעִ֔ים

"transgressors"

Some ancient manuscripts read "transgressors." The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read "transgressions." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Daniel 8:23 (#4)

עַז־פָּנִ֖ים

"strong of face"

Gabriel is using **strong of face** as a common expression of the culture to mean "fierce and insolent." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [having a fierce and shameless manner]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:23 (#5)

וּמֵבִ֥ין חִידֹֽות

"and understanding riddles"

Gabriel is using **understanding riddles** as a common expression of the culture to mean "skilled at scheming." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and skilled at scheming]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:24 (#1)

וְעָצַ֥ם כֹּח֖וֹ וְלֹ֣א בְכֹחֹ֑ו

"And his power will be mighty, but not by his power"

The implication is that this king's strength will come from a source outside himself, since God will allow him to become powerful. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And his power will be mighty, but the strength will not come from himself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 8:24 (#2)

וְהִצְלִ֖יחַ וְעָשָׂ֑ה

"and he will succeed and do"

The phrase **succeed and do** expresses a single idea. The word **succeed** tells more about **do**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [he will do whatever he wants and be successful at it]

See: Hendiadys

Daniel 8:24 (#3)

וְהִשְׁחִ֣ית עֲצוּמִ֔ים

"And he will destroy the mighty"

Gabriel is using the adjective **the mighty** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [And he will destroy powerful people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 8:24 (#4)

וְעַם־קְדֹשִׁ֖ים

"and the people of the holy {ones"

Gabriel is using the possessive form to describe a **people** that is characterized by being **holy**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and the holy people]

See: Possession

Daniel 8:25 (#1)

וְעַל־שִׂכְלֹ֥ו

"And by his cunning"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **cunning**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And because he acts shrewdly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 8:25 (#2)

וְהִצְלִ֥יחַ מִרְמָ֖ה בְּיָדֹֽו

“he will also make deceit succeed under his hand”

Here, **his hand** represents “his control.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [he will also make deceit succeed under his control]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 8:25 (#3)

וּבִלְבָבֹ֖ו יַגְדִּ֑יל

“And in his heart, he will make {himself} great”

Gabriel is using the expression **in his heart** together with the words that follow as a common expression of the culture to mean “he will become arrogant.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will become arrogant]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:25 (#4)

שַׂר־שָׂרִ֖ים

“the Prince of princes”

The implication is that **the Prince of princes** is God, who rules over every other ruler. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [God, the Prince over all princes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 8:25 (#5)

וּבְאֶ֥פֶס יָ֖ד יִשָּׁבֵֽר

“but he will be broken by no hand”

The expression **will be broken** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but no hand will break him]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 8:25 (#6)

וּבְאֶ֥פֶס יָ֖ד יִשָּׁבֵֽר

“but he will be broken by no hand”

Here, **hand** represents “human power.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [but he will be broken by no human power]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 8:26 (#1)

וּמַרְאֵ֥ה הָעֶ֛רֶב וְהַבֹּ֖קֶר

“And the appearance of the evening and the morning”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **the appearance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And what was seen concerning the evening and the morning]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 8:26 (#2)

אֱשֶׁ֥ר נֶאֱמַ֖ר

“that was told”

The expression **was told** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that I told you]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 8:26 (#3)

סְתֹ֣ם הֶֽחָזֹ֑ון

“close up the vision”

Gabriel is speaking as if the vision were a document that Daniel could **close up**, when he means that Daniel should keep its message secret. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [keep the vision secret]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 8:26 (#4)

כִּ֥י לְיָמִ֖ים רַבִּֽים

“for it is for many days”

Gabriel is using **for many days** as a common expression of the culture to mean “about a time far in the

future." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for it refers to a time far in the future]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:27 (#1)

וַאֲנִי דָּנִיֵּאל נִהְיֵיתִי

"Then I, Daniel, was finished"

Daniel is using **was finished** as a common expression of the culture to mean "was completely exhausted." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Then I, Daniel, was completely exhausted]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:27 (#2)

וְנֶחֱלֵיתִי יָמִים

"and I was sickened {for} days"

The expression **was sickened** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and I was ill for days]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 8:27 (#3)

אֶת־מְלֶאכֶת הַמֶּלֶךְ

"the business of the king"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **the business**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what the king required me to do]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 8:27 (#4)

וָאֶשְׁתּוֹמֵם עַל־הַמַּרְאֶה

"But I was desolate at the vision"

Daniel is using **I was desolate** as a common expression of the culture to mean "I was appalled." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But I was appalled by the vision]

See: Idiom

Daniel 8:27 (#5)

וְאֵין מֵבִין

"and not understanding"

Daniel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and I was not understanding it]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Daniel prays, based on Jeremiah's prophecy, that God will restore Jerusalem (1–19)
2. Gabriel comes and explains a further meaning of Jeremiah's prophecy (20–27)

Translation issues in this chapter

What are the "seventy sevens" that Gabriel describes (9:24)?
The Hebrew word for "seven" can also mean a "week," that is, a period of seven days, and so some translators say "seventy weeks" here. Some interpreters understand the term in this context to mean a "week of years," that is, seven years, and so some translations say "490 years." However, these meanings are not certain. It is also possible that the number seven is being used to symbolize completeness rather than to indicate a specific total of years. So we encourage translators to use general expressions that allow for the range of possible interpretations rather than naming a specific total such as 490. The UST models one way to do this. It translates "seventy sevens" as "seventy sets of seven time periods."

Daniel 9:1 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת אַחַת לְדָרְיָוֶשׁ

"In the year of one to Darius"

The original language uses a cardinal number, **one**, where your language might use an ordinal number. If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **In the year of one to Darius**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [In the first year of Darius]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel 9:1 (#2)

בֶּן־אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ מִזֶּרַע מָדָי אֲשֶׁר הָמְלַךְ עַל מַלְכוּת כַּשְׂדִּים

“the son of Ahasuerus, from the seed of Madai, who had been made king over the kingdom of the Chaldeans”

Daniel is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Daniel 9:1 (#3)

מִזֶּרַע מָדָי

“from the seed of Madai”

Daniel is speaking as if Darius were **seed** that had come from Madai. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a descendant of Madai]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:1 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר הָמְלַךְ

“who had been made king”

The expression **who had been made king** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [who reigned as king]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 9:1 (#5)

בִּשְׁנַת אַחַת לְדָרְיָוֶשׁ בֶּן־אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ מִזֶּרַע מָדָי אֲשֶׁר הָמְלַךְ עַל מַלְכוּת כַּשְׂדִּים

“In the year of one to Darius, the son of Ahasuerus, from the seed of Madai, who had been made king over the kingdom of the Chaldeans”

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine 9:1 and 9:2 into a verse bridge, as the UST does, in order to keep the information about the date of Darius’s reign together.

See: Verse Bridges

Daniel 9:2 (#1)

בִּינֹתִי בַּסְּפָרִים

“perceived in the scrolls”

The implication is that **the scrolls** were the writings of the prophets. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [perceived in the sacred scrolls written by the prophets]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 9:2 (#2)

מִסְפַּר הַשָּׁנִים אֲשֶׁר הָיָה דְבַר־יְהוָה אֶל־יִרְמְיָה הַנָּבִיא לְמַלְּאוֹת לְחָרְבוֹת יְרוּשָׁלַם שִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה

“the number of years that was the word of Yahweh to Jeremiah the prophet for the filling of the desolations of Jerusalem, seventy years”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **seventy years** with the information about **the number of years**. Alternate translation: [the number of years, seventy of them, that was the word of Yahweh to Jeremiah the prophet for the filling of the desolations of Jerusalem]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 9:2 (#3)

לְמַלְּאוֹת לְחָרְבוֹת יְרוּשָׁלַם

“for the filling of the desolations of Jerusalem”

Daniel is using **the filling of the desolations of Jerusalem** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the completion of the years during which Jerusalem would lie in ruins.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for the completion of the time during which Jerusalem would lie in ruins]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:2 (#4)

לְחָרְבוֹת יְרוּשָׁלַם

“the desolations of Jerusalem”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **desolations**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the days in which Jerusalem would lie devastated]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 9:3 (#1)

וָאֶתְּנָה אֶת־פָּנַי אֶל־אֲדֹנָי הָאֱלֹהִים

“And I set my face to the Lord God”

Daniel is using **I set my face to the Lord God** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I gave my full attention to the Lord God.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I turned my full attention to the Lord God]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:3 (#2)

תְּפִלָּה וְתַחֲנוּנִים

“by} prayer and supplications”

The terms **prayer** and **supplications** mean similar things. Daniel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [by earnest pleading]

See: Doublet

Daniel 9:3 (#3)

בְּצוֹם וְשַׂק וָאֵפֶר

“with fasting and sackcloth and ashes”

Going without food, wearing rough cloth, and putting ashes on oneself were symbolic actions by which Daniel showed that he was mourning over sin and humbling himself before God. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of these actions in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [with fasting and sackcloth and ashes to show that I was mourning and humbling myself]

See: Symbolic Action

Daniel 9:3 (#4)

וָאֵפֶר

“and ashes”

In this verse, the word **ashes** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the particles of ashes as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “ashes.” Alternate translation: [and ash particles]

See: Collective Nouns

Daniel 9:4 (#1)

וָאֶתְפַּלְלָה לַיהוָה אֱלֹהָי וָאֶתְוַדֶּה וָאֹמְרָה

“And I prayed to Yahweh my God, and I confessed and said”

Daniel is using three verbs, **I prayed**, **I confessed**, and **said**, to introduce a single direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Daniel 9:4 (#2)

אָנְנָא אֲדֹנָי

“Oh Lord”

Daniel is using a phrase that expresses a strong feeling of urgent appeal to God. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [Please, Lord]

See: Exclamations

Daniel 9:4 (#3)

הָאֵל הַגָּדוֹל וְהַנּוֹרָא

“the great and feared God”

The terms **great** and **feared** mean similar things. Daniel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the awesome God]

See: Doublet

Daniel 9:4 (#4)

שֹׁמֵר הַבְּרִית וְהַחֶסֶד

“the one keeping covenant and covenant faithfulness”

The terms **keeping covenant** and **covenant faithfulness** mean similar things. Daniel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the one faithfully keeping his covenant]

See: Doublet

Daniel 9:4 (#5)

הַבְּרִית וְהַחֶסֶד

“covenant and covenant faithfulness”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **covenant** and **faithfulness**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [what he promised, and acting faithfully]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 9:4 (#6)

לְאֹהֲבָיו וּלְשֹׁמְרֵי מִצְוֹתָיו

“to the ones loving him and to the keepers of his commandments”

Even though Daniel is addressing God directly, he is speaking of him in the third person as **him** and **his** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [to the ones loving you and to the keepers of your commandments]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Daniel 9:4 (#7)

לְאֹהֲבָיו וּלְשֹׁמְרֵי מִצְוֹתָיו

“to the ones loving him and to the keepers of his commandments”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [to the ones who show that they truly love him by keeping his commandments]

See: Parallelism

Daniel 9:5 (#1)

חָטָאנוּ

“we have sinned”

By **we**, Daniel means himself and his fellow Israelites but not the one to whom he is speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Daniel 9:5 (#2)

וְעָוִינוּ

“and committed iniquity”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **iniquity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and acted perversely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 9:5 (#3)

וְסָרְנוּ מִמִּצְוֹתֶיךָ וּמִמִּשְׁפָּטֶיךָ

“turning away from your commandments and your judgments”

Daniel is speaking as if refusing to obey God’s commands were **turning away** from them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [refusing to obey your commandments and your judgments]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:5 (#4)

מִמִּצְוֹתֶיךָ וּמִמִּשְׁפָּטֶיךָ

“from your commandments and your judgments”

The terms **your commandments** and **your judgments** mean similar things. Daniel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [turning away from all of your laws]

See: Doublet

Daniel 9:6 (#1)

וְלֹא שָׁמַעְנוּ אֶל־עֲבָדֶיךָ הַנְּבִיאִים

“And we have not listened to your servants the prophets”

Daniel is using **we have not listened to** as a common expression of the culture to mean “we have not obeyed.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And we have not obeyed your servants the prophets]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:6 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר דִּבְּרוּ בְשִׁמְךָ

“who spoke in your name”

Here, **your name** represents “your authority.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [who spoke by your authority]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 9:6 (#3)

וַאֲבֹתֵֽינוּ

“and our fathers”

Daniel is speaking as if all of the earlier generations of the Israelites were their **fathers**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and our forefathers]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:7 (#1)

לְךָ֤ אֲדֹנָי֙ הַצְּדָקָ֔ה

“To you, Lord, {is} righteousness”

Daniel is using this expression as a common expression of the culture to mean “You, Lord, have always done what is right.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You, Lord, have always done what is right]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:7 (#2)

בּ֚שֶׁת הַפָּנִ֔ים

“is} shame of faces”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **shame**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [belong faces that show we are ashamed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 9:7 (#3)

בּ֚שֶׁת הַפָּנִ֔ים

“is} shame of faces”

Daniel is using **faces** to represent the whole person who is ashamed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is complete disgrace]

See: Synecdoche

Daniel 9:7 (#4)

כַּיּ֣וֹם הַזֶּ֔ה

“as this day”

Daniel is using **as this day** as a common expression of the culture to mean “as is the case at the present time.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as is the case at the present time]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:7 (#5)

לְאִ֣ישׁ יְהוּדָ֔ה

“to a man of Judah”

In this verse, the word **man** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the people of Judah as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “man.” Alternate translation: [to the men of Judah]

See: Collective Nouns

Daniel 9:7 (#6)

הַקְּרֹבִ֥ים וְהָרְחֹקִ֖ים

“the near and the far”

Daniel is using the adjectives **near** and **far** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [the ones who are nearby and the ones who are far away]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 9:7 (#7)

בְּכָל־הָאֲרָצוֹת֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר הִדַּחְתָּ֔ם שָׁ֖ם

“in all of the lands where you have driven them there”

It might seem that the expression **where you have driven them there** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [in all of the lands to which you have driven them]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Daniel 9:8 (#1)

לְמַלְכֵּ֣ינוּ לְשָׂרֵ֔ינוּ וְלַאֲבֹתֵ֖ינוּ

“to our kings, to our princes, and to our fathers”

Daniel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be com-

plete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to our kings, our princes, and our fathers there is also complete disgrace]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 9:9 (#1)

לַאדֹנָי אֱלֹהֵינוּ הָרַחֲמִים וְהַסְּלִחוֹת כִּי מָרַדְנוּ בּוֹ

“To the Lord our God, {may there be} compassion and forgiveness, for we have rebelled against him”

Even though Daniel is addressing God directly, he is speaking of him in the third person as **the Lord our God** and **him** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [To you, our Lord and God, we pray for compassion and forgiveness, for we have rebelled against you]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Daniel 9:9 (#2)

הָרַחֲמִים וְהַסְּלִחוֹת

“may there be} compassion and forgiveness”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **compassion** and **forgiveness**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [we ask that you would act compassionately and forgive us]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 9:10 (#1)

בְּקוֹל יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ

“to the voice of Yahweh our God”

Here, **the voice of Yahweh our God** represents “what Yahweh our God commanded.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to what Yahweh our God commanded]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 9:10 (#2)

לָלֶכֶת בְּתוֹרֹתָיו

“to walk in his laws”

Daniel is speaking as if obeying God’s laws were **to walk in** them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to obey his laws]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:10 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לְפָנֵינוּ

“that he gave to our faces”

Here, **our faces** represents “us.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [that he gave to us]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 9:10 (#4)

בְּיַד עֲבָדָיו הַנְּבִיאִים

“by the hand of his servants the prophets”

Here, **the hand** represents the agency of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [through his servants the prophets]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 9:11 (#1)

וַתִּתַּדְּ עָלֵינוּ הָאָלָה וְהַשְּׁבוּעָה אֲשֶׁשֶׁר כְּתוּבָה בְּתוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה

“And the oath has been poured out on us, and the curse, that is written in the law of Moses”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **the curse** with the information about **the oath**. Alternate translation: [And the oath and the curse have been poured out on us, which are written in the law of Moses]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 9:11 (#2)

וַתִּתַּדְּ עָלֵינוּ הָאָלָה וְהַשְּׁבוּעָה

“And the oath has been poured out on us, and the curse”

Daniel is speaking as if the oath and the curse were a liquid that could be **poured out** on the Israelites. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And we have experienced the oath and the curse]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:11 (#3)

וַתִּתַּדְּ עָלֵינוּ הָאָלָה

“And the oath has been poured out on us”

The expression **has been poured out** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And you have poured out the oath]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 9:11 (#4)

אֲשֶׁשֶׁר כְּתוּבָה

“that is written”

The expression **that is written** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that God had written]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 9:12 (#1)

וַיָּ֫קֶם אֶת־דבריו

“And he has made stand his word”

Daniel is using **made stand his word** as a common expression of the culture to mean “fulfilled his word.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [kept his word] or [done what he said he would do]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:12 (#2)

אֲשֶׁשֶׁר לֹא־נֶעֱשְׂתָה תַּחַת כָּל־הַשָּׁמַיִם כַּאֲשֶׁשֶׁר נֶעֱשְׂתָה בִּירוּשָׁלָם

“that has not been done under all of the heavens like what has been done to Jerusalem”

The expressions **has not been done** and **has been done** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that he has not done anywhere under all of the heavens like what he has done to Jerusalem]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 9:13 (#1)

וְלֹא־חִלִּ֫ינוּ אֶת־פְּנֵי ׀ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵ֫ינוּ

“but we have not entreated the face of Yahweh our God”

Daniel is using **the face** to represent Yahweh himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but we have not entreated Yahweh our God himself]

See: Synecdoche

Daniel 9:13 (#2)

לָשׁוּב֫ מֵעֲוֹנֵ֫נוּ

“to return from our iniquities”

Daniel is speaking as if abandoning sin were **to return from** a place where the people had been. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to turn away from our iniquities] or [to repent of our sin]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:14 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁקֹ֫ד יְהוָה֫ עַל־הָרָעָ֫ה

“And Yahweh watched over the trouble”

Daniel is using **Yahweh watched over the trouble** as a common expression of the culture to mean “Yahweh kept the disaster ready to send.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh watched for the right time to bring the disaster]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:15 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֫תָּה ׀ אֲדֹנָ֫י אֱלֹהֵ֫ינוּ

“And now, Lord our God”

The words **And now** mark a transition from Daniel’s confession to his request. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [So then, Lord our God]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Daniel 9:15 (#2)

בְּיָ֫ד חֲזָקָ֫ה

“with a mighty hand”

Here, **a mighty hand** represents “great power.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use

an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [with your mighty strength]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 9:15 (#3)

וַתַּעַשׂ־לְךָ שֵׁשֵׁם

“and made a name for yourself”

Here, **a name** represents “a reputation.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and made a reputation for yourself]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 9:16 (#1)

כְּכָל־צִדְקֹתֶיךָ

“according to all of your righteousnesses”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousnesses**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [according to your righteous deeds]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 9:16 (#2)

כְּכָל־צִדְקֹתֶיךָ

“according to all of your righteousnesses”

The phrase **according to all of your righteousnesses** probably refers initially to Yahweh’s “righteous acts,” that is, his acts of deliverance, supremely in the Exodus, described in v. 15. But in light of the overall prayer, it also refers to his righteous character (vv. 7, 14). This phrase could mean: (1) [in keeping with your acts of deliverance] or (2) [because you always do what is right]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:16 (#3)

כְּכָל־צִדְקֹתֶיךָ

“according to all of your righteousnesses”

The implication is that **your righteousnesses** are the righteous deeds by which Yahweh had rescued his people in the past. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [according to all of the righteous deeds by which you have rescued us in the past]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 9:16 (#4)

יָשָׁב־נָא אַפְּךָ וַחֲמָתְךָ

“may your nose and your heat please turn back”

Daniel is using **your nose and your heat** as a common expression of the culture to mean “your burning anger.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [may you please turn your fierce anger away]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:16 (#5)

הַר־קָדְשֶׁךָ

“the mountain of your holiness”

Daniel is using the possessive form to describe a **mountain** that is characterized by **holiness**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [your holy mountain]

See: Possession

Daniel 9:16 (#6)

הַר־קָדְשֶׁךָ

“the mountain of your holiness”

The implication is that **the mountain of your holiness** is Mount Zion, where the temple stood. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [your holy mountain, Mount Zion]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 9:17 (#1)

אֶל־תְּפִלַּת עַבְדְּךָ וְאֶל־תַּחֲנוּנָיו

“to the prayer of your servant and to his supplications”

Even though Daniel is speaking about himself, he refers to himself in the third person as **your servant** to show humility before God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [listen to my prayer, your servant, and to my supplications]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Daniel 9:17 (#2)

וְהָאֵ֣ר פָּנֶ֔יךָ עַל־מִקְדָּשְׁךָ֖ הַשָּׁמֵֽם

“and make your face shine on your desolate sanctuary”

Daniel is speaking as if Yahweh’s favor were light shining from his **face** onto the sanctuary. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and show your favor to your desolate sanctuary]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:17 (#3)

לְמַ֥עַן אֲדֹנָֽי

“for the sake of the Lord”

Even though Daniel is addressing Yahweh directly, he is speaking of him in the third person as **the Lord** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [for your own sake, my Lord]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Daniel 9:18 (#1)

הַטֵּ֤ה אֱלֹהַי֙ ׀ אָזְנְךָ֣ וּשְׁמָ֔עׇה

“Incline your ear, my God, and hear”

Daniel is using **Incline your ear** as a common expression of the culture to mean “please give me your attention.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Pay attention, my God, and hear]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:18 (#2)

פקחה עֵינֶ֔יךָ וּרְאֵ֖ה

“Open your eyes and see”

Daniel is using **Open your eyes** as a common expression of the culture to mean “pay attention.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Pay attention and consider]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:18 (#3)

שְׁמָמֹתֵ֔ינוּ וְהָעִ֕יר אֲשֶׁר־נִקְרָ֥א שִׁמְךָ֖ עָלֶ֑יהָ

“our desolations and the city upon which your name is called”

The phrase **our desolations and the city upon which your name is called** expresses a single idea. The word **desolations** describes the state of **the city**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [the desolations of our city, upon which your name is called] or [the city upon which your name is called, which lies in desolation]

See: Hendiadys

Daniel 9:18 (#4)

וְהָעִ֕יר אֲשֶׁר־נִקְרָ֥א שִׁמְךָ֖ עָלֶ֑יהָ

“and the city upon which your name is called”

The expression **your name is called** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the city upon which you have put your name]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 9:18 (#5)

וְהָעִ֕יר אֲשֶׁר־נִקְרָ֥א שִׁמְךָ֖ עָלֶ֑יהָ

“and the city upon which your name is called”

Daniel is using **the city upon which your name is called** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the city that is your own possession.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the city that is your own possession]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:18 (#6)

מַפִּילִ֥ים תַּחֲנוּנֵ֖ינוּ לְפָנֶ֑יךָ

“are & making our supplications fall to your face”

Daniel is using **making our supplications fall to your face** as a common expression of the culture to mean “presenting our requests to you.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the mean-

ing plainly. Alternate translation: [are not laying our petitions before you]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:18 (#7)

רַחֲמֶיךָ הָרַבִּים

“your great mercies”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **mercies**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how very merciful you are]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 9:19 (#1)

אֲדֹנָי ׀ שְׁמָעָה אֲדֹנָי ׀ סְלָחָה אֲדֹנָי הַקְשִׁיבָה וַעֲשֵׂה

“Lord, hear! Lord, forgive! Lord, pay attention and act”

The words translated as **hear**, **forgive**, **pay attention** and **act** are imperatives, but they communicate a request rather than a command. If the imperative does not communicate a request for your readers, then use a form in your language that communicates a request. Alternate translation: [Lord, I ask you to hear! Lord, I beg you to forgive! Lord, I plead with you to pay attention and act]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Daniel 9:20 (#1)

וְעוֹד אֲנִי מְדַבֵּר וּמִתְפַּלֵּל וּמִתְוַדֶּה חַטָּאתִי וְחַטַּאת עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמַפִּיל תְּחִנָּתִי לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהָי עַל הַר־קׇדֶשׁ אֱלֹהָי

“And I was still speaking and praying and confessing my sin and the sin of my people Israel and making my supplication fall to the face of Yahweh my God for the mountain of the holiness of my God”

You can create a verse bridge for these two verses, 20–21, in order not to repeat the information “I was still speaking.” The UST models one way to do that.

See: Verse Bridges

Daniel 9:20 (#2)

וְעוֹד אֲנִי מְדַבֵּר וּמִתְפַּלֵּל וּמִתְוַדֶּה חַטָּאתִי וְחַטַּאת עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמַפִּיל תְּחִנָּתִי לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהָי עַל הַר־קׇדֶשׁ אֱלֹהָי

“And I was still speaking and praying and confessing my sin and the sin of my people Israel and making my supplication fall to the face of Yahweh my God for the mountain of the holiness of my God”

The words that the ULT translates as **And I was still speaking** indicate that Gabriel came to Daniel at the same time as when Daniel was praying. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe the time relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [While I was still speaking and praying and confessing my sin and the sin of my people Israel and presenting my supplication before Yahweh my God for the holy mountain of my God]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Daniel 9:21 (#1)

וְהָאִישׁ גַּבְרִיאֵל אֲשֶׁר־ רָאִיתִי בֶחָזוֹן בַּתְּחִלָּה

“and the man Gabriel whom I had seen in the vision at the beginning”

Daniel is reintroducing **the man Gabriel**, whom he had described earlier, as a participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of reintroducing participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [and Gabriel, the same man whom I had seen earlier in the vision]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 9:21 (#2)

וְהָאִישׁ גַּבְרִיאֵל

“and the man Gabriel”

The implication is that Gabriel was an angel, and Daniel calls him **the man** because Gabriel appeared in human form. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the angel Gabriel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 9:21 (#3)

כְּעֵת מִנְחַת־עָרֶב

“at the time of the offering of the evening”

The implication is that **the offering of the evening** was the sacrifice that the priests offered every day at that time. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at the time when the priests presented the daily evening sacrifice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 9:22 (#1)

וַיָּבֶן וַיְדַבֵּר עִמִּי וַיֹּאמַר

“And he made me understand and he spoke with me and said”

Daniel is describing one event, Gabriel making him understand, before describing another event that preceded it, Gabriel speaking with him. If it would be helpful in your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened, as in the UST.

See: Order of Events

Daniel 9:22 (#2)

לְהַשְׂכִּילְךָ בִינָה

“to make you wise {for} understanding”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **understanding**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to enable you to understand wisely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 9:23 (#1)

יָצָא דָבָר

“a word came forth”

The implication is that **a word came forth** from God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a word came forth from God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 9:23 (#2)

וַאֲנִי֙ בָּאתִי

“and I, I have come”

Gabriel is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I have come** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he himself has come immediately to answer Daniel’s prayer. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [I have indeed come]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 9:23 (#3)

כִּֽי־ חֲמוּדוֹת אָתָּה

“for you {are} desirablenesses”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **desirablenesses**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for you are very precious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 9:23 (#4)

כִּֽי־ חֲמוּדוֹת אָתָּה

“for you {are} desirablenesses”

Gabriel is using the term **desirablenesses** as a common expression of the culture to mean “one whom God loves greatly.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for you are one whom God loves greatly]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:23 (#5)

וּבִ֥ין בַּדָּבָ֖ר וְהָבֵ֥ן בַּמַּרְאֶֽה

“So understand the word and understand the appearance”

In the original language, the first **understand** is “Qal,” and the second **understand** is from “Hiphil.” The meaning of the second is not to “make understood” but ingressive, to “come to understand.” Some languages may have forms that they can use to express these slightly different meanings. Alternate translation: [So consider this message and grasp the meaning of this vision] or [Therefore, ponder the message and begin to understand the meaning of the vision]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 9:24 (#1)

שָׁבֻעִ֣ים שִׁבְעִ֔ים נֶחְתַּ֖ךְ

“Seventy sevens have been determined”

The expression **have been determined** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God has determined seventy sevens]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 9:24 (#2)

שָׁבֻעִ֣ים שִׁבְעִ֔ים

“Seventy sevens”

The expression **Seventy sevens** refers to seventy units of seven. Translate this number according to the conventions of your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [Seventy periods of seven]

See: Numbers

Daniel 9:24 (#3)

לְכַלֵּא הַפֶּשַׁע ולחתם חטאות וּלְכַפֵּר עָוֹן וּלְהָבִיא צֶדֶק עֹלָמִים

“to finish transgression and to seal up sins and to cover iniquity and to bring in righteousness of eternities”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **transgression**, **sins**, **iniquity**, and **righteousness**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [to stop people from transgressing and to seal up what they have done wrongly and to cover what they have done perversely and to bring in what is eternally right]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 9:24 (#4)

ולחתם חטאות

“and to seal up sins”

Gabriel is speaking as if putting an end to sins were **to seal up** a container so that nothing more could come out of it. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and to put an end to sins]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:24 (#5)

וּלְכַפֵּר עָוֹן

“and to cover iniquity”

Gabriel is speaking as if forgiving iniquity were **to cover** it so that it could no longer be seen. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and to forgive iniquity]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:24 (#6)

וְלַחְתֹּם חָזוֹן וְנָבִיא

“and to seal up vision and prophecy”

Gabriel is speaking as if bringing about what the prophets foretold were **to seal up** a document to certify it. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and to fulfill vision and prophecy]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:24 (#7)

וְלִמְשֹׁחַ קֹדֶשׁ קָדָשִׁים

“and to anoint the Holy of Holies”

This could mean: (1) **the Holy of Holies** refers to the most holy place in the temple or (2) it refers to a most holy person. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and to anoint the most holy place in the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 9:25 (#1)

וְתֵדַע וְתַשְׂכֵּל

“And may you know and understand”

The terms **know** and **understand** mean similar things. Gabriel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [And may you understand this clearly]

See: Doublet

Daniel 9:25 (#2)

מִן־מֹצָא דָבָר לְהָשִׁיב וְלִבְנוֹת יְרוּשָׁלַ͏ִם

“from the going forth of the word to return and to build Jerusalem”

Gabriel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [from the time when a king issues the command to return and to build Jerusalem]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 9:25 (#3)

מֹצָא דָבָר

“the going forth of the word”

The implication is that **the going forth of the word** is the issuing of a royal decree. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the issuing of the royal decree]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 9:25 (#4)

לְהָשִׁיבֵ֞

“to return”

Here **return** is an idiom meaning “do again.” Alternate translation: [to build Jerusalem again] or [to rebuild Jerusalem]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:25 (#5)

תָּשׁוּבֵ֞ וְנִבְנְתָ֣ה

“It will return and it will be built”

As in the instance of “return” earlier in this verse, here **It will return and it will be built** means “It will be built again.” Alternate translation: [It will be built again] or [It will be rebuilt]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:25 (#6)

שִׁשִּׁ֤ים וּשְׁנַ֙יִם֙

“sixty and two”

The expression **sixty and two** describes a single number. Translate this number according to the conventions of your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [sixty-two]

See: Numbers

Daniel 9:25 (#7)

תָּשׁוּבֵ֞

“It will return”

The pronoun **It** refers to Jerusalem. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Jerusalem will return]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 9:25 (#8)

וְנִבְנְתָ֣ה רְחֹ֔וב וְחָרֻ֖וץ

“and it will be built {with} a square and a trench”

The expression **it will be built** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people will build it with a square and a trench]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 9:25 (#9)

וּבְצוֹק֖ הָעִתִּֽים

“but in distress of times”

Gabriel is using the possessive form to describe **times** that are characterized by **distress**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [but in distressful times]

See: Possession

Daniel 9:26 (#1)

יִכָּרֵ֥ת מָשִׁ֖יחַ

“the anointed one will be cut off”

The expression **will be cut off** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [enemies will cut off the anointed one]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 9:26 (#2)

יִכָּרֵ֥ת מָשִׁ֖יחַ

“the anointed one will be cut off”

Gabriel is speaking as if the killing of the anointed one were his being **cut off**, as a branch is cut from a tree. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the anointed one will be killed]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:26 (#3)

וְאֵ֥ין לֹֽו

“and nothing {will be} to him”

Gabriel is using this expression as a common expression of the culture to mean that the anointed one would be left with nothing. This could mean that he would have (1) no possessions or (2) no one to support him. If this expression does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will have nothing]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:26 (#4)

וְהָעִ֣יר וְהַקֹּ֔דֶשׁ יַשְׁחִ֖ית עַ֣ם נָגִ֑יד הַבָּֽא׃

“And the city and the sanctuary, the people of the coming ruler will destroy”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **the people of the coming ruler** before the information about **the city and the sanctuary**. Alternate translation: [And the people of the coming ruler will destroy the city and the sanctuary]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 9:26 (#5)

וְקִצּ֖וֹ בַּשֶּׁ֑טֶף

“And its end {will be} with a flood”

This could mean: (1) **its** refers to the city or (2) it refers to the coming ruler. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the end of the city will be with a flood]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 9:26 (#6)

וְקִצּ֖וֹ בַּשֶּׁ֑טֶף

“And its end {will be} with a flood”

Gabriel is speaking as if the destruction that would come were **a flood** that would sweep everything away. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And it will come to an end in overwhelming destruction]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:26 (#7)

נֶחֱרָצ֥וֹת שֹׁמֵמֽוֹת׃

“Desolations are determined”

The expression **are determined** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God has determined desolations]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 9:27 (#1)

וְהִגְבִּ֥יר בְּרִ֖ית לָרַבִּ֑ים

“And he will strengthen a covenant with many”

This could mean: (1) **he** refers to the coming ruler or (2) it refers to the anointed one. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And that ruler will strengthen a covenant with many] or [And the anointed one will strengthen a covenant with many]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 9:27 (#2)

וְהִגְבִּ֥יר בְּרִ֖ית לָרַבִּ֑ים

“And he will strengthen a covenant with many”

Gabriel is using **strengthen a covenant** as a common expression of the culture to mean “make a firm agreement.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will make a firm agreement with many]

See: Idiom

Daniel 9:27 (#3)

לָרַבִּ֑ים

“with many”

Gabriel is using the adjective **many** as a noun to mean a certain group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [with a large number of people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 9:27 (#4)

זֶ֣בַח וּמִנְחָ֔ה

“the sacrifice and the offering”

The terms **the sacrifice** and **the offering** mean similar things. Gabriel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [all the sacrifices]

See: Doublet

Daniel 9:27 (#5)

וְעַ֥ל כְּנַף־ שִׁקּוּצִ֖ים

“And on the wing of abominations”

Gabriel is speaking as if abominations were a creature with wings. This could mean: (1) **the wing of abominations** refers to the highest point of the temple, where something detestable would be set up, or (2) it refers

to the extreme degree of the abominations that would be committed. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And on the highest point of the temple, detestable things]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 9:27 (#6)

מְשֹׁמֵֽם

"will be} something making desolate"

The implication is that **something making desolate** is a detestable object that would be set up in the temple. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [will be placed a detestable object that makes the temple desolate]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 9:27 (#7)

וְנֶֽחֱרָצָ֥ה תִתַּ֖ךְ עַל־שֹׁמֵֽם

"and the thing having been determined will be poured out upon the one desolating"

The expressions **having been determined** and **will be poured out** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and God will pour out upon the one desolating what he has determined]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel - Chapter 10 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is the first part of the last section in the book, in which Daniel has a vision and man-like figure appears to him and interprets it.

1. Narrative introduction to this section (1)
2. Daniel relates how he had a vision and prayed for three weeks to understand it (2–3)
3. Daniel relates how a glorious, man-like figure appeared to him (4–9)
4. The man explains why he was delayed (10–21)

Daniel 10:1 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שָׁלֹ֔וֹשׁ לְכ֥וֹרֶשׁ מֶ֖לֶךְ פָּרַ֑ס

"In the year of three to Cyrus, the king of Persia"

Daniel is using the phrase translated as **In the year of three to Cyrus, the king of Persia** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Daniel 10:1 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שָׁלֹ֔וֹשׁ לְכ֥וֹרֶשׁ

"In the year of three to Cyrus"

Daniel is using the cardinal number **three** where your language may use an ordinal number. If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **three**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [In the third year of the reign of Cyrus]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel 10:1 (#3)

דָּבָ֣ר נִגְלָ֔ה לְדָנִיֵּ֖אל

"a word was revealed to Daniel"

The expression **was revealed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God revealed a word to Daniel]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 10:1 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר־נִקְרָ֥א שְׁמ֖וֹ בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּ֑ר

"whose name was called Belteshazzar"

The expression **was called** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom Babylonian people called Belteshazzar]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 10:1 (#5)

בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּ֑ר

"Belteshazzar"

The word **Belteshazzar** is the name of a man. It is the name that the Babylonians gave to Daniel.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 10:2 (#1)

שְׁלֹשָׁה שָׁבֻעִים יָמִים

“for} three weeks {of} days”

Daniel is using **three weeks {of} days** as a common expression of the culture to mean “three full weeks.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for three entire weeks]

See: Idiom

Daniel 10:3 (#1)

לֶ֣חֶם חֲמֻדּ֗וֹת לֹ֤א אָכַ֙לְתִּי֙ וּבָשָׂ֣ר וְיַ֔יִן לֹ֥א בָ֖א אֶל־פִּ֑י וְסָ֣וֹךְ לֹא־סָ֔כְתִּי

“I ate no bread of delight, and flesh and wine did not come into my mouth, and anointing, I did not anoint {myself”

Going without **bread of delight, and flesh and wine** and **anointing** for **three weeks** was a symbolic action by which Daniel showed that he was mourning. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [To show that I was mourning, I ate no choice foods or meat or wine, and certainly, I did not anoint myself]

See: Symbolic Action

Daniel 10:3 (#2)

לֶ֣חֶם חֲמֻדּ֗וֹת

“bread of delight”

Daniel is using one kind of food, **bread**, to represent food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [delightful food]

See: Synecdoche

Daniel 10:3 (#3)

וּבָשָׂ֣ר וְיַ֔יִן לֹ֥א בָ֖א אֶל־פִּ֑י

“and flesh and wine did not come into my mouth”

Daniel is using **flesh and wine did not come into my mouth** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I did not eat meat or drink wine.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I did not consume any meat or wine]

See: Idiom

Daniel 10:3 (#4)

וְסָ֣וֹךְ לֹא־סָ֔כְתִּי

“and anointing, I did not anoint {myself”

Daniel is repeating forms of the verb **anoint** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I did not anoint myself at all]

See: Reduplication

Daniel 10:4 (#1)

וּבְיוֹם֙ עֶשְׂרִ֣ים וְאַרְבָּעָ֔ה לַחֹ֥דֶשׁ הָרִאשׁ֖וֹן

“And on the day of twenty and four to the first month”

Daniel is using the cardinal number **twenty and four** where your language may use an ordinal number. If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **twenty and four**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [And on the twenty-fourth day of the first month]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel 10:4 (#2)

לַחֹ֥דֶשׁ הָרִאשׁ֖וֹן

“to the first month”

The **first** month of the Hebrew calendar includes the last part of March and the first part of April on Western calendars. You could convert the Hebrew day and month into an approximate date on the calendar that your culture uses. However, the Jews used a lunar calendar, so if you use a solar calendar, the date will be different every year, and the translation will not be entirely accurate. So you may just want to give the number of the day and the name of the month on the Hebrew calendar and say in a footnote approximately what time of year that is on your calendar.

See: Hebrew Months

Daniel 10:4 (#3)

עַ֚ל יַ֣ד הַנָּהָ֔ר הַגָּדֹֽול

“at the hand of the great river”

Daniel is using **at the hand of the great river** as a common expression of the culture to mean “on the bank of the great river.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [beside the great river]

See: Idiom

Daniel 10:4 (#4)

חִדֶּקֶל

“the Tigris”

The word **Tigris** is the name of a river.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 10:5 (#1)

וָאֶשָּׂא אֶת־עֵינַי וָאֵרֶא

“then I lifted up my eyes and saw”

Daniel is using **I lifted up my eyes and saw** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I looked up and saw.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then I raised my gaze and saw]

See: Idiom

Daniel 10:5 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה

“and behold”

Daniel is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [there before me]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 10:5 (#3)

אִישׁ־אֶחָד לָבוּשׁ בַּדִּים

“a man clothed in linen”

Daniel is introducing **a man clothed in linen** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [there was a certain man clothed in linen]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 10:5 (#4)

וּמָתְנָיו חֲגֻרִים בְּכֶתֶם אוּפָז

“and his loins were girded with gold of Uphaz”

The expression **were girded** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he had girded his loins with gold of Uphaz]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 10:5 (#5)

אוּפָז

“Uphaz”

The word **Uphaz** is the name of a place.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 10:6 (#1)

וּגְוִיָּתוֹ כְּתַרְשִׁישׁ

“And his body {was} like beryl”

The point of this comparison is that just as **beryl** gleams brightly, so did **his body**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [And his body gleamed as brightly as the gemstone beryl]

See: Simile

Daniel 10:6 (#2)

כְּתַרְשִׁישׁ

“was} like beryl”

A **beryl** is a kind of precious stone that has a gleaming, greenish color. If your readers would not be familiar with what a beryl is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [was like a gleaming green gemstone]

See: Translate Unknowns

Daniel 10:6 (#3)

וּפָנָיו כְּמַרְאֵה בָרָק

“and his face {was} like the appearance of lightning”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the appearance of lightning** is dazzlingly bright, so was **his**

face. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and his face was dazzlingly bright, as lightning is]

See: Simile

Daniel 10:6 (#4)

וְעֵינָיו֙ כְּלַפִּידֵ֣י אֵ֔שׁ

“and his eyes {were} like torches of fire”

The point of this comparison is that just as **torches of fire** blaze and glow, so did **his eyes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and his eyes blazed and glowed as brightly as burning torches]

See: Simile

Daniel 10:6 (#5)

וּזְרֹעֹתָיו֙ וּמַרְגְּלֹתָ֣יו כְּעֵ֣ין נְחֹ֔שֶׁת קָלָ֖ל

“and his arms and his feet {were} like the eye of polished bronze”

The point of this comparison is that just as **polished bronze** shines and gleams, so did **his arms and his feet**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and his arms and his feet gleamed brightly]

See: Simile

Daniel 10:6 (#6)

כְּעֵ֣ין נְחֹ֔שֶׁת קָלָ֖ל

“were} like the eye of polished bronze”

Here, **eye** represents the appearance or gleam of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [were the gleam of polished bronze]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 10:6 (#7)

וְקוֹל֙ דְּבָרָ֔יו כְּקוֹל֖ הָמֽוֹן

“and the sound of his words {was} like the sound of a multitude”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the sound of a multitude** is loud and roaring, so was **the sound of his words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the sound of his words was as loud and rumbling as the noise a great crowd makes]

See: Simile

Daniel 10:7 (#1)

חֲרָדָ֣ה גְדֹלָ֔ה נָפְלָ֖ה עֲלֵיהֶֽם

“a great trembling fell on them”

Daniel is speaking of the terror that seized these men as if it were something that **fell on them**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they began to tremble violently]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 10:8 (#1)

וַאֲנִי֙ נִשְׁאַ֣רְתִּי לְבַדִּ֔י

“And I, I was left alone”

Daniel is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **was left** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he alone remained to see the vision. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [And I myself was left alone] or [And I myself was left entirely alone]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 10:8 (#2)

נִשְׁאַ֣רְתִּי לְבַדִּ֔י

“I was left alone”

The expression **was left** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And I remained alone]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 10:8 (#3)

וְהוֹדִ֣י נֶהְפַּ֔ךְ עָלַ֖י לְמַשְׁחִֽית

“and my splendor was turned in me to destruction”

Daniel is speaking of his appearance changing as if it **was turned** into something else. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and my healthy appearance became deathly pale]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 10:9 (#1)

הָיֵיתִי נִרְדָּמִם עַל־פָּנַי

“I was sleeping deeply upon my face”

Daniel is using **I was sleeping deeply upon my face** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I lost consciousness and lay with my face toward the ground.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I fell unconscious with my face down]

See: Idiom

Daniel 10:10 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“Then behold”

Daniel is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Then suddenly]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 10:10 (#2)

יַד נָגְעָה בִּי

“a hand touched me”

Daniel is using one part of this being, **a hand**, to represent the whole being. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [someone touched me]

See: Synecdoche

Daniel 10:11 (#1)

אִישׁ־חֲמֻדוֹת

“man of delight”

The man is using **man of delight** as a common expression of the culture to mean “man who is greatly treasured.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [man who is greatly treasured]

See: Idiom

Daniel 10:11 (#2)

וַעֲמֹד עַל־עָמְדֶךָ

“Stand on your standing”

The man is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [Get to your feet]

See: Poetry

Daniel 10:11 (#3)

כִּי עַתָּה שֻׁלַּחְתִּי אֵלֶיךָ

“for now I have been sent to you”

The expression **have been sent** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [for now God has sent me to you]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 10:12 (#1)

אַל־תִּירָא דָּנִיֵּאל

“May you not fear, Daniel”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a reassurance rather than a command. If the imperative does not communicate a reassurance for your readers, then use a form in your language that communicates a reassurance. Alternate translation: [You should not be afraid, Daniel]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Daniel 10:12 (#2)

נָתַתָּ אֶת־לִבְּךָ לְהָבִין

“you set your heart to understand”

The man is using **you set your heart to understand** as a common expression of the culture to mean “you determined to understand.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you determined to understand]

See: Idiom

Daniel 10:12 (#3)

לִפְנֵי אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“to the face of your God”

Here, **the face of your God** represents the presence of God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before your God]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 10:12 (#4)

נִשְׁמְעוּ דְבָרֶיךָ

“your words were heard”

The expression **were heard** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God heard your words]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 10:12 (#5)

וַאֲנִי־בָאתִי

“and I, I have come”

The messenger is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I have come** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize the importance of his role in serving God. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [and it is I who have come]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 10:13 (#1)

וְשַׂר ׀ מַלְכוּת פָּרַס

“But the prince of the kingdom of Persia”

The implication is that **the prince of the kingdom of Persia** is not a human ruler but a spirit being who opposed the man speaking with Daniel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [But the spirit prince who rules over the kingdom of Persia]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 10:13 (#2)

עָשְׂרִים וְאֶחָד יוֹם

“for} twenty and one day”

The expression **twenty and one day** means twenty-one days. Translate this number according to the conventions of your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [for twenty-one days]

See: Numbers

Daniel 10:13 (#3)

מִיכָאֵל אַחַד הַשָּׂרִים הָרִאשֹׁנִים

“Michael, one of the chief princes”

The man is introducing **Michael** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [a certain one of the chief princes, named Michael]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 10:13 (#4)

וַאֲנִי׀ נוֹתַרְתִּי שָׁם אֵצֶל מַלְכֵי פָּרָס

“for I, I had been left there beside the kings of Persia”

The expression **had been left** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [for I, I remained there beside the kings of Persia]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 10:13 (#5)

מַלְכֵי פָּרָס

“the kings of Persia”

The standard written Hebrew text as we have it today reads “the kings of Persia.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “the prince of the kings of Persia.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Daniel 10:14 (#1)

בְּאַחֲרִית הַיָּמִים

“at the end of days”

The man is using **at the end of days** as a common expression of the culture to mean “in the distant future.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for

your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the distant future]

See: Idiom

Daniel 10:14 (#2)

עוֹד & לְיָמִים

“yet for days”

Daniel is using **yet for days** as a common expression of the culture to mean “sometime far in the future.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [still a long way off] or [something that will not happen for a long time]

See: Idiom

Daniel 10:16 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“And behold”

Daniel is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Suddenly]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 10:16 (#2)

כִּדְמוּתbֿ בְּנֵי אָדָם

“one} according to the likeness of the sons of man”

Daniel is using **the sons of man** as a common expression of the culture to mean “a human being.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one according to the likeness of a human being]

See: Idiom

Daniel 10:16 (#3)

נֶהֶפְכוּ צִירַיbֿ עָלָי

“my pains have turned onto me”

Daniel is speaking of being overcome with anguish as if his pains **have turned onto** him. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I have become full of anguish]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 10:17 (#1)

וְהֵיךְ יוּכַל עֶבֶד אֲדֹנִיbֿ זֶה לְדַבֵּר עִם־אֲדֹנִי זֶה

“And how shall this servant of my lord be able to speak with this my lord”

Daniel is using the question form to say emphatically that he is not able to speak with the one who is addressing him. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [And this servant of my lord is certainly not able to speak with this my lord!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Daniel 10:17 (#2)

וְהֵיךְ יוּכַל עֶבֶד אֲדֹנִיbֿ זֶה לְדַבֵּר עִם־אֲדֹנִי זֶה

“And how shall this servant of my lord be able to speak with this my lord”

Even though Daniel is addressing this being directly, he is speaking of him in the third person as **this my lord**, and he is speaking of himself in the third person as **this servant**, in order to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in respectful forms in the first and second person. Alternate translation: [And how shall I, your servant, be able to speak with you, my lord]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Daniel 10:17 (#3)

וּנְשָׁמָה לֹא נִשְׁאֲרָה־בִּי

“and breath is not left in me”

The expression **is not left** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and no breath remains in me]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 10:17 (#4)

וּנְשָׁמָה לֹא נִשְׁאֲרָה־בִּי

“and breath is not left in me”

Daniel says **breath is not left in me** as an extreme statement for emphasis, since he is still breathing and speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and I can barely breathe]

See: Hyperbole

Daniel 10:18 (#1)

וַיֹּ֣סֶף וַיִּגַּ֣ע־בִּ֔י כְּמַרְאֵ֖ה אָדָ֑ם

“And {the one} according to the appearance of a man added and touched me”

The phrase **added and touched** expresses a single idea. The word **added** tells more about **touched**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [And the one who looked like a man touched me again]

See: Hendiadys

Daniel 10:19 (#1)

חֲזַ֥ק וַחֲזָֽק

“Be strong and be strong”

The man is repeating forms of the verb **be strong** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Be strong indeed]

See: Reduplication

Daniel 10:19 (#2)

הִתְחַזַּ֖קְתִּי

“I was strengthened”

The expression **was strengthened** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he made me strong]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 10:20 (#1)

הֲיָדַ֣עְתָּ֔ לָמָּה־בָּ֥אתִי אֵלֶ֖יךָ

“Do you know why I have come to you”

The man is using the question form to remind Daniel of the reason why he has come to him. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You know why I have come to you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Daniel 10:20 (#2)

יָוָ֖ן

“Javan”

The word **Javan** is the name of a place, the region that later became known as Greece.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 10:20 (#3)

וְהִנֵּ֥ה

“and behold”

Daniel is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [and look]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 10:21 (#1)

אֶת־הָרָשׁ֖וּם בִּכְתָ֣ב אֱמֶֽת

“the inscribed in the Writing of Truth”

The man is using the adjective **the inscribed** as a noun to mean a certain kind of thing, what has been written down. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the things that are inscribed in the Writing of Truth]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 10:21 (#2)

בִּכְתָ֣ב אֱמֶֽת

“in the Writing of Truth”

The implication is that **the Writing of Truth** is a heavenly record in which God has written what he has decreed will happen. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in the Writing of Truth, the heavenly book in which God has recorded what he has decreed will happen]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 10:21 (#3)

וְאֵ֣ין אֶחָ֗ד מִתְחַזֵּ֤ק עִמִּי֙ עַל־אֵ֔לֶּה

“And there is not one being strong with me against these”

The man is using **one being strong with me** as a common expression of the culture to mean "one who supports me." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And there is no one who supports me against these]

See: Idiom

Daniel 10:21 (#4)

עַל־אֵאֵלֶּה

"against these"

The pronoun **these** refers to the princes of Persia and of Javan, the spirit beings whom the man mentioned in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [against these princes of Persia and Javan]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 10:21 (#5)

מִיכָאֵל שַׂרְכֶם

"Michael, your prince"

The word **your** is plural here, since Michael protects all of Daniel's people and not Daniel alone. If your language marks that distinction, use a plural form here.

See: Forms of You

Daniel - Chapter 11 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the last section in the book, in which Daniel has a vision and man-like figure appears to him and interprets it.

1. The man finishes his explanation of why he was delayed (1)
2. The man begins to explain the meaning of Daniel's vision (2–45)
3. Wars between the kings of the north and south (2–20)
4. An evil king of the north will cause great trouble for the Jews (21–35)
5. This king of the north will become powerful but ultimately be destroyed (36–45)

Translation issues in this chapter

The identification of the kings of the north and south
As in chapter 8, the person who interprets Daniel's vision does specify what some of the figures in it represent. He speaks of Persian kings and their wars against "the kingdom of Javan," that is, Greece (11:2). He then describes how "a mighty king will stand" (11:3), presumably Alexander the Great of Greece, and how "his kingdom will be broken and divided toward the four winds of the heavens, but not to his posterity," just as Alexander's empire was divided among four of his generals after he died. This leads many interpreters to believe that the kings of the north are the kings who ruled the northern part of what had been that empire and that the kings of the south are the ones who ruled the southern part, which was based in Egypt. (In 11:7–8, the man even describes how one king of the south will defeat the king of the north and bring their gods "into captivity to Egypt.") However, even if the accounts of the kings of the north and south are initially describing the actual struggle for power between two Greek empires that succeeded Alexander's, it is not clear at what point the vision might shift from historical events subsequent to Daniel but prior to the present day to future events that will take place "at the time of the end" (11:40). So as in the case of the other visions in the book, we recommend that translators not add any identifying information beyond what the book specifically says, either in the text or in footnotes.

Daniel 11:1 (#1)

וַאֲנִי

"And I"

The pronoun **I** refers to the angel who is speaking to Daniel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And I, the angel who is speaking to you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:1 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת אַחַת לְדָרְיָוֶשׁ הַמָּדִי

"in the year of one to Darius the Mede"

In this expression, the number **one** means "first." If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **one**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the first year of Darius the Mede]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel 11:1 (#3)

עָמְדִי לְמַחֲזִיק וּלְמָעוֹז לוֹ

“I stood as one strengthening and as a fortress for him”

Here the angel is speaking as if he were **a fortress** for Michael. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I stood as one strengthening him and as one defending Michael]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:1 (#4)

לוֹ

“for him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Michael, whom the angel named in the previous chapter. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [for Michael]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:2 (#1)

אֱמֶת אַגִּיד לָךְ

“I will declare the truth to you”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **the truth**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [I will tell you what is true]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:2 (#2)

לָךְ

“to you”

The word **you** is singular here because the angel is addressing Daniel alone, so use the singular form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Daniel 11:2 (#3)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

Daniel is using the term **Behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Look]

See: Foreground Information

Daniel 11:2 (#4)

עוֹד שְׁלֹשָׁה מְלָכִים עֹמְדִים לְפָרַס

“three more kings will be standing in Persia”

Here the angel is speaking as if these kings were **standing** in Persia, meaning that they will rule there. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [three more kings will reign in Persia]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:2 (#5)

וְהָרְבִיעִי

“and a fourth”

The expression **a fourth** means a fourth king. If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **a fourth**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [and after them one more king]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel 11:2 (#6)

יַעֲשֶׁשִׁיר עָשֶׁר־גָּדוֹל מִכֹּל

“will become wealthy {with} wealth greater than all”

The angel is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. See the UST.

See: Poetry

Daniel 11:2 (#7)

יָעִיר הַכֹּל אֵת מַלְכוּת יָוָן

“he will awaken all against the kingdom of Javan”

Here the angel is speaking as if this king would **awaken all** his people, meaning that he will rouse them to go to war. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will stir up everyone to fight against the kingdom of Javan]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:2 (#8)

יָעִיר הַכֹּל

“he will awaken all”

The angel is using the adjective **all** as a noun to mean all of the people of his kingdom. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [he will awaken all of the people of his kingdom]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 11:2 (#9)

יָוָן

“Javan”

The word **Javan** is the name of a place, Greece.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 11:3 (#1)

וְעָמַד מֶלֶךְ גִּבּוֹר

“Then a mighty king will stand”

Here the angel is introducing **a mighty king** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Then a certain mighty king will arise]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 11:3 (#2)

וּמָשַׁל מִמְשָׁל רַב

“and he will rule {with} great dominion”

The angel is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this.

See: Poetry

Daniel 11:3 (#3)

כִּרְצוֹנוֹ

“according to his will”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **his will**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [as he desires]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:4 (#1)

וּכְעָמְדוֹ תִּשָּׁבֵר מַלְכוּתּוֹ וְתֵחָץ לְאַרְבַּע רוּחוֹת הַשָּׁמָיִם וְלֹא לְאַחֲרִיתוֹ וְלֹא כְמָשְׁלוֹ אֲשֶׁר מָשָׁל כִּי תִנָּתֵשׁ מַלְכוּתּוֹ וְלַאֲחֵרִים מִלְּבַד־אֵלֶּה

“But as he stands, his kingdom will be broken and divided toward the four winds of the heavens, but not to his posterity, and not according to his dominion {by} which he ruled. For his kingdom will be uprooted, and to others besides these”

The expression **as he stands** indicates that **his kingdom will be broken and divided** while this king is still ruling. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe the time relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [But at the same time that he is still reigning]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Daniel 11:4 (#2)

תִּשָּׁבֵר מַלְכוּתּוֹ וְתֵחָץ

“his kingdom will be broken and divided”

The expression **will be broken and divided** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [others will break his kingdom apart and divide it]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:4 (#3)

תִּשָּׁבֵר מַלְכוּתּוֹ וְתֵחָץ

“his kingdom will be broken and divided”

Here the angel is speaking as if the **kingdom** were an object that would be broken into pieces. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his kingdom will fall apart and be divided]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:4 (#4)

לְאַרְבַּע רוּחוֹת הַשָּׁמָיִם

“toward the four winds of the heavens”

Here the angel is speaking as if the four directions were **the four winds of the heavens**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use

in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [toward the four directions of the earth]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:4 (#5)

כִּֽי תִנָּתֵשׁ מַלְכוּתׇתֹּו

“For his kingdom will be uprooted”

The expression **will be uprooted** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [For someone will uproot his kingdom]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:4 (#6)

תִנָּתֵשׁ מַלְכוּתׇתֹּו

“his kingdom will be uprooted”

Here the angel is speaking as if **his kingdom** were a plant that would be **uprooted** from the ground. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his kingdom will be completely removed]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:4 (#7)

וְלַאֲחֵרִים מִלְּבַד־אֵלֶּה

“and to others besides these”

The angel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and it will be given to others besides these]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 11:5 (#1)

מֶלֶךְ־הַנֶּגֶב

“the king of the south”

The implication is that **the south** means the region to the south of Judea, that is, Egypt. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the king of the south, that is, Egypt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:5 (#2)

וּמִן־שָׂרָיָו

“but {one} from his princes”

The pronoun **his** refers either to (1) the king of the south, so that one of his own commanders will become stronger than he is or (2) the mighty king of verse 3, so that one of that king’s commanders will become stronger. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [but one from the princes of the king of the south]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:5 (#3)

מִמְשָׁלָה רַבָּה מֶמְשַׁלְתּוֹ

“His dominion {will be} a great dominion”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **dominion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [He will rule over very many peoples]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:6 (#1)

תָּבוֹאנָה אֶל־מֶלֶךְ הַצָּפוֹן

“will come to the king of the north”

The angel is referring to marriage in a polite way by using the phrase **will come to the king of the north**. Depending on what is helpful for your readers, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [will marry the king of the north]

See: Euphemism

Daniel 11:6 (#2)

לַעֲשׂוֹת מֵישָׁרִים

“to make uprightnesses”

The angel is using **to make uprightnesses** as a common expression of the culture to mean “to make a peace agreement.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to arrange a peace treaty]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:6 (#3)

וְלֹא־תַעְצֹר כׇּחַ הַזְּרֹועַ

“But she will not retain the strength of the arm”

Here, **the arm** represents “power.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [But she will not retain her powerful position]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 11:6 (#4)

וְלֹ֣א יַעֲמֹ֔ד וּזְרֹעֹ֖ו

“and he will not stand, nor his arm”

The angel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will not continue to rule, nor will he retain power]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 11:6 (#5)

וְתִנָּתֵ֣ן

“And she will be given up”

The expression **will be given up** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And enemies will hand her over]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:6 (#6)

וְהַיֹּלְדָ֖הּ

“and the one having fathered her”

The expression translated as **and the one having fathered her** represents the standard written Hebrew text as we have it today. This reading, however, does not seem to make sense. Scholars have proposed that a scribe may have added the wrong vowels to the original consonants of the text, resulting in this expression. With different vowels, it would say “her child,” which seems to fit the meaning of this passage better. The UST follows that interpretation. You may want to follow the major translation in your area. Alternate translation: [and her child]

See: Alternative Readings

Daniel 11:7 (#1)

וְעָמַ֣ד מִנֵּ֔צֶר שָׁרְשֶׁ֖יהָ כַּנֹּ֑ו

“But from a branch of her roots, one will stand {in} his place”

The angel is using this phrase as a common expression of the culture to mean “he will rule as king after him.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But from a branch of her roots, one will rule as king after him]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:7 (#2)

מִנֵּ֔צֶר שָׁרְשֶׁ֖יהָ

“from a branch of her roots, one”

Here the angel is speaking as if the family of this woman were a plant with **roots** from which **a branch** would grow. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from among her family members, one]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:7 (#3)

וְעָשָׂ֥ה בָהֶ֖ם וְהֶחֱזִֽיק

“And he will do with them and be strong”

The phrase **do with them and be strong** expresses a single idea. The word **strong** tells more about **do**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [he will act powerfully against them] or [he will subjugate them]

See: Hendiadys

Daniel 11:8 (#1)

בַּשִּׁבְיָ֣ יָבִ֔יא מִצְרָ֖יִם

“he will bring into captivity {to} Egypt”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **captivity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [he will capture and carry away to Egypt]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:8 (#2)

אֱלֹהֵיהֶ֔ם

“their gods”

The pronoun **their** refers to the people of the northern kingdom. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the gods of the people of the north]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:8 (#3)

כְּלֵ֣י חֶמְדָּתָ֔ם כֶּ֖סֶף וְזָהָ֑ב

“the silver and gold vessels of their delight”

The angel is using the possessive form to describe **vessels** that are characterized by being objects of **their delight**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the silver and gold vessels that they treasured]

See: Possession

Daniel 11:8 (#4)

יַֽעֲמֹ֥ד מִמֶּ֖נּוּ מֶ֥לֶךְ הַצָּפֽוֹן

“he will stand from the king of the north”

The angel is using **he will stand from the king of the north** as a common expression of the culture to mean “he will keep away from the king of the north and not attack him.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will refrain from attacking the king of the north]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:9 (#1)

וּבָ֣א

“Then he will come”

The pronoun **he** refers either to (1) the king of the north, who will invade the kingdom of the south. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Then the king of the north will come]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:10 (#1)

ובנו יִתְגָּרֹ֔ו

“And his sons will be stirred up”

The expression **will be stirred up** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And his sons will stir themselves up for battle]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:10 (#2)

וּבָ֥א בָּבֹ֖וא

“And coming, it will come”

The angel is repeating forms of the verb **come** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [And it will surely come]

See: Reduplication

Daniel 11:10 (#3)

וְשָׁטַ֥ף וְעָבָ֖ר

“and it will overflow and pass through”

Here the angel is speaking as if this army were water that would **overflow** the land. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will spread over the land and pass through]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:10 (#4)

וְיָשֹׁ֔ב ויתגרו עַד־מעזה

“and it will return and be stirred up to his fortress”

The angel is using **return and be stirred up** as a common expression of the culture to mean “attack again.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will bring the war once again to his stronghold] or [it will attack again, reaching all the way to his fortress]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:11 (#1)

וְיִתְמַרְמַר֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ הַנֶּ֔גֶב

“Then the king of the south will embitter himself”

The angel is using **will embitter himself** as a common expression of the culture to mean “will become very angry.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for

your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Then the king of the south will become furious]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:11 (#2)

וְהֶעֱמִידַ֣ה הָמוֹן֮ רָ֒ב וְנִתַּ֣ן הֶהָמוֹן֒ בְּיָד֗וֹ

“And he will make a great multitude stand, but the multitude will be given into his hand”

The pronoun **he** refers to the king of the north, while the pronoun **his** refers to the king of the south. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the king of the north will make a great multitude stand, but the multitude will be given into the hand of the king of the south]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:11 (#3)

וְהֶעֱמִידַ֣ה הָמוֹן֮ רָ֒ב

“And he will make a great multitude stand”

The angel is using **will make a great multitude stand** as a common expression of the culture to mean “will gather a large army.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will raise up many soldiers]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:11 (#4)

וְנִתַּ֣ן הֶהָמוֹן֒ בְּיָד֗וֹ

“but the multitude will be given into his hand”

The expression **will be given** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but God will give the multitude into his hand]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:11 (#5)

וְנִתַּ֣ן הֶהָמוֹן֒ בְּיָד֗וֹ

“but the multitude will be given into his hand”

Here, **his hand** represents “his power and control.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [but the multitude will be given over into his control]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 11:12 (#1)

יר֥וֹם לִבָּבֹ֖ו

“And his heart will rise up”

The angel is using **his heart will rise up** as a common expression of the culture to mean “he will become arrogant.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will become arrogant]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:12 (#2)

וְהִפְפִּ֣יל רִבֹּא֔וֹת

“for he will have made myriads fall”

Here, **fall** represents “die in battle.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for he will have caused myriads to die in battle]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 11:12 (#3)

רִבֹּא֔וֹת

“myriads”

The term **myriads** describes a very large number, tens of thousands. Translate this number according to the conventions of your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [ten thousands]

See: Numbers

Daniel 11:13 (#1)

וְשָׁ֣בַ֔ מֶ֖לֶךְ הַצָּפ֑וֹן וְהֶעֱמִ֣יד הָמ֔וֹן

“For the king of the north will return and make stand a multitude”

The phrase **return and make stand** expresses a single idea. The word **return** tells more about **make stand**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [For the king of the north will once more assemble a multitude]

See: Hendiadys

Daniel 11:13 (#2)

רַ֣ב מִן־הָרִאשֹׁ֗ון

“greater than the first”

The expression **the first** means the first army that this king gathered. If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the first**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [greater than his earlier army]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Daniel 11:13 (#3)

וּלְקֵ֥ץ הָעִתִּ֖ים שָׁנִ֑ים

“And at the end of times, years”

The angel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And at the end of a period of several years]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 11:14 (#1)

רַבִּ֖ים יַעַמְד֣וּ עַל־מֶ֣לֶךְ הַנֶּ֑גֶב

“many will stand against the king of the south”

The angel is using the adjective **many** as a noun to mean many people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [many soldiers will stand against the king of the south]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 11:14 (#2)

רַבִּ֖ים יַעַמְד֣וּ עַל־מֶ֣לֶךְ הַנֶּ֑גֶב

“many will stand against the king of the south”

The angel is using **will stand against** as a common expression of the culture to mean “will rebel against.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [many will rise up against the king of the south]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:14 (#3)

וּבְנֵ֣י ׀ פָּרִיצֵ֣י עַמְּךָ֗

“And sons of violence of your people”

The angel is using the possessive form to describe **sons** who are characterized by **violence**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And violent sons of your people]

See: Possession

Daniel 11:14 (#4)

עַמְּךָ֗

“your people”

The implication is that **your people** means the Jewish people, to whom Daniel belongs. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [your own Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:14 (#5)

לְהַעֲמִ֣יד חָזֹ֔ון

“to make the vision stand”

The angel is using **to make the vision stand** as a common expression of the culture to mean “to bring about what the vision describes.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to fulfill what the vision describes]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:14 (#6)

וְנִכְשָׁלֹ֑ו

“but they will stumble”

Here the angel is speaking as if these men would **stumble**, meaning that they will fail and be defeated. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the rebels will fail]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:15 (#1)

וְיִשְׁפֹּ֤ךְ סֹולְלָה֙

“and he will pour out a mound”

The angel is using **he will pour out a mound** as a common expression of the culture to mean "he will pile up earth against the wall of a city in order to attack it." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will build a siege ramp against a city wall]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:15 (#2)

עִ֥יר מִבְצָרוֹת

"a city of fortifications"

The angel is using the possessive form to describe a **city** that is characterized by **fortifications**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a fortified city]

See: Possession

Daniel 11:15 (#3)

וּזְרֹעֹ֥ות הַנֶּ֖גֶב לֹ֣א יַעֲמֹ֑דוּ

"And the arms of the south will not stand"

Here, **the arms** represents "the military forces." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the military forces of the south will not stand]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 11:15 (#4)

וְעַמּ֖וֹ מִבְחָרָ֥יו

"even his choice people"

The angel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [even his best warriors will not stand]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 11:16 (#1)

וְיַ֣עַשׂ הַבָּ֣א אֵלָ֔יו כִּרְצֹונֹ֑ו

"But the one coming against him will act according to his desire"

The pronoun **him** refers to the king of the south, and the pronoun **his** refers to the king of the north, who is the one coming against him. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [But the king of the north will succeed in doing as he wishes]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:16 (#2)

בְּאֶ֥רֶץ־הַצְּבִ֖י

"in the land of beauty"

The angel is using the possessive form to describe a **land** that is characterized by **beauty**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in the beautiful land]

See: Possession

Daniel 11:16 (#3)

וְכָלָ֖ה בְּיָדֹֽו

"and destruction {will be} in his hand"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **destruction**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and he will be able to destroy it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:17 (#1)

וְיִשָּׁרִ֖ים עִמֹּ֑ו

"and uprightnesses with him"

This expression could mean: (1) that this king will make a treaty. The meaning would be the same as in 11:6, "The daughter of the king of the south will come to the king of the north to make uprightnesses." Alternate translation: [and he will make a treaty] or (2) that some Jews will side with this king. Alternate translation [and some upright ones will be with him] or [and some who should be upright will support him instead]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:17 (#2)

וְיָשֵׁ֥ם ׀ פָּנָ֛יו לָבֹ֥וא

"And he will set his face to come"

The angel is using **he will set his face** as a common expression of the culture to mean "he will firmly decide." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or

you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will firmly decide to come]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:17 (#3)

וִישָׁרִים עִמּוֹ וְעָשָׂה

“and uprightnesses with him, thus he will do”

The angel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will bring terms of agreement with him, and thus he will act]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 11:17 (#4)

וּבַת הַנָּשִׁים֙ יִתֶּן־לוֹ֙ לְהַשְׁחִיתָ֔הּ

“And he will give a daughter of women to him, to ruin it”

The pronoun **he** refers to the king of the north, while the pronoun **him** refers to the king of the south. The pronoun **it** refers to the kingdom of the south It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the king of the north will give a daughter of women to the king of the south, to ruin the kingdom of the south]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:17 (#5)

וּבַת הַנָּשִׁים֙

“a daughter of women”

The angel is using **a daughter of women** as a common expression of the culture to mean “a young woman.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a young woman]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:17 (#6)

לְהַשְׁחִיתָ֔הּ

“to ruin it”

The pronoun **it** refers either to (1) the kingdom of the south, which this king wants to destroy or (2) the daughter herself, whom he is willing to use for his own purposes. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to ruin the southern kingdom]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:17 (#7)

וְלֹ֣א תַעֲמֹ֔ד וְלֹא־לֹ֖ו תִּהְיֶֽה

“But it will not stand, and it will not be for him”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [But this plan will not succeed and will not benefit him at all]

See: Parallelism

Daniel 11:18 (#1)

וְהִשְׁבִּ֤יתַ קְצִין֙ חֶרְפָּתֹ֣ו לֹ֔ו

“But a commander will end his reproach {that is} to him”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **reproach**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [But a commander will stop him from insulting others]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:18 (#2)

חֶרְפָּתֹ֣ו לֹ֔ו

“his reproach {that is} to him”

The pronouns **his** and **him** both refer to the king of the north. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the king of the north’s own reproach]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:18 (#3)

חֶרְפָּתֹ֣ו לֹ֔ו

“his reproach {that is} to him”

It might seem that the expression **his reproach that is to him** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [his reproach]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Daniel 11:18 (#4)

בִּלְתִּתִּי חֶרְפָּתוֹ יָשִׁיב

“without his {own} reproach, he will return {it”

The pronouns “his” and “he” refer to the “commander”; “him” refers to the king of the north.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:19 (#1)

וְנִכְשַׁל וְנָפַל וְלֹא יִמָּצֵא

“but he will stumble and fall, and he will not be found”

The angel is referring to the death of this king in a polite way by using the phrase **he will stumble and fall, and he will not be found**. Depending on what is helpful for your readers, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [but he will die there and disappear from history]

See: Euphemism

Daniel 11:19 (#2)

וְלֹא יִמָּצֵא

“and he will not be found”

The expression **will not be found** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and no one will find him]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:20 (#1)

וְעָמַד עַל־כַּנּוֹ מַעֲבִיר נוֹגֵשׂ הֲדָר מַלְכוּת

“And one making an exactor pass through the splendor of the kingdom will stand in his place”

The implication is that this king will send a tax collector throughout his realm to take money from the people. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And a king who sends a tax collector throughout the glorious realm to take money from the people will rule]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:20 (#2)

הֲדָר מַלְכוּת

“the splendor of the kingdom”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **the splendor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the splendid kingdom]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:20 (#3)

יִשָּׁבֵר

“he will be broken”

The expression **will be broken** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone will break him]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:20 (#4)

יִשָּׁבֵר

“he will be broken”

Here the angel is speaking as if this king were an object that would be **broken**, meaning that he will die. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will die]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:20 (#5)

וְלֹא בְאַפַּיִם וְלֹא בְמִלְחָמָה

“but not in nostrils and not in battle”

The angel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but he will not be broken in anger and he will not be broken in battle]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 11:20 (#6)

וְלֹא בְאַפַּיִם

“but not in nostrils”

The angel is using **in nostrils** as a common expression of the culture to mean “in anger.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but not in anger]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:21 (#1)

וְעָמַד עַל־כַּנּוֹ נִבְזֶה

“And a despised one will stand in his place”

The expression **a despised one** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And a man whom people despise will stand in his place]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:21 (#2)

וְלֹא־נָתְנוּ עָלָיו הוֹד מַלְכוּת

“and they will not give the splendor of the kingdom to him”

The pronoun **they** does not refer to any specific people. The angel is using it to mean people in general. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and people will not give the splendor of the kingdom to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:21 (#3)

הוֹד מַלְכוּת

“the splendor of the kingdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **the splendor** in 11:20.

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:21 (#4)

וּבָא בְשַׁלְוָה

“And he will come in security”

The angel is using **he will come in security** as a common expression of the culture to mean “he will come when people feel safe and are not expecting an attack.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will come when people feel safe and unsuspecting]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:22 (#1)

וּזְרֹעוֹת הַשֶּׁשֶׁט יִשָּׁטְפוּ

“And the arms of the flood will be swept away”

Here the angel is speaking as if an army were a flood; speaking as if a flood had arms; speaking as if a flood could be swept away (rather than sweeping things away itself). Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the vast armies will be utterly defeated]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:22 (#2)

וּזְרֹעוֹת הַשֶּׁשֶׁט יִשָּׁטְפוּ

“And the arms of the flood will be swept away”

The expression **will be swept away** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And he will sweep away the vast armies]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:22 (#3)

וּזְרֹעוֹת הַשֶּׁשֶׁט יִשָּׁטְפוּ

“And the arms of the flood will be swept away”

The noun “flood” and the verb “swept away” are from the same root. Alternate translation: [And the arms of the sweeping away will be swept away] or [And the arms of the flood will be flooded away]

See: Poetry

Daniel 11:22 (#4)

מִלְּפָנָיו

“from to his face”

Here, **his face** represents “his presence.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from before him]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 11:22 (#5)

וְיִשָּׁבֵרוּ

“and they will be broken”

The expression **will be broken** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you

could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will break them]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:22 (#6)

וְיִשָּׁבֵֽרוּ

“and they will be broken”

The pronoun **they** refers to the arms of the flood, that is, the invading armies mentioned earlier in the verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the invading armies will be defeated]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:22 (#7)

וְיִשָּׁבֵֽרוּ

“and they will be broken”

Here the messenger is speaking of the invading armies as if they were an object that could be **broken**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will be defeated] or [and he will defeat them]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:22 (#8)

וְגַם נְגִיד בְּרִית

“and also the leader of the covenant”

The angel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and also the leader of the covenant will be swept away and broken]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 11:22 (#9)

נְגִיד בְּרִית

“the leader of the covenant”

The implication is that **the leader of the covenant** is the high priest, who leads the people in keeping the covenant that God made with them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the high priest, who leads the people in God’s covenant]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:23 (#1)

וּמִן־הֻתְחַבְּרוּת אֵלָ֖יו יַעֲשֶׂ֣ה מִרְמָ֑ה וְעָלָ֥ה וְעָצַ֛ם בִּמְעַט־גּֽוֹי

“And after the joining together with him, he will act {with} deceit. And he will go up, and he will become strong with a few of people”

The expression **after the joining together with him** indicates that these events will happen after other rulers make an alliance with this king. Your language may have a connecting phrase that you can use to show this. Alternate translation: [Once others have made an alliance with him, he will act with deceit. Then he will go up, and he will become strong with a few people]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Daniel 11:23 (#2)

וּמִן־הֻתְחַבְּרוּת אֵלָ֖יו

“And after the joining together with him”

This seems to refer to lesser kings or groups among peoples he wanted to control joining with this “king of the north.”

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:23 (#3)

יַעֲשֶׂ֣ה מִרְמָ֑ה

“he will act {with} deceit”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **deceit**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [he will act in a deceitful way]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:24 (#1)

וּבְמִשְׁמַנֵּ֥י מְדִינָ֖ה׀

“even into the fatnesses of the province”

Here the angel is speaking as if the richest parts of the province were its **fatnesses**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [even into the richest parts of the province]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:24 (#2)

אֲבֹתָיו֙ וַאֲבֹ֣ת אֲבֹתָ֔יו

“his fathers and the fathers of his fathers”

Here the angel is speaking as if the ancestors of this king were his **fathers**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his ancestors and their ancestors before them]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:24 (#3)

וּבְמִשְׁמַנֵּ֣י & בִּזָּ֔ה וְשָׁלָ֖ל וּרְכ֑וּשׁ לָהֶ֣ם יִבְזֹֽר

“even into the fatnesses of & He will scatter plunder and spoil and wealth to them”

The pronoun **He** refers to the king, while the pronoun **them** refers to his soldiers and followers. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [even into the fatnesses of the province, the king will scatter plunder and spoil and wealth to his soldiers and followers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:24 (#4)

בִּזָּ֔ה וְשָׁלָ֖ל וּרְכ֑וּשׁ

“plunder and spoil and wealth”

The terms **plunder**, **spoil**, and **wealth** mean similar things. The angel is using the three terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [great amounts of captured goods]

See: Doublet

Daniel 11:24 (#5)

יְחַשֵּׁ֥ב מַחְשְׁבֹתָ֖יו

“and he will devise his devices”

The angel is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this.

See: Poetry

Daniel 11:24 (#6)

וְעַד־עֵ֥ת

“but until a time”

The angel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but only until a certain time has passed]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 11:25 (#1)

וְיָעַר֙ כֹּח֣וֹ וּלְבָב֔וֹ

“And he will awaken his strength and his heart”

The angel is using **he will awaken his strength and his heart** as a common expression of the culture to mean “he will summon all of his power and courage.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will summon all of his power and courage]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:25 (#2)

וּמֶ֣לֶךְ הַנֶּ֗גֶב יִתְגָּרֶה֙ לַמִּלְחָמָ֔ה

“And the king of the south will be stirred up to battle”

The expression **will be stirred up** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the king of the south will rouse himself to battle]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:25 (#3)

בְּחַ֤יִל־גָּדוֹל֙ וְעָצ֣וּם עַד־מְאֹ֔ד

“with an army great and mighty unto much”

The terms **great** and **mighty** mean similar things. The angel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [with an extremely powerful army]

See: Doublet

Daniel 11:25 (#4)

כִּֽי־יַחְשְׁב֥וּ עָלָ֖יו מַחֲשָׁבֹֽות

“for they will devise devices against him”

The pronoun **they** refers to officials of the king of the south who will betray him. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [for his own officials will devise devices against him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:26 (#1)

וְאֹכְלֵי פַּת־בָּגֹו

“Even the eaters of his portion”

The angel is using **the eaters of his portion** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the men who eat at his table as his trusted advisers.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Even those who share his food as his trusted friends]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:26 (#2)

וְחֵילֹו יִשְׁטֹוף

“And his army will be swept away”

The expression **will be swept away** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And his army will collapse]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:26 (#3)

וְנָפְלוּ חֲלָלִים רַבִּים

“and many will fall slain”

The expression **slain** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and many will fall as enemies kill them]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:27 (#1)

לִבָּבָם לְמָרָע

“their heart {will be} to evil”

Here the angel is speaking as if the intentions of these two kings were their **heart**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their intentions will be evil]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:27 (#2)

וְעַל־שֻׁלְחָן אֶחָד כָּזָב יְדַבֵּרוּ

“and at one table they will speak falsehood”

Here, **one table** represents “the negotiations between them.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and while negotiating together, they will speak falsehood]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 11:27 (#3)

כָּזָב יְדַבֵּרוּ

“they will speak falsehood”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **falsehood**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [they will speak deceitfully to each other]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:27 (#4)

וְלֹא תִצְלָח

“But it will not prosper”

The pronoun **it** refers to the scheming of these two kings. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [But their scheming will not prosper]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:27 (#5)

כִּי־עֹוד קֵץ לַמֹּועֵד

“for the end {is} still for the appointed time”

The implication is that God has determined the time when these things will come to an end. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for the end will only come at the time that God has appointed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:28 (#1)

בְּרִית קֹדֶשׁ

“the covenant of holiness”

The angel is using the possessive form to describe a **covenant** that is characterized by **holiness**. If a

speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the holy covenant]

See: Possession

Daniel 11:28 (#2)

וְעָשָׂה

“And he will act”

The implication is that this king will act against the people who belong to the covenant. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And he will take action against the people of the covenant]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:29 (#1)

וְלֹא־תִהְיֶה כָרִאשֹׁנָֽה וְכָאַחֲרֹנָֽה

“But it will not be like the former and like the latter”

The angel is using **But it will not be like the former and like the latter** as a common expression of the culture to mean “this time will not turn out like the previous times.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But history will not repeat itself this time] or [But this campaign will not go the way the earlier ones did]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:30 (#1)

כִּתִּיִּם׃

“Kittim”

The word **Kittim** is the name of a place.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 11:30 (#2)

וְיָבִ֖ן עַל־עֹזְבֵ֣י בְּרִ֑ית קֹֽדֶשׁ

“and he will attend to the forsakers of the covenant of holiness”

The angel is using **he will attend to** as a common expression of the culture to mean “he will show favor to.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will show favor to those people who forsake the covenant of holiness]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:31 (#1)

הַמִּקְדָּ֖שׁ הַמָּעֽוֹז׃

“the sanctuary, the fortress”

The implication is that **the sanctuary** is the temple in Jerusalem. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the temple in Jerusalem, that fortified sanctuary]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:31 (#2)

הַתָּמִ֔יד

“the perpetual sacrifice”

The implication is that **the perpetual sacrifice** is the offering that the priests presented every morning and every evening. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the sacrifice that the priests offered morning and evening without fail]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:31 (#3)

הַשִּׁקֻּ֖וץ מְשֹׁמֵֽם׃

“the abomination making desolate”

The implication is that **the abomination making desolate** is an idolatrous object that these men will set up in the temple, which will make the temple unfit for the worship of God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [an idolatrous object in the temple that will make it unfit for worshiping God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:32 (#1)

וּמַרְשִׁיעֵ֥י בְרִ֖ית יַחֲנִ֣יף בַּחֲלַקּ֑וֹת

“And he will pollute with flatteries the wicked actors of the covenant”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **the wicked actors of the covenant** before the information about **flatteries**. Alternate translation: [And the people who disobey the covenant, he will pollute with flatteries]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 11:32 (#2)

יַחֲנִ֥יף בַּחֲלַקְּק֖וֹת

“And he will pollute with flatteries”

Here the angel is speaking as if this king would **pollute** these people, meaning that he will lead them into wickedness. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will use flattery to corrupt]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:32 (#3)

וְעַ֣ם יֹדְעֵ֣י אֱלֹהָ֔יו

“But the people knowing its God”

In this verse, the word **people** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the Israelites as a group. That is why the angel uses the singular pronoun **its**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use plural forms here. Alternate translation: [But the people who know their God]

See: Collective Nouns

Daniel 11:32 (#4)

וְעַ֣ם יֹדְעֵ֣י אֱלֹהָ֔יו

“But the people knowing its God”

The angel is using **knowing its God** as a common expression of the culture to mean “remaining faithful to its God.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But the people remaining faithful to its God]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:32 (#5)

אֱלֹהָ֔יו

“its God”

The angel is not using this possessive form **its God** to indicate that these people possess or control God. Rather, the angel is using these words to indicate that God is the one whom these people worship. Alternate translation: [the God they worship]

See: Possession

Daniel 11:32 (#6)

יַחֲזִ֖קוּ וְעָשֽׂוּ

“they will be strong and act”

The phrase **be strong and act** expresses a single idea. The word **be strong** tells more about **act**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [they will act strongly]

See: Hendiadys

Daniel 11:33 (#1)

וּמַשְׂכִּ֣ילֵי עָ֔ם

“And the makers wise of the people”

By **the makers wise of the people**, the angel means the wise leaders among the Jewish people who will teach and encourage others to remain faithful to God despite the persecution. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And the wise leaders among the Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:33 (#2)

וּמַשְׂכִּ֣ילֵי עָ֔ם יָבִ֖ינוּ לָרַבִּ֑ים

“And the makers wise of the people will make many understand”

This is poetic language. If your language has a way to indicate poetry, you could use it here. Alternate translation: [And those who teach to make others wise will lead many to understand]

See: Poetry

Daniel 11:33 (#3)

וְנִכְשְׁל֥וּ

“But they will stumble”

The angel is referring to dying in a polite way by using the phrase **they will stumble**. Depending on what is helpful for your readers, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [they will perish] or [they will die]

See: Euphemism

Daniel 11:33 (#4)

בְּחֶ֥רֶב וּבְלֶהָבָ֖ה

“by the sword and by flame”

Here, **the sword** and **flame** represent "violent death." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [by violent death]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 11:33 (#5)

יָמִים

"for} days"

Here, **days** represents "a period of time." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for a length of time]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 11:34 (#1)

וּבְהִכָּשְׁלָם יֵעָזְרוּ עֵזֶר מְעָט וְנִלְווּ עֲלֵיהֶם רַבִּים בַּחֲלַקְלַקּוֹת

"And when they stumble, they will be helped {with} a little help. And many will join themselves with them by intrigues"

The expression **when they stumble** indicates that these people **will be helped** at the same time as when they are suffering in this way. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe the time relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [And during the time when they are stumbling, they will be helped with a little help. And many will join themselves with them by intrigues]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Daniel 11:34 (#2)

יֵעָזְרוּ עֵזֶר מְעָט

"they will be helped {with} a little help"

The expression **will be helped** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [others will give them a little help]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:34 (#3)

וְנִלְווּ עֲלֵיהֶם רַבִּים בַּחֲלַקְלַקּוֹת

"And many will join themselves with them by intrigues"

The angel is using **will join themselves with them by intrigues** as a common expression of the culture to mean "will pretend to support them without being sincere." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And many will pretend to support them without being sincere]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:35 (#1)

וּמִן־הַמַּשְׂכִּילִים יִכָּשְׁלוּ

"And some of the ones making wise will stumble"

The angel is referring to the death of these people in a polite way by using the phrase **will stumble**. Depending on what is helpful for your readers, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [And some of the ones teaching others will lose their lives]

See: Euphemism

Daniel 11:35 (#2)

כִּי

"For"

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Daniel 11:35 (#3)

לִצְרֹוף בָּהֶם וּלְבָרֵר וְלַלְבֵּן

"to refine and to purify and to whiten them"

Here the angel is speaking as if these people were metal or cloth that someone would **refine** and **whiten**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that they may become completely faithful and free from any fault]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:36 (#1)

וְעָשָׂה כִרְצֹונֹו הַמֶּלֶךְ

"And the king will act according to his desire"

The implication is that **the king** here is the king of the north, whom the angel has been describing. You could include this information if that would be helpful

to your readers. Alternate translation: [And the king of the north will act according to his desire]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:36 (#2)

וְיִתְרוֹמַמֵּם וְיִתְגַּדֵּל

“And he will exalt himself and magnify himself”

The terms **exalt himself** and **magnify himself** mean similar things. The angel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [And he will greatly glorify himself]

See: Doublet

Daniel 11:36 (#3)

יְדַבֵּר נִפְלָאוֹת

“he will speak astonishing {things”

The implication is that this king will say things about the true God that insult him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he will speak shocking, insulting things]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:36 (#4)

אֵאֵל אֵלִים

“the God of gods”

The angel is using this possessive form to mean the God who is supreme over everything that people call a god. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the God who is supreme over all gods]

See: Possession

Daniel 11:36 (#5)

עַד־כְּכָלָה זַעַם

“until the indignation finishes”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **the indignation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [until God finishes being angry]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:36 (#6)

כִּכִי נֶחֱרָצָה נֶעֱשָׂתָה

“For what is decreed will be done”

The expressions **is decreed** and **will be done** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [For God will surely do what he has decreed]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 11:37 (#1)

וְעַל־אֱלֹהֵי אֲבֹתָיו לֹא יָבִין וְעַל־חֶמְדַּת נָשִׁים

“And to the gods of his fathers and to the desire of women, he will not attend”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could put the phrase **he will not attend** before the phrases that tell what he will not attend to. Alternate translation: [And he will not attend to the gods of his fathers or to the desire of women]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 11:37 (#2)

וְעַל־אֱלֹהֵי אֲבֹתָיו לֹא יָבִין וְעַל־חֶמְדַּת נָשִׁים

“And to the gods of his fathers and to the desire of women, he will not attend”

The angel is using **he will not attend** as a common expression of the culture to mean “he will show no regard.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will have no respect for the gods of his fathers or for the gods desired by women]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:37 (#3)

חֶמְדַּת נָשִׁים

“the desire of women”

Here, **the desire of women** does not mean “the desire for women” but “that which women desire,” some specific deity that women particularly worshiped. Alternate translation: [the gods which women desired to worship]

See: Possession

Daniel 11:38 (#1)

עַל־כַּנּוֹ

“in its place”

The pronoun **its** refers to “any god” in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Since this applies to “the gods of his fathers” and “the desire of women” in the previous verse, it may be natural in your language to use a plural pronoun. Alternate translation: [instead of worshiping any other god] or [instead of worshiping those gods]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:38 (#2)

וְלֵאלֹהַּ מָעֻזִּים

“But & a god of fortresses”

The angel is using this possessive form to mean **a god** who gives strength in war. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a god who gives strength in war]

See: Possession

Daniel 11:39 (#1)

לְמִבְצְרֵי מָעֻזִּמּם

“against the fortifications of fortresses”

The angel is using this possessive form to mean the strongest **fortresses** of all. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [against the strongest fortifications]

See: Possession

Daniel 11:39 (#2)

יַרְבֶּה כָּבוֹד

“he will increase glory”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [he will honor them more and more]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:39 (#3)

בְּמָחִיר

“for a price”

This could mean: (1) as a reward. Alternate translation: [in exchange for favor] (2) in exchange for tribute. Alternate translation: [according to taxation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:40 (#1)

יִתְנַגַּח עִמּוֹ מֶלֶךְ הַנֶּגֶב

“the king of the south will gore together with him”

Here the angel is speaking as if the king of the south were an animal that would **gore** his enemy with its horns. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the king of the south will violently attack him]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:40 (#2)

יִתְנַגַּח עִמּוֹ

“will gore together with him”

The pronoun **him** refers to the king of the north, whom the angel names in the next sentence. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [will gore together with the king of the north]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 11:40 (#3)

וְיִשְׂתָּעַר עָלָיו מֶלֶךְ הַצָּפוֹן

“But the king of the north will storm himself against him”

Here the angel is speaking as if the king of the north were a **storm** that would sweep over his enemy. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But the king of the north will attack him violently]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:41 (#1)

וְרֵאשִׁית בְּנֵי עַמּוֹן

“and the first of the sons of Ammon”

The implication of **the first** is either (1) that the greater part of the people of Ammon will escape or (2) that the leaders of the people of Ammon will escape. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and most of the people of Ammon]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:42 (#1)

וְיִשְׁלַ֥ח יָד֛וֹ בָּאֲרָצ֖וֹת

“And he will stretch out his hand against the lands”

The angel is using **he will stretch out his hand against** as a common expression of the culture to mean “he will attack.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will attack the lands]

See: Idiom

Daniel 11:42 (#2)

וְאֶ֥רֶץ מִצְרַ֖יִם לֹ֥א תִהְיֶ֖ה לִפְלֵיטָֽה

“and the land of Egypt will not be an escape”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **an escape**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and the land of Egypt will not escape]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 11:43 (#1)

וְלִבִּ֖ים וְכֻשִׁ֑ים בְּמִצְעָדָֽיו

“And the Libyans and the Cushites will be in his steps”

Here the angel is speaking as if these peoples would follow in the **steps** of this king, meaning that they will submit to his rule. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the Libyans and the Cushites will submit to him]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:43 (#2)

וְלִבִּ֖ים

“And the Libyans”

The words **Libyans** and **Cushites** are the names of people groups.

See: How to Translate Names

Daniel 11:44 (#1)

וּשְׁמֻעֹ֤ות יְבַהֲלֻ֙הוּ֙ מִמִּזְרָ֔ח וּמִצָּפ֖וֹן

“But reports from the east and from the north will terrify him”

The implication is that these **reports** will tell of threats to his rule that come from those directions. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [But reports of threats arising in the east and in the north will terrify him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 11:44 (#2)

וְיָצָ֣א בְּחֵמָ֔ה גְּדֹלָ֖ה

“and he will go out in great heat”

Here the angel is speaking as if the rage of this king were **great heat**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will go out in a great rage]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:44 (#3)

לְהַשְׁמִ֥יד וּלְהַחֲרִ֖ים רַבִּֽים

“to destroy and to devote many”

The terms **to destroy** and **to devote** mean similar things. The angel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [to completely wipe out many]

See: Doublet

Daniel 11:45 (#1)

וְיִטַּ֣ע אָהֳלֵ֔י אַפַּדְנֹ֖ו

“And he will plant the tents of his palace”

Here the angel is speaking as if this king would **plant** his tents the way a person plants a tree. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will securely establish his royal tents]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 11:45 (#2)

אָהֳלֵ֔י אַפַּדְנֹ֖ו

“the tents of his palace”

The angel is using the possessive form to describe **tents** that are characterized by belonging to his

palace. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the tents of his royal court]

See: Possession

Daniel 11:45 (#3)

וּבָא֙ עַד־קִצּ֔וֹ

“But he will come to his end”

The angel is referring to the death of this king in a polite way by using the phrase **he will come to his end**. Depending on what is helpful for your readers, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [But he will pass away]

See: Euphemism

Daniel - Chapter 12 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter concludes the last section in the book, in which Daniel has a vision and man-like figure appears to him and interprets it.

1. The man finishes his interpretation of Daniel’s vision (1–4)
2. The man answers the question of when these things will happen (5–12)

Translation issues in this chapter

How should translators represent the time periods in this chapter?

When two other figures ask the man who has been speaking with Daniel, “Until when will be the end of the wonders?” (12:6), he replies that it will be “for an appointed time, appointed times, and a half” (12:7). Some interpreters understand the term “time” to mean a “year” and the term “times” to mean “two times” (thus “two years”), and so some translations represent this expression as “three and a half years.” However, it is not certain that these are the meanings, and so we recommend that translators represent this expression in a way that allows for the range of possible interpretations. The UST models one way to do this. It translates this expression as “a time, times, and half a time.” We similarly recommend that translators represent the expressions “1,290 days” (12:11) and “1,335 days” (12:12) straightforwardly, without suggesting further interpretations of them.

Daniel 12:1 (#1)

וּבָעֵ֣ת הַהִ֔יא

“And at that time”

The words that the ULT translates as **And at that time** indicate that the events of this verse happen at the same time as the events that the angel described in the previous chapter. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe the time relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [And while those things are happening]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Daniel 12:1 (#2)

הַשַּׂ֣ר הַגָּדֹ֑ול

“the great prince”

The implication is that **the great prince** Michael is an angelic ruler over the people of Israel, not a human king. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the great angelic ruler]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:1 (#3)

הָעֹמֵ֖ד עַל

“standing over”

The angel is speaking as if Michael were guarding the people of Israel by physically **standing over** them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who guards]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 12:1 (#4)

בְּנֵ֥י עַמֶּ֛ךָ

“the sons of your people”

The angel is speaking as if the members of Daniel’s nation were **the sons** of that nation. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the members of your people’s nation]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 12:1 (#5)

יַעֲמֹ֑ד

“will stand”

The angel is using **will stand** as a common expression of the culture to mean "will arise to take action." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will take action]

See: Idiom

Daniel 12:1 (#6)

עֵ֣ת צָרָ֔ה

"a time of distress"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **distress**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a distressing time]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 12:1 (#7)

יִמָּלֵ֖ט עַמְּךָ֑

"your people will be rescued"

The expression **will be rescued** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will rescue your people]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 12:1 (#8)

כָּל־הַנִּמְצָ֖א כָּת֥וּב בַּסֵּֽפֶר

"every one found written in the book"

The expressions **found** and **written** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [every one that God finds, whose name he has written in the book]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 12:1 (#9)

כָּל־הַנִּמְצָ֖א כָּת֥וּב בַּסֵּֽפֶר

"every one found written in the book"

The implication is that **the book** is a heavenly register in which God has recorded the people who belong to him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [every one whose name God has written in his heavenly book]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:2 (#1)

מִיְּשֵׁנֵ֣י אַדְמַת־עָפָ֔ר יָקִ֖יצוּ

"the sleepers of the ground of the dust will awaken"

The angel is referring to dying and to coming back to life in a polite way by using the phrase **the sleepers of the ground of the dust will awaken**. Depending on what is helpful for your readers, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [those who are dead and buried in the ground will come back to life]

See: Euphemism

Daniel 12:2 (#2)

לַחֲרָפ֥וֹת לְדִרְאוֹן־עוֹלָֽם

"to reproaches, to contempt of eternity"

The terms **reproaches** and **contempt** mean similar things. The angel is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [to everlasting disgrace]

See: Doublet

Daniel 12:2 (#3)

לְדִרְאוֹן־עוֹלָֽם

"to contempt of eternity"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **contempt**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [so that people will despise them forever]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 12:3 (#1)

וְהַֽמַּשְׂכִּלִ֔ים

"And the ones making wise"

The implication is that **the ones making wise** refers to either (1) those who are wise themselves or (2) those who make others wise. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And those who are wise]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:3 (#2)

יַזְהִרוּ כְּזֹהַר הָרָקִ֖יעַ

“will shine like the brightness of the firmament”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the brightness of the firmament** is radiant and glorious, so are **the ones making wise**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [will be as radiant and glorious as the shining sky]

See: Simile

Daniel 12:3 (#3)

כְּזֹהַר הָרָקִ֖יעַ

“like the brightness of the firmament”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **brightness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [like the bright sky above]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 12:3 (#4)

וּמַצְדִּיקֵ֥י הָרַבִּ֖ים כַּכּוֹכָבִ֑ים לְעוֹלָ֖ם וָעֶֽד

“and the ones making many righteous, like stars forever and ever”

The angel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the ones making many righteous will shine like stars forever and ever]

See: Ellipsis

Daniel 12:3 (#5)

וּמַצְדִּיקֵ֥י הָרַבִּ֖ים

“and the ones making many righteous”

The implication is that **the ones making many righteous** are people who lead many others to live rightly before God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and those who turn many people to righteousness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:4 (#1)

סְתֹ֤ם הַדְּבָרִים֙ וַחְתֹ֣ם הַסֵּ֔פֶר

“close up the words, and seal the book”

The implication is that to **close up the words, and seal the book** means to keep its contents secret and unaltered until the proper time. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [keep these words secret and preserve this scroll unchanged]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:4 (#2)

יְשֹׁטְט֖וּ רַבִּ֑ים וְתִרְבֶּ֖ה הַדָּֽעַת

“Many will go about, that knowledge may increase”

Here, **that** marks **knowledge may increase** as the goal or purpose of **Many will go about**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [Many will travel about while trying to increase knowledge]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Daniel 12:4 (#3)

יְשֹׁטְט֖וּ רַבִּ֑ים

“Many will go about”

The angel is using **Many will go about** as a common expression of the culture to mean either (1) “many people will travel here and there” or (2) “many people will search through the book.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Many will travel here and there]

See: Idiom

Daniel 12:4 (#4)

וְתִרְבֶּ֖ה הַדָּֽעַת

“that knowledge may increase”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **knowledge**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [that people may know more and more]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 12:5 (#1)

שְׁנַ֣יִם אֲחֵרִ֔ים עֹמְדִ֖ים

“two others were standing”

Daniel is introducing **two others** as new participants in the story. Your language may have its own way

of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [there were two other beings standing]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Daniel 12:5 (#2)

שְׁנַיִם אֲחֵרִים

“two others”

The implication is that **two others** are two more angelic beings, in addition to the man clothed in linens whom Daniel had already seen. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [two other angelic beings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:5 (#3)

אֶחָד הֵהֵנָּה לִשְׂפַת הַיְאֹר

“one here on the lip of the river”

Daniel is speaking as if the edge of the river were a **lip**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one here on the bank of the river]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 12:6 (#1)

לָאִישׁ לְבֻשׁ הַבַּדִּים

“to the man clothed {in} linens”

The implication is that **the man clothed {in} linens** is the angelic being who had been speaking to Daniel, identified here by his garment. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the angel who had been speaking to me, the man clothed in linens]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:6 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר מִמַּעַל לְמֵימֵי הַיְאֹר

“who {was} from above to the waters of the river”

The implication is that the phrase **from above to the waters of the river** means that the man was positioned in the air over the river. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [who was hovering in the air over the waters of the river]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:6 (#3)

קֵץ הַפְּלָאוֹת

“will be} the end of the wonders”

The implication is that **the wonders** are the astonishing events that the angel described in this vision. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [will be the end of the astonishing events described in this vision]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:7 (#1)

וַיָּרֶם יְמִינוֹ וּשְׂמֹאלוֹ אֶל־הַשָּׁמַיִם

“And he raised his right hand and his left hand toward the heavens”

Raising both hands toward heaven was a symbolic action by which the man clothed in linens showed that he was calling on God as the witness to the oath he was about to swear. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And he raised his right hand and his left hand toward the heavens to call on God as his witness]

See: Symbolic Action

Daniel 12:7 (#2)

וַיִּשָּׁבַע בְּחֵי הָעוֹלָם

“and he swore by the one living {for} eternity”

Following the custom of the culture, the man clothed in linens is swearing an oath and guaranteeing it by someone whom he holds sacred, **the one living {for} eternity**. Alternate translation: [and he made a solemn promise, calling on the one who lives for eternity as his witness]

See: Oath Formulas

Daniel 12:7 (#3)

בְּחֵי הָעוֹלָם

“by the one living {for} eternity”

The implication is that **the one living {for} eternity** is a title for God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [by God, the one who lives eternally]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:7 (#4)

לְמוֹעֵ֥ד מוֹעֲדִ֖ים וָחֵ֑צִי

“for an appointed time, appointed times, and a half”

The man clothed in linens is using **an appointed time, appointed times, and a half** as a common expression of the culture to mean “a limited period whose length God has determined.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for a limited period of time that God has determined]

See: Idiom

Daniel 12:7 (#5)

וּכְכַלּ֣וֹת נַפֵּ֔ץ

“And according to the finishing of the shattering of”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **the finishing** and **the shattering**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [And when they finish shattering]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 12:7 (#6)

יַ֥ד־עַם־קֹדֶ֖שׁ

“the hand of the people of holiness”

Here, **the hand** represents “power.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the power of the people of holiness]

See: Metonymy

Daniel 12:7 (#7)

עַם־קֹדֶ֖שׁ

“the people of holiness”

The man clothed in linens is using the possessive form to describe a **people** that is characterized by **holiness**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the holy people]

See: Possession

Daniel 12:7 (#8)

תִּכְלֶ֑ינָה כָּל־אֵ֖לֶּה

“all of these would finish”

The pronoun **these** refers to the wonders that the other angel asked about in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [all of these wonders would finish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 12:8 (#1)

וַאֲנִ֣י שָׁמַ֔עְתִּי

“And I, I heard”

Daniel expresses the pronoun **I** twice here, where it would ordinarily be expressed only once. This suggests that he is emphasizing his own part in what happened. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And as for me, I myself heard]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Daniel 12:8 (#2)

אֲדֹנָ֑י

“My lord”

Daniel is referring to the man clothed in linens by a respectful title. Use a comparable title or expression for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [Honored sir]

See: Politeness

Daniel 12:9 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Daniel 12:9 (#2)

לֵ֥ךְ דָּנִיֵּ֖אל

“Go, Daniel”

The man clothed in linens is using **Go, Daniel** as a common expression of the culture to mean “go on your way and live out the rest of your life.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Continue living your life, Daniel]

See: Idiom

Daniel 12:9 (#3)

סְתֻמִים וַחֲתֻמִים הַדְּבָרִים

“the words are closed up and sealed”

The expressions **closed up** and **sealed** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God has closed up and sealed the words]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 12:10 (#1)

יִתְבָּרְרוּ וְיִתְלַבְּנוּ וְיִצָּרְפוּ רַבִּים

“Many will be purified and whitened and refined”

The expressions **purified**, **whitened**, and **refined** are passive verbal forms. If it would be unnatural to use those forms, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will purify and whiten and refine many]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 12:10 (#2)

יִתְבָּרְרוּ וְיִתְלַבְּנוּ וְיִצָּרְפוּ רַבִּים

“Many will be purified and whitened and refined”

The man clothed in linens is speaking as if these people were cloth that could be **purified and whitened** and metal that could be **refined**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Many will be made morally clean and pure and proven genuine]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 12:10 (#3)

וְהִרְשִׁיעוּ רְשָׁעִים

“but the wicked will act wickedly”

The man clothed in linens is using the adjective **wicked** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [but people who are wicked will act wickedly]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Daniel 12:10 (#4)

וְלֹא יָבִינוּ כָּל־רְשָׁעִים וְהַמַּשְׂכִּלִים יָבִינוּ

“And not any of the wicked will understand, but the ones making wise will understand”

The implication is that what the wicked will not **understand**, and what **the ones making wise will understand**, is the meaning of this message about the last days. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And none of the wicked will understand the meaning of this message about the last days, but the people who are wise will understand it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:11 (#1)

וּמֵעֵת הוּסַר הַתָּמִיד וְלֻתֵּת שִׁקֻּוץ שֹׁמֵם יָמִים אֶלֶף מָאתַיִם וְתִשְׁעִים

“And from the time of {when} the perpetual sacrifice is removed and the setting up of the abomination making desolate {will be} 1,290 days”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **1,290 days** before the information about the time **when the perpetual sacrifice is removed and the setting up of the abomination making desolate**. Alternate translation: [And there will be 1,290 days from the time of when the perpetual sacrifice is removed and the setting up of the abomination making desolate]

See: Information Structure

Daniel 12:11 (#2)

הוּסַר הַתָּמִיד

“when} the perpetual sacrifice is removed”

The expression **is removed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when they remove the perpetual sacrifice]

See: Active or Passive

Daniel 12:11 (#3)

הַתָּמִיד

“the perpetual sacrifice”

The implication is that **the perpetual sacrifice** is the offering that the priests presented in the temple every

morning and every evening. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the daily temple sacrifice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:11 (#4)

שִׁקּוּץ שֹׁמֵם

“the abomination making desolate”

The implication is that **the abomination making desolate** is an idolatrous object that would defile the temple and cause people to abandon it. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the detestable idol that defiles the temple and causes it to be abandoned]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:12 (#1)

אַשְׁרֵי הַמְחַכֶּה

“The happinesses of the one waiting”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **happinesses**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [How happy is the one waiting]

See: Abstract Nouns

Daniel 12:12 (#2)

וְיַגִּיעַ לְיָמִים אֶלֶף שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת שְׁלֹשִׁים וַחֲמִשָּׁה

“and he reaches to the 1,335 days”

The man clothed in linens is using **reaches to** as a common expression of the culture to mean “survives until.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he survives until the 1,335 days]

See: Idiom

Daniel 12:13 (#1)

לֵךְ לַקֵּץ

“go until the end”

The implication is that **the end** refers to either (1) the end of Daniel’s own life or (2) the end of the age. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [go until the end of your life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Daniel 12:13 (#2)

וְתָנוּחַ

“for you will rest”

The man clothed in linens is referring to Daniel’s death in a polite way by using the phrase **you will rest**. Depending on what is helpful for your readers, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [for you will pass away]

See: Euphemism

Daniel 12:13 (#3)

וְתַעֲמֹד

“and you will stand”

The man clothed in linens is speaking as if Daniel’s return to life were his getting up to **stand**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will rise to life again]

See: Metaphor

Daniel 12:13 (#4)

לְגֹרָלְךָ

“for your lot”

Here, **your lot** represents “the portion that God has assigned to you.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for the portion God has assigned to you]

See: Metonymy